

SUNDAY 6 SEPTEMBER 2026

Twenty Third Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:

Aghyaran ♦ Ardstraw West & Castlederg ♦ Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

Parish websites (*including access to church webcams*) and emails:

Aghyaran: Website: parishofaghyaran.com Email: aghyaranparish@derrydiocese.org

Drumquin: Website: drumquinparish.com Email: drumquin@derrydiocese.org

Ardstraw West & Castlederg: Web: castledergparish.com Email: castledergparish@derrydiocese.org

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:

Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 7 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 8 Sept	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 9 Sept	Liturgy of the Word, With Holy Communion	Liturgy of the Word, With Holy Communion	Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 10 Sept	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 11 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	
Saturday 12 Sept	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 13 Sept	<i>Mass on first and third Sunday</i>	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am Drumnabey, 12.30pm	<i>Mass on first and third Sunday</i>

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £877 & €51. Church Restoration Fund: £773 & €522.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,018 & €79, made up of:

Castlederg £1,147 & €46, Drumnabey £483 & €36, Dregish £388 & €10. **DRUMQUIN:** £877.

UNLOCKING THE MYSTERIES OF THE BIBLE: As published last week, we had intended to start this eight-week course in the coming week. Unfortunately, the resources that we need for the programme will not be available until the end of September. We will keep you posted with a new start-date as soon as we have the materials. Apologies for the inconvenience.



We pray for the happy repose of the soul of Evelyn Baxter, Castlefin Park, whose Funeral Mass took place in Castlederg on Thursday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to Evelyn's family and to all who mourn her death. May she rest in peace.

CONGRATULATIONS to the winners in the Ardstraw West and Castlederg Monthly Draw for Parish Development, which took place in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, on Sunday 30 August:

£1,000 Eunan Carlin (1118) Promoter's Prize: Sylvia McHugh
£500 Lynn Gallen (13)
£250 (x 3) May Browne (16); Michael Lynch (677); Alicia McCrory (220)
£100 (x 7) Mary McGlinchey (918); Eugene Carlin (557); Michael Gallen (194); Frank & Geraldine Gallen (1027); Patrick McHugh (600); Michelle McDougall (832); Fr Patsy Arkinson (678).

As always, thanks to our wonderful team of promoters and to all who are supporting our Parish Appeal by taking part in the draw. Returns for September's draw should be made to the Parochial House on Thursday 17 September between 6.00 and 7.30pm. The next draw will take place on Sunday 27 September 2026 in St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg.

There is a small number of tickets left – if you are not in the draw but would like to join, talk to the promoter in your area or contact Kathleen in the Parish Office. If you're not in, you can't win!

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Monday 7 Sept – Drumquin - Rural Area only: Tattysallagh Road / Dooish Road / Glen Road / Bradan Road / Sloughan Road / Drumscrew Road, commencing at 11.00am - Fr Thomas.

Wednesday 9 Sept – Castlederg Rural Area, Oakleigh Grove, Main Street and Derg Fold, commencing at 3.00pm - Fr Thomas.

Thursday 10 Sept – Young Crescent and Drumnabey, commencing at 10.30am – Fr Paul.

Friday 11 Sept – Town Area – (excluding Oakleigh Grove, Derg Fold & Main Street), commencing 10.30am – Fr Paul.

BLESSING OF STUDENTS: A special Mass to mark the beginning of the school year for both Primary and Secondary school pupils will be celebrated on Saturday 12 September at 7.30pm in St. Patrick's Church Aghyaran.

Blessing of school bags for those starting school will take place at this Mass. We encourage families to come along and young children beginning school are asked to bring their school bag with them, as we ask God's blessing on all of them and their work in the new year ahead.

PRAYER:

Lord, we thank you for your goodness to all your children,
Be with these children throughout this new school year.
May your blessing be upon these school bags which the children will carry to and from school each day.
Watch over the children in their coming and their going.
Keep them safe always; help them to be kind; bless their learning and their play.
Enfold them at all times in your love. We pray through Christ our Lord. AMEN

LEGION OF MARY Meetings will resume in Drumquin Parochial House this Thursday, 10 September, commencing at 7.30pm. New members are very welcome to come along to this short time prayer and reflections.

RISE AND SHINE TRUST – Easter 2027 Pilgrimage: Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11-30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with Rise and Shine Trust. The trip is free to Guests. Application form available on riseandshine.ie. Closing date 15 October. Applications also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests. Applications at riseandshine.ie Visit www.riseandshine.ie or contact Sian (07960211352) or Maurice (07711504821).

ARANDERG CCÉ Irish Traditional Music Sessions have started back on Friday nights at 9.00pm in Killeter Heritage. Everyone is welcome! We are holding a **registration night** tomorrow, Mon 7 September, for parents to register their child for upcoming music lessons, in Banjo, Fiddle, Accordion and Tin whistle. Lessons are £30 for 6 weeks, with payment required on registration night. Call in any time between 7.00 – 8.00pm to register or if you have any questions.

IRISH DANCING resumes on **Tuesday 8 September**, at **6.00pm** in **Drumquin Community Youth Centre**. New beginners P1 and above are welcome to join. Text / call Dolores on 07739631478.

ZUMBA FITNESS with Vanessa is back for September – Tuesday 8 September at 7.00pm in Garvagh Hall and Wednesday 9 September at 7.00pm in St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg. No experience needed, no perfect moves required, no pressure. Any questions or queries, contact Vanessa on 077 0235 5424

YOGA CLASS: Aghyaran Development Association in conjunction with HARC is commencing a 6-week Yogo class for over 50's in Aghyaran Centre, commencing Tues 15 September, 11.30am - 12.30pm. Contact Jerry on 078 6492 9344.

HOST FOR HOSPICE: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

Season of Creation 2026: 1 September to 4 October

The annual celebration of Season of Creation aims to bring Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation. The theme is inspired by the vision of hope and renewal found in the Book of Ezekiel, 47:9: "Wherever the river flows, every living creature that swarms will live... and everything will live where the river goes."

ARDMORE PARISH NEWSLETTER

Sunday, 6th September 2026

23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time

Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 18:15–20

In today's Gospel, Jesus teaches that **reconciliation is a sacred responsibility**, rooted in love, humility and a desire for restored relationship.

When conflict or hurt arises, the first response should not be anger, gossip, avoidance or revenge, but a quiet and honest conversation with the person involved. This private dialogue gives space for **listening, understanding and healing**.

If the conflict cannot be resolved alone, Jesus encourages the involvement of trusted witnesses — not to shame or accuse, but to help guide the conversation with wisdom, fairness and care. When difficulties continue, the wider community has a role in encouraging accountability, unity and peace.

Remember LOVE

L — Listen with humility

Hear one another deeply and seek to understand.

O — Offer reconciliation

Choose restoration and forgiveness over pride.

V — Value community

Protect the unity, peace and wellbeing of the community.

E — Embrace divine presence

Trust that God is present wherever people gather in faith, prayer, forgiveness and harmony.

Jesus reminds us that **love is more than a feeling; it is a way of living**. Through patience, courage, humility and faith, conflict can become an opportunity for healing, forgiveness and renewed fellowship.

May the peace of Christ guide our hearts, strengthen our unity, and fill our community with love, forgiveness and grace. Amen.

Readings for Sunday 13th September

1st Reading: Sirach 27:30–28:7

Psalm: 102:1–4, 9–12

2nd Reading: Romans 14:7–9

Gospel: Matthew 18:21–35



Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday: Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Wednesday: St Ciaran of Clonmacnoise

Thursday: St Peter Claver

Saturday: St Ailbe; The Most Holy Name of Mary



Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles

The **Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles** takes place on **Sunday 13th September at 1.30 pm** in **St Aengus' Chapel, Burt**.

Following the blessing, all are welcome to join the run to **Ned's Point RNLI Station**, where a donation will be presented to the RNLI.

Mass will be celebrated on **13th September at 11.30 am** in **St Patrick's Chapel, Dungiven**, for deceased bikers.

All welcome.



Pray for Vocations

We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

Visit: <https://derryvocations.org>



St Joseph's Men's Camino

A day of **pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal** takes place on **Saturday 12th September**.

Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, the **25km guided pilgrimage** along the beautiful Boyne Valley is open to all men aged 18+.

Cost: €65 / €55 (including lunch and dinner)

Visit: www.dominicans.ie



Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day takes place **today (Sunday) at Termonbacca, Derry**, beginning with the **National Mass at 2.00 pm**, celebrated by Bishop McKeown.

This will be followed by refreshments, children's activities and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family.

Email: info@catholicmothers.ie



Host for Hospice

October is Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month.

We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on — **it's a piece of cake!**

To request your **FREE host pack** or for more information, please contact:

Ailbhe, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice

☎ 028 71359888

✉ ailbhe@foylehospice.com



Job Opportunity

Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of **Sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish**.

Hours: 12 hours per week

Rate of Pay: £12.88 per hour

Closing Date: 15/09/26

✉ recruitment@derrydiocese.org

☎ 028 71262302



Human Life International Ireland

Fr L Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, will visit Ireland as part of a Provincial Tour.

Join us for the **Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry**, on **29th September at 6.45 pm**, with a first-class relic of **St Thérèse**.

Season of Creation

During this **Season of Creation**, Pope Leo invites us to turn our attention to one of the most essential gifts for life: **water**.

Let us pray that we may learn to manage water with justice and responsibility, protecting it as a common good and ensuring that everyone has equitable access to it.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Course

The next Marriage Preparation Course takes place on **20th/21st November** at the **Ebrington Hotel, Derry**.

Booking online: www.accordni.com

Lough Derg Day Retreats

Day Retreats take place on:

September 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20

A day of **prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal**.

Visit: www.loughderg.org

All welcome.

Rosary on the Coast

Rosary on the Coast takes place **today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm** at **Lisfannon Beach**, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn babies.

Everyone welcome.

BALLINASCREEN & DESERTMARTIN PARISHES

6_SEPTEMBER_2026

No. 45 ~ TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

PARISH CONTACT DETAILS

Fr. Peter Madden PP VF

31 Sixtowns Road

Telephone: 79628376

Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Fr Michael McCaul CC

50 Tobermore Road, Desertmartin

Telephone: 79632196

Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

PARISH OFFICES

Ballinascreen:

9 High Street

Phone: (028)79628248

Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Opening Hours: Monday, Tuesday and Thursday: 8.45 am - 3.30 pm. Wednesday: 8.45 am - 3.00 pm.

Desertmartin:

St Patrick's Keenaught

Phone: (028)79397047

Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

Opening Hours: Wednesday and Thursday 10.30 am to 3.00 pm.

SAFEGUARDING

Safeguarding Contact Information

If you have any concerns with regard to the safeguarding of children within the Church, please contact:

Marie O'Kane - Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) Tel.: +44 7596 500793 or Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland Emergency Services

- PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101
- Social Services:
 - Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (ask for the Duty Social Worker)
 - Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459
 - Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995

LIFELINE

Tel: 0808 808 8000 / Textphone 18001 0808 808 8000.

www.lifelinehelpline.info

SVP HELPLINE

Helpline telephone number: 07710838050

GAMBLING HELPLINE

Help is available, phone: 02871351329

SPERRIN FOODBANK

Tel: 07543420639

BALLINASCREEN COMMUNITY SUPPORT GROUP

Please click the link <https://www.parishofballinascreen.com/ballinascreen-community-support-gro> for full details of Ballinascreen Community Support Group.



NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices for the Bulletin should be received by 1.00 pm on Wednesday, preferably by email.

Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

VIGIL MASSES FOR SUNDAY

Holy Rosary: 6.00 pm

St Patrick's, Keenaught: 7.30 pm

SUNDAY MASSES

St Columba's, Straw: 9.00 am

St Mary's, Coolcalm: 10.00 am

St Patrick's, Sixtowns: 11.00 am

St Eugene's, Moneyneena: 12 noon

MASSES FOR THIS WEEK

Monday ~ 7 September

10.00 am ~ St. Mary's, Coolcalm.

7.30 pm ~ Holy Rosary Church. Mass in honour of St Pio of Pietrelcina.

Tuesday ~ 8 September

10.00 am ~ St. Mary's, Coolcalm.

Wednesday ~ 9 September

10.00 am ~ Holy Rosary Church. DDS Mass.

Thursday ~ 10 September

10.00 am ~ St Mary's, Coolcalm

Friday ~ 4 September

10.00 am ~ St. Mary's, Coolcalm.

7.30 pm ~ Holy Rosary Church.

CONFESSIONS

Ballinascreen: Holy Rosary 5.30 pm - before Vigil Mass.

Desertmartin: Keenaught, Saturday 6.30 pm until 7.10 pm.

FEASTS OF THE WEEK

Tuesday 8 September: Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary.

Wednesday 9 September: St Ciaran, abbot.

Thursday 10 September: St Peter Claver, priest.

Saturday 12 September: The Holy Name of Mary & St Ailbe, bishop.

DERRY DIOCESAN SOCIETY

The following Mass on Wednesday 9 September, at 10.00 am in The Holy Rosary, will be offered for the members of the Derry Diocesan Society:

If you wish to enrol someone in the society, please contact the parish office. The fee for a living or deceased member is £20.

OPENING OF THE NEW SCHOOL YEAR MASSES

St Columb's Primary School, Cullion: Wednesday 23 September in St Patrick's, Keenaught at 1.15 pm.

Knocknagin Primary School: Thursday 24 September in St Mary's, Coolcalm at 10.00 am.

MASS IN HONOUR OF ST PIO

Monthly Mass in honour of St Pio of Pietrelcina will be celebrated on Monday 7 September at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church. Novena prayers and Rosary at 7.00 pm.

VOICE OF PADRE PIO

Annual subscriptions for the St Pio magazine are now due. If you wish to receive this informative magazine posted directly to you from San Giovanni Rotunda please enclose £14 in a sealed envelope with your full name and address and pay at the St Pio mass on Monday 7 September.

CHANGE OF MASS TIME

Please note the evening Mass in Holy Rosary Church on Friday 2 October will be at the earlier time of 6.00 pm.

DEATHS

We extend our prayerful sympathy to the family and relatives of Garry McCullagh, Glengomna Rd.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS

The First Anniversary Mass for Anna McCullagh, Moneyneena Rd, will be held on Friday 18 September at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.
The First Anniversary Mass for Gerry Donnelly, Moykeeran Drive, will be held on Friday 18 September at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.
The First Anniversary Mass for Mary McGuckin, Carnose Rd, will be held on Saturday 26 September at 7.30 pm in St Patrick's, Keenaught.

ANNIVERSARIES

Ballinascreen:

First Anniversary:

Eugene Kelly, Magherafelt

Anniversaries:

Rose O'Kane, Magherafelt Rd.;

Annie Murray, Sixtowns Rd.;

Charles Murray, Campbelltown Terr.;

Susan Clerkin, The Fold;

Mary Lagan, Glenelly Villas;

Rose O'Neill, Disert Rd.;

Rose Kelly, Moneyneena Rd.;

Desmond Bradley, Glenelly Villas;

Nuala McCrossan, Bancran Rd.;

Brendan Kelly, Mulnavoo Rd.;

Stephen Conway, High St.

Desertmartin:

Hubert Murray;

Kevin Donnelly;

Gerard McCann;

Maureen McNally;

James Fullen;

Baby Mary Henry;

Eddie Walls.

BAPTISMS

We welcome into God's family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Líle Jacqueline Brown, Dunmurry Rd.;

Peadar Ger Kelly, River Rd.

WEDDINGS

Congratulations and best wishes for the future to:

Claire O'Hagan and Gerard Higgins who were married recently in St Mary's Coolcalm;

Martin Donnelly and Jodie Monger who were married recently in St Columba's Straw.

LAPÓGLANN - TODDLE-INN

Glór na Speiríní are pleased to announce that our parent and toddlers' group has recommenced. Every Monday, Wednesday and Friday from 9.00 am to 10.30 am in Glór na Speiríní centre Straw, directly beside the chapel. £2 per session with refreshments included. Please note that our Irish language session is every Thursday morning from 9.00 am to 10.30 am. Tá fáilte roimh chách - Everyone is welcome! For further info or to register your place at these events please Email conchurglor@gmail.com or Tel.: 07795 536682 Urraithe ag Comhairle Ceantair Lár Uladh

WARM WELCOME WEDNESDAYS

In Workspace Community Hub, recommence on Wednesday 9 September, from 11.00 am to 1.00 pm. No need to book, just drop-in for tea / coffee and some chat. Free of charge and open to everyone.

O'NEILL ACADEMY OF IRISH DANCE

Class will resume Thursday 10 September in Ráth Dubh Centre, Moneyneena at 4.45 pm. All new members welcome.

GLÓR NA SPEIRÍNÍ / OÍCHE CHULTÚIR

In Workspace Hub, Saturday 19 September at 6.30 pm. Join us for an evening of Irish / Scottish Ceilí, Traditional Music, Piper, Highland dancing and Séan Nós dancing. All Donations welcome, and will be donated to STEPS and Mid Ulster Womens Aid. Funded by Workspace.

SGARA

Three nights break in Bundoran. 28, 29 and 30 September. B&B plus evening meal. Music each night €237euros plus transport. Contact any member for details.

RANGANNA GAEILGE DO DHAOINE FÁSTA

Glór na Speiríní are delighted to announce recommencement of our adult Irish language classes on Thursday 1 October from 7.30 pm to 9.00 pm in Straw, Ballinascreen. Cost for this block of 10 lessons is £40 and there are 5 levels to cater for everyone's needs. For information on booking and payment please contact Conchúr via Email: conchurglor@gmail.com or Tel.: 07795 536682. Urraithe ag Comhairle Ceantair Lár Uladh

KILCRONAGHAN CENTRE

Vintage Rally, Craft Fair & Family Fun Day, on Saturday 26 September from 11.00 am to 3.00 pm. For details see Kilcronaghan Facebook page or Tel.: 028 79627826.

PARISH COLLECTIONS

Ballinascreen:

Weekly Collection - £1,433

Renovation Collection - £1,730.80

Desertmartin:

Weekly Collection - £1,222

Thank you for your generous support which is greatly appreciated.

SUMMER BONANZA DRAW WINNERS ~ WEEK 4

£1000 ~ Colm McNamee, Kildress;

£200 ~ Joanne Connolly;

£100 ~ Danny Scullion, Ballinascreen.

KNOCKNAGIN HALL

Social Tea Dance: Friday 11 September at 9.00 pm. Music by Wee Tom. Admission £7 - includes refreshments.

Craft Fair: Now taking bookings for our Christmas Craft Fair, Sunday 8 November from 10.30 am to 3.00 pm. £20 per table or 2 for £30; £10 booking deposit required. Email knocknaginhc@gmail.com or phone 078 8761 4094 to secure a table.

Irish Classes: Resumes on Monday 7 September. Partly supported by MUDC.

Bunrang (Beginners) 6:45 pm to 8.00 pm. This class is suitable for people who have no Irish and wish to learn,

Meánrang (Improvers) 8.00 pm to 9:30 pm. This class is suitable for people who already have a basic grasp of Irish - such as those who have completed a beginner class, but want to build confidence and fluency. Anyone wishing to join either class please book a place by

Email: knocknaginhc@gmail.com or phone 028 7963 1744 / 078 3516 1927. Cost: 8 wks £40 - payable on the first night.

Chair Exercises: Tuesday mornings from 10.00 am to 11.00 am. A fun and exciting way to get exercise, improve your fitness, health & wellbeing. Everyone welcome. Admission £4.

Irish Dancing Lessons: Tuesday evenings from 5:30 pm to 7.00 pm. To register, contact Nicola: 07518 207458

Bowling Club: Recommences on Tuesday 1 September from 8.00 pm. Suitable for all ages - from 9 to 90, everyone welcome.

Line Dancing Classes: Wednesday evenings from 7:30 pm, suitable for all ages, from beginners to experts. Adm £5. All welcome.

Acrobats Gymnastics Club: Saturday mornings from 9.00 am to 2.00 pm. Spaces are available across selected classes. To register visit <https://acro-bats.classforkids.io/term/10>

CHILD SAFEGUARDING INFORMATION TRAINING

An information evening will take place in Desertmartin Parochial/Knocknagin Hall on Wednesday 9 September at 7.00 pm and will finish at 8.00 pm. This is an essential meeting for all priests in Ballinascreen / Desertmartin Parishes; all sacristans, secretaries. SPRED group leaders, Eucharistic Ministers who bring Holy Communion to non-family members, members of SVP, Prayers Groups and all other volunteers who interact with the young and the vulnerable on behalf of the parish.

SIXTOWNS CROSS COMMUNITY GROUP

- Tea/Coffee Morning to Start off our 25th Anniversary Celebrations of the Centre on Sunday 6 September at 11.30 am. Everyone Welcome.
- A special 25th Anniversary celebration event will be held on Friday 9 October at 8.00 pm in Sixtowns Hall. A great night of music & entertainment has been arranged with special guests Country Harmony, Patsy O'Hagan, Justin McGurk, Hugo Duncan and Brendan Quinn. Tickets are £20 and available from Heron's Gift Shop, Ballinascreen Credit Union, Straw Service Station & Committee Members.

DRAPERSTOWN PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH

An evening of Gospel Music and Praise on Friday 11 September at 7.30 pm. Suitable for all ages and tastes. Everyone welcome. All proceeds and donations to Mission Work.

BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOTORCYCLES

Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, at 1.30 pm. All welcome to attend the brief service and blessing, after which all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September at 11.30 am in **St Patrick's Church, Dungiven**, for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.

BALLINASCREEN GAC

Irish Language and Culture Night at 7.00 pm on Friday 18 September. More details to follow on Ballinascreen GAC social media pages.

Ballinascreen GAC hope to enter teams in the Junior Scór Dhoire in October. Contact John on 07471374398 to register or for any queries.

ST PIO KNOCK PILGRIMAGE

National Knock Pilgrimage in honour of St Pio of Pietrelcina on Sunday September 20. Coach will leave from Holy Rosary Church at 7.00 am, pickup at St Mary's Coolcam (7.10 am) returning at 10.00 pm approx. Fare £35 (includes breakfast) payable on booking. All welcome.

To book please contact: 07836366949 or 07732125316 or 07769720546.

DONEGAL GROUP 173 RISE AND SHINE TRUST

Celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. A special Mass will be held on Saturday 26 September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's Letterkenny at 12 noon. Concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal Mc Keowan Diocese of Derry.

We invite all the guests, their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

MICHAEL ENGLISH CONCERT ~ SPONSORSHIP

Any business or company who would like to be one of the sponsors for the Michael English Fundraising Concert should please contact Fr Madden: Tel.: 028 79628376 or Email either Parish [Office desertmartinparish@gmail.com](mailto:desertmartinparish@gmail.com) or ballinascreenparish@gmail.com.

All sponsorship will be gratefully received and acknowledged.

MICHAEL ENGLISH & BAND LIVE CONCERT

Enjoy a rare and intimate evening with Michael English, one of Ireland's most popular entertainers. This exclusive acoustic performance of uplifting music filled with hope, faith and community spirit takes place on Friday 2 October, at 8.00 pm in St. Patrick's Church, Keenaught. All proceeds from this special fundraising concert will go to towards the Parish of Desertmartin, Church Renovation Fund. Tickets £30 each are now available to buy from Heron's Gift Shop, Moneyneena Post Office, both Parish Offices, or online (**Click Here**) with Eventbrite or use this QR code:



HEART FOR ART / QUIZ NIGHT SUCCESS

A massive thank you to everyone who supported our recent Quiz Night! Together, we raised an incredible total of **£9,895** for two very special causes close to our hearts. The funds have been donated to the dedicated teams at Antrim Area Hospital - **£9,395 to the Intensive Care Unit (ICU)** - in memory of Daddy, thanking the incredible team who did absolutely everything they could for him 10 years ago. **£500 to Respiratory Ward A1** - in deep gratitude to the staff who looked after Mummy and helped her so much this past April. Your overwhelming generosity means the world to our family and ensures these healthcare heroes can continue their vital work. **From the bottom of our hearts, thank you!**

Ciara McNamee & Family

PARISH BAPTISMS 2026

Ballinascreen Parish:

All bookings to be made via Ballinascreen Parish Office on 02879628248 or Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Baptisms will be held at 3.00 pm on the following dates:

13 September, Straw.
4 October, Holy Rosary.
17 October, Sixtowns. (**Saturday**)
1 November, Straw.

Desertmartin Parish:

To book a baptism, contact Fr McCaul on 02879632196 or Desertmartin Parish Office on 02879397047. Baptisms can be held in either church and are held at 1.30 pm on the following dates:

September 6 & 27 2026
October 4 & 18 2026
November 8 & 22 2026
December 6 & 20 2026
January 10 & 24 2027
February 7 & 21 2027
March 7 & 14 2027
April 4 & 18 2027

NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices should be received by **1.00 pm on Wednesday**, preferably emailed to **ballinascreenparish@gmail.com**

PARISH ANNIVERSARY MASS & MONTH'S MIND MASSES

If you wish to have a deceased loved one prayed for at any Anniversary Friday Mass, please email their name to the Parish Office by **1.00 pm on Wednesday** of the relevant week. Notices for First Anniversary and Month's Mind Masses should be received before **1.00 pm on Wednesday of the previous week** so that, they may be printed in the Bulletin the weekend before the Anniversary Mass.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS

We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

PARISH OF BANAGHER

23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time – 6th September 2026

Mass Times Mass

Times:

Monday: St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9.30am
 Tuesday: St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.00am
 Wednesday: St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: 7.00pm
 Thursday: St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.00am
 Friday: St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9.30am

Weekend Mass Times for Sunday 13th September 2026

St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 7.00pm Vigil
 St. Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.30am
 St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12.00pm Noon

Confessions

St. Mary's Church, Altinure: Thursday 10.30am
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Friday 10.00am
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Saturday 6.30pm

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament and Divine Mercy Chaplet

St. Mary's Church, Altinure: Thursday 10.30am – 11.30am.
 St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn: Friday 10.00am – 11.00am.

A Month's Mind Mass will be celebrated for Patsy Murphy, RIP, at St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn on Saturday 13th September at 7.00pm.



Banagher Parish Monthly Cash Prize Draw ~ Tickets on Sale!

✠ Money raised will go towards the ongoing refurbishment and ✠
 ✠ maintenance of our Churches ✠

Draws for 10 Cash Prizes will take place in **October, November and December**.
 30 chances to win! Tickets cost **£30** and are now on sale and available from our
 Church Sacristies and Parochial House and from Feeny Spar, Park Vivo,
 Mace Derrychrier and Sperrin View Bar. Thank you very much for your support.

September	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn		St Mary's Church, Altinure
	7.00pm	9.15am	10.30am
Readers	Natalie McCloskey	Mary Kathleen McDermott	Noeleen McGlinchey
Eucharistic Ministers	Bernie Lynch	Geraldine McCloskey	Andrena O'Kane
Flowers	Bridget Kealey		Briege McLaughlin
Cleaning	Margaret Cartin, Angela Hasson		Audrey McElhinney, Martina Moore
Counters	Ann Hassan, Marian & Anthony O'Neill, Patricia McCloskey		Philomena Conway, Sean Conway, Karen Feeney
Collectors	Dermot Lynch Vincent McCloskey	Anthony O'Neill Patrick McGrellis	Eamon Feeney, Patrick Conway

Blessing of Motorcycles next Sunday 13th September at St. Aengus' Church, Burt, Co. Donegal at 1.30pm. All are very welcome. All money raised will be donated to the RNLI Station at Ned's Point, Buncrana.

Prayer for Vocations: We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

Michael English Church Concert: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2nd October at 7.15pm in St. Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, and at the Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>.

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) is celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26th September in the Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny, Co. Donegal at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our Mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

OFFERTORY COLLECTION

29th & 30th August 2026

St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: £870 St Mary's Church, Altinure: £585
 St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen: £500

Please consider online contributions and Gift Aid. Online Contributions to:
Parish of Banagher Sort Code: 950306 A/c 51052659
Thank you for your continued generosity.

Feast Days this Week

Tuesday 8th September: Nativity of Mary. We celebrate the Birth of Mary, who brought Jesus Christ the dawn of hope and salvation into the world. She is the Ark of the Covenant, the temple of God, because her body received the one Mediator.

Wednesday 9th September: St. Ciaran was born in Roscommon around 512. He came to Clonmacnoise in January 545 where he founded a monastery which was to become one of the most renowned in Europe. He died at the age of thirty-three while the monastery was still being built.

Thursday 10th September: St. Peter Claver was born in Verdu, Catalonia, in 1580 and studied at the University of Barcelona. He became a Jesuit; and while he was studying philosophy in Mallorca, the doorkeeper of the college, Alfonso Rodríguez, saw that his true vocation was to evangelize the New World, and encouraged him to fulfil that vocation. (Rodríguez was later canonized on the same day as Peter Claver himself). He arrived in Cartagena, in what is now the country of Colombia, in 1610, and after his ordination six years later he became a servant to the native people, labouring on their behalf for 33 years, attending to both their spiritual and material needs. The slave trade around at the time was repeatedly condemned by the Popes, but it was too profitable to be stopped and on the whole the local church hierarchy kept quiet about it, much as they did in North America in the 19th century. He brought fresh food to the slave-ships as they arrived, instructed the slaves and baptized them in the faith, followed their progress and kept track of them even when they were sent to the mines and plantations, defending them as best he could from oppressive slave-owners. At the end of his life he fell ill with a degenerative disease and for four years he was treated neglectfully and brutally by the servant whose task it was to look after him. He did not complain but accepted his sufferings as a penance for his sins.

JOB OPPORTUNITY

Derry Diocesan Trust: Sacristan

Hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St. John the Baptist Church, Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish. Rate of Pay: £12.88 per hour. For application packs, please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St. Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than **12 noon on Tuesday 15th September 2026**.

Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Privacy Notice - The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting the Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn, St. Mary's Church, Altinure and St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen are available online. Please note that the first three rows of seats are visible online in St. Joseph's Church, Fincairn and St. Peter's & St. Paul's Church, Foreglen, and the first six rows of seats in St. Mary's Church, Altinure.

COMMUNITY NEWS

Dungiven and Feeny local committee for Cancer Research UK would like to thank everyone who supported and helped in any way with our 'Dungiven Walk of Hope 2026'. The walk raised the amazing sum of £8,780.01! Thank you everyone for your continued support.

Learmount Community Development Group (PARK): Week commencing **Monday 7th September:** Dementia Social Group: (11 am - 1 pm); **Tuesday 8th:** Men's Hobby Workshop (10.30 am - 12.30 pm); Advice NW (2 - 4 pm); Funky Feet Kids dance class (5 - 6 pm); Slow Sewing (7 - 9 pm); **Thursday 10th:** Post Office Outreach Service (9 am - 12 pm); Painting for Pleasure (10.30 am - 12.30 pm); Park 60+ Club (12 - 2 pm); **Friday 11th:** Learmount Walking Group (10.30 am).

Dates for your diary: The following classes will resume on Monday 14th September: Ladies & Men's Yoga Classes in Park Hall; Time for Me Ladies (10.30 - 12.30 pm), Evening Art Class (7.30 - 9.30 pm). Saturday 19th September: Family Fun afternoon in Park with In Your Space Circus. Tai Chi sessions: Wednesday 23rd September. Booking is essential for classes: Tel 028 7778 1881 / WhatsApp 077 5111 8656 / DM / email: admin@learmountgroup.org

Glenshane House, Dungiven: A Free 4-week Family History Programme starts on Tuesday 22nd September from 6.30-9.30 pm. Topics - Local Roots; American Roots; Life in Ireland and the American Journey. It will also show how to research genealogical records. To book, tel. 028 7774 2494.

Host for Hospice: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more information, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com.

The Parish Webcams are now available to view on the Firestick. If you search for the iTech Media App and download it to your Firestick, you can then search for the Church.

PARISH CLERGY

Fr. Dermot McGirr, P.P.

42 Glenedra Road, Feeny, BT47 4TW

Tel: 028 7778 1223 Email: banagherparish@derrydiocese.org

CONTACT US

To arrange a Baptism, Wedding or Anniversary Mass, please call Fr. Dermot or the secretaries on 028 7778 1223 or email banagherparish@derrydiocese.org.

Parish Office opening hours next week: Monday to Friday: 9.30am - 12.30pm.

Mass is Live on the Webcam at www.banagherparish.com
SVP Confidential Helpline: 075 9395 4973

Bellaghy Parish Office: info@bellaghyparish.com 02879386259/ 07703444280

Office hours: Mon, Wed & Thurs 9am—3pm, Fri 8am—11am.

Office closed Tuesday. Website: www.bellaghyparish.com

St Vincent de Paul 07508549588

Greenlough Parish Office: greenloughparish@gmail.com Tel: 02825821190

Website: www.greenlough.com

HOST FOR HOSPICE: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! **To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com**

Human Life International Ireland: Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tues 29 Sep at 6:45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

Job Opportunity: Derry Diocesan Trust - Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish: Sacristan, hours of work: 12 hours per week. Rate of Pay : £12.88 per hour. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12noon on Tues 15 Sep 2026. *Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.*

St Ergnat's GAC— Lotto No's: 6, 7, 17, 20. £30 each to Sinead McCoy & Ross Donnelly. **Jackpot £5,000.00.**

St Malachy's GAC— Lotto No's: 8, 9, 15, 21. £25 each to Ronan Rafferty & Ethan Johnson. **Jackpot £2,000.00**

Bellaghy GAA: O'Neill Academy of Irish Dance- Class will resume Thurs 10 Sep at 6.30 pm. All new members welcome

St Mary's, Bellaghy / St Joseph's, Ballyscullion. 6 September 2026 Twenty-Third Sunday in Ordinary Time.

From 1 September until 4 October (The Feast of St Francis of Assisi) we are in the Season of Creation, an initiative of the late Pope Francis. The theme this year is: "Living Water."

As well as using the gift of water carefully and sparingly, we are invited to pray for the many billions of people in today's world who cannot take fresh, running water for granted.

Pope Leo asks us to think about the "deserts inside us, in our hearts" and to pray that the Lord will renew our hearts, moving us from "desert to garden, from division to communion, from violence to peace.

We are invited to pray for all those who will be taking part in World Youth Day in Seoul, South Korea, next year, that they will take courage, and become streams of "Living Water", bringing faith, hope, love, and care for creation into the life of the Church and the world.

Let us pray together.

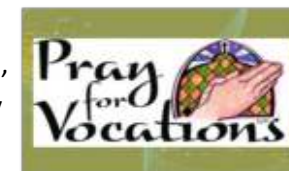
Let us act together.

Let us make space for conversion.

Let us make Living Water flow.

This coming Friday, 11 September, a bill on Assisted Suicide is due to be debated in Westminster. Anyone who is opposed to such legislation passing into law is asked to write to their local MP to ask him/her to vote against it. If you wish to do that you will find postcards in the churches on which you can write your name and address and send it to Cathal Mallaghan, the MP for Mid-Ulster.

We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.



September Schedules:

St Mary's:

Readers: 11.00am: Madeline Scullion

Weekdays: Mon: M Scullion **Wed:** A Scott

Church Cleaners: Maria McMullan & Tracy McErlean

Stewards: 11am: Bernard McKenna & Patrick McKenna.

Altar Society: Marie Glancy.

Volunteers Needed.

We still need more people to help with the cleaning of the Church.

If you are willing to help please contact Sally-Ann or Fr Pat 02879386259.

St Joseph's:

Eucharistic Minister: Dolores McErlean

Reader: Neil Duffin **Collector:** Danny Duffin

Altar Society: Barbara Carey

Deaths: We offer our sympathy to the family of **Manus McShane (Ballyscullion Lane), Jacqueline Madden (Belfast) and Eamon Downey (Dunloy/Ballynease)** who died recently.

Anniversaries:

5/6: Ann Loughlin (Anniversary Mass at 11am), James Gilmore (Anniversary Mass at 11am), Michael Hendry, Joe Hughes, Eddie Friel, Peter McGurk, Róisín Campbell, Alexander McKeown, Seamus Larkin, James O'Kane, Aisling Wohihan, Brendan Kearney, Mary Graham, Willie Mullan, James Pollock.

Sat/Sun 12/13: Bridget Murphy (Month's Mind at 11am), Hugh Scullion (Anniversary Mass at 11am), Michael McCloskey, Willy McErlean, Markie Higgins. *May they rest in peace.*

Last week's Collection: £1,982.00 **Thank you.**



St. Mary's, Bellaghy:

Mon 7, 9.30am

Adoration, Friday, 10am—8pm (Rosary, 7.30pm)

Sat, 5.30pm (Streamed from Greenlough)

Sun, 11am (Streamed to Greenlough)

St. Oliver Plunkett, Clady:

Tues 8, 9.30am (Rosary: 7.30pm)

Thurs 10, 7.30pm.

Adoration, Thursday, 9am—5pm.

Sat, Vigil, 5.30pm (Streamed to Bellaghy)

Sun, 11am (Streamed from Bellaghy)

St. Joseph's, Ballyscullion: Sun, 9.45am.



The **Funeral Mass** for **Gregory McErlean** who died recently in the USA will take place in St Joseph's Church, at 11am on Saturday 12 September, with the burial of ashes afterwards in Ballyscullion Cemetery.

Legion Of Mary: Wednesday at 6.15pm in the Prayer Room of St Mary's Church. All are welcome.



BAPTISM DATES: JULY—DECEMBER

BELLAGHY

Sep 26, 1pm
Oct 10, 1pm
Nov 7, 1pm
Dec 5, 1pm

GREENLOUGH

Sep 13, 12.30pm
Oct 24, 4.15pm
Nov 28, 4.15pm
Dec 19, 4.15pm

Buncrana Parish Newsletter ST. MARY'S HALL & CINEMA

Last week's collection totalled €4,840. We gratefully acknowledge a donation of €60 towards the Garden Fete. <i>Sincere thanks.</i>		Priest on Call 074 9361253		Fr Bradley 936455 Fr Walsh 9361393 Fr Baker 9360151 Parish Office 9361253 Parish Catechist 086 785 3726		PARISH DRAW		BUNCRANA CINEMA See all show times www.thecinemabuncrana.com			BINGO						
Anniversary Masses & Times		Twenty-Third Sunday in Ordinary Time 6 September 2026				Friday 21August: Week 10 1st Prize: €500 Celia Brady, Doonwood Promoter: Dolores O'Connor 2nd Prize: €300 Kathleen Gubbins c/o Promoter Promoter: Bernadette Gallagher 3rd Prize: €150 Lorena McGrory, Mulberry Promoter: Bridget Hepper		Holy Days 12A 100mins Saturday 5th Sept - 8:15pm Sunday 6th - 5:15pm		Cars 20th Anniver-sary G 120mins Saturday 5th Sept - 5pm Sunday 6th - 3pm		An Cailín Ciúin (The Quiet Girl) 2022 12A 95mins Sunday 6th Sept - 8:15pm		NATIONAL CINEMA WEEKEND 5th & 6th September All Seats €4		St Mary's Hall Fridays at 8pm Single book €11 Double €17 Snowball: €5150	
Community Corner																	
ST MARY'S ORATORY Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/buncrana Monday 7 Sep - Mass at 10am Aodhan McCallum (MM), plus John and Bridie Duffy Tuesday 8 Sept - Mass at 10am Legion Of Mary Wednesday 9 Sept - Mass at 10am Frank Doherty (Cuey) Thursday 10 Sept - Mass at 10am Special Intention Saturday 12 Sept - Mass at 4:30pm Pa Deeney (1st A) Sunday 13 Sept - Mass at 8:30am Sunday 13 Sept - Mass at 12:30pm Maura Cutliffe (5th A), plus Hugh O'Donnell (6th A)								CONFIRMATION 2027 The Bishop's Office have informed us that Bishop Michael Router will celebrate the Sacrament of Confirmation on Saturday 13 22March 2027 at 10:30am in St Mary's Oratory: Scoil Íosagáin 2:30pm in St Mary's, Cockhill: St Oran's NS, Scoil Naomh Iosáf, Scoil Naomh Pádraig, and St Egney's NS. <i>Please note: The date for Gaelscoil Bhun Cranncha Confirmation will be forthcoming.</i>								ADORATION CHAPEL Please consider spending an hour in the Adoration Chapel Sunday 2pm - 10pm Monday - Wednesday 6am - 10pm Friday 6am - 10pm	
St. MARY'S, COCKHILL Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/cockhill Friday 11 Sept - Mass at 7pm Tommy Cuffe (1st A) Sunday 13 Sept - Mass at 11am								EQUESTRIAN ORDER OF THE HOLY SEPULCHRE OF JERUSALEM The EOHSJ Order is a Catholic Order under the protection of the Holy See, dedicated to supporting the Latin Patriarchate of Jerusalem and the Christian communities of the Holy Land. The Holy Land is the land of the Gospel, but it is also home to Christian families, schools, parishes and communities who need prayer, solidarity and practical support today. Help sustain the living Christian presence in the Holy Land by becoming a Friend of the Order . Friends of the Order offers a simple way to help by providing support for Catholic schools and teachers; parishes, churches, seminaries and religious communities; healthcare, homes for the elderly and humanitarian aid; Projects in Jerusalem, Bethlehem, Gaza, Jordan, Galilee and the West Bank, and more. Friends are not members of the Order but are people of goodwill who wish to support this mission through prayer, awareness and charitable giving. 100% of Friends' donations go directly to approved Holy Land needs, without administrative deductions. To learn more or become a Friend: Website: holysepulchre.ie/friends Facebook: EOHSJ Ireland Email: friends@holysepulchre.ie Phone: 086 3253882 <i>Together, we can help ensure Christianity continues to flourish in the land where Our Lord lived, died and rose again.</i>								GUIDED HOLY HOUR The Holy Hour in honour of the Holy Face of Jesus continues this Sunday at 6pm in St Mary's Oratory. All Welcome.	
STAR OF THE SEA, DESERTEGNEY Masses streamed on www.youtube.com/@BuncranaParish Sunday 13 Sept - Mass at 9:45am								ROSARY The Rosary is said in the Oratory at 9.30am before Mass Monday to Thursday.								LEGION OF MARY Pilgrimage to Knock on Sun 27 Sept leaving from Buncrana. For more details contact Mary on 0862145405 or Vera on 0863084935. DONEGAL GROUP 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Sat 26th Sept in the Church of the Irish Martyrs, Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown, Diocese of Derry, and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes. ANAM CARA Donegal, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold its monthly Face to Face Parent Support Evening for bereaved parents on Thur 10th Sept at 7.30pm in the Raddison Blu Hotel, Letterkenny F92 FK15. ALZHEIMERS SOCIETY CHURCH GATE COLLECTION on the weekend of 12th and 13th September THE IRISH CANCER SOCIETY is seeking compassionate volunteer drivers to join our pool of drivers. As a volunteer driver you would be bringing patients undergoing chemotherapy to the hospital and back home for their treatment. Gifting your time means that cancer patients will have comfortable (one on one) transport to attend appointments for their lifesaving treatment. If you can spare 2 days per month, have a valid driving licence, and a safe, reliable vehicle, you are the perfect candidate to make a significant difference. The Irish Cancer Society will provide you with training before you start as a driver for us. Your generosity not only eases the journey for many during a challenging time but also offers comfort and support when it's needed most. For more info and to become a volunteer driver, please contact Monica or Emily at volunteer@irishcancer.ie THE PRIORY INSTITUTE provides online Theology courses to degree level. Attend Saturday lectures in Tallaght or from the comfort of your own home. Register now to begin on 19 Sept. Find out more on www.prioryinstitute.com	
BAPTISMS We welcome into God's Family the following children who were recently baptised: Cillian Martin Kelly William Eóghan McKeever Patrick Henry O'Donnell Aoife Rose Porter <i>May God guide and protect our children always.</i>								ROSARY ON THE COAST Sunday 6 Sept at 3pm at Lisfannon Beach. All welcome.								OUR LADY OF FATIMA Our Lady of Fatima appealed for the Holy Rosary to be said every day, especially for peace in the world. On Sun 13 September we remember the 109th anniversary of the apparitions in Fatima. You are invited to join us on that evening for the recitation of the Rosary at the Oratory Grotto at 7:15pm immediately after the Guided Holy Hour.	
DEATH Your prayers are asked for Liam McLaughlin (Strain) who died recently and for his family and friends saddened by their loss.								BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOTORCYCLES takes place on Sun 13 Sept in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt at 1:30pm. All welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.								COCKHILL TEMPORARY CLOSURE St Mary's Cockhill will be closed from Monday 7 Sept until 6 :15pm on Friday 11 September to facilitate painting work. We apologise for any inconvenience.	
PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.								SEASON OF CREATION 2026 The Season of Creation takes place from 1 Sept to 4 Oct, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, <i>Living Water</i> , invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation. <i>'St Francis of Assisi reminds us that our common home (the Earth) is like a sister with whom we share our life and a beautiful mother who opens her arms to embrace us.'</i> (Pope Francis: LS 1)									
SICK VISITATIONS Fr Bradley will visit the sick and housebound in his care on Wed 9 Sept in the town areas, and on Thurs 10 Sept in the country areas.								DIVINE MERCY DEVOTIONS will take place on Fri 11 September at 6.15pm in St. Mary's Church, Cockhill, followed by Mass at 7pm. All Welcome									
RTE MASS There will be Mass at 7:30am in St Mary's Oratory on Tues 8 Sept which will then be broadcast on RTE News at 10:30am. All welcome.								READINGS FOR 23RD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME 1st Reading: Ez 33:7-9. Ezekiel (600 BC), was primarily a visionary. As both prophet and priest, he lived during the destruction of Jerusalem and the subsequent deportations to Babylon (modern day Iraq). His prophecies were an important preparation for Christ, The Saviour is viewed as a shepherd rather than as a 'king', whose gift will be a new heart and new spirit. Following Ezekiel we must do our utmost to correct our brother, both individually and collectively. 2nd Reading: Rm 13:8-10. We have to learn to help and to heal each other. Loving our neighbour as ourselves, the new law brought by Christ, is the one thing that cannot hurt anyone. Gospel: Mt. 18:15-20. This teaching complements the one about the shepherd (Jesus) going after his one lost sheep. His communities will imitate the shepherd in caring for everyone, providing fraternal correction where necessary. Jesus will never abandon them.									
PRIVACY NOTICE: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mary's Oratory and St Mary's Cockhill are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online in St Mary's Oratory and the first seven rows of seats are visible in St Mary's Cockhill.																	

**Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Twenty-Third Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 6th September 2026**

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (Matthew 18:15-20)

In today's gospel, Jesus teaches that reconciliation is a sacred responsibility rooted in love, humility and a desire for restored relationship. When conflict or hurt arises, the first response should not be anger, gossip, avoidance or revenge, but a quiet and honest conversation with the person involved. This private dialogue gives space for listening, understanding and healing. If the conflict cannot be resolved alone, Jesus encourages the involvement of trusted witnesses, not to shame or accuse, but to help guide the conversation with wisdom, fairness and care. When difficulties continue, the wider community has a role in encouraging accountability, unity and peace.

This message can be remembered through the word **LOVE**:

Listen with humility,

Offer reconciliation,

Value community, and

Embrace divine presence.

Love calls us to hear one another deeply, choose restoration over pride, protect unity, and trust that God is present wherever people gather in faith, prayer, forgiveness, and harmony. Overall, Jesus reminds us that love is more than a feeling; it is a way of living. Through patience, courage, humility, and faith, conflict can become an opportunity for healing, forgiveness, and renewed fellowship.

***May the peace of Christ guide our hearts, strengthen our unity, and
fill our community with love, forgiveness and grace. Amen.***

A Time of Prayer and Reflection in Honour of St Pio will take place in our pastoral area from Saturday 19th September until Wednesday 23rd September. At this time we invite people to simply take time aside from their busy schedules to invoke the intercession of St Pio on individuals, families, and parish community. At this time of year when schools / colleges reopen and many people return to work, it is good to think about our own faith commitment.



At our Masses on the weekend of 19/20th September, a reflection on the life of St Pio will be offered. Mon 21st / Tues 22nd / Wed 23rd, we will celebrate together an early morning Mass in each of our churches and again, Mass at 10.00 am with an evening devotion at 7.00 pm. So too, an opportunity for reflection. Specific times and places will be confirmed next week.

On **Wednesday 23rd September**, the Feast Day of St Pio, Bishop Michael Router will celebrate Mass at **7.00 pm** in St Patrick's Church, Murlog. This is a prayerful opportunity to welcome Bishop Michael to our diocese and to our pastoral area.

Eucharistic Adoration takes place on **Wednesday** from **8.30 am - 5.30 pm** in **Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road**.

Eucharistic Adoration will resume in **St Patrick's, Murlog** on **Monday 7th September** from **10.30 am - 1.00 pm**. Everyone welcome.

Sick and Housebound Fr McCaughey hopes to visit the sick and housebound through the coming week as follows:

Monday and Wednesday: Leckpatrick and Strabane

Tuesday: Lifford.

We pray for all who are sick and housebound at this time and for those who accompany them.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of Eamonn McNulty, Ballyduff Pk, Lifford

Conor Woods, Lisnafin Pk, Strabane

Teresa Madden, Glenview Pk, Strabane

Aiden Dunne, Townsend St, Strabane

Anniversaries Jackie Bjourson, Margaret Crotty, Anthony Diver, Hugh Duncan, Sarah Huston-Richmond, Gerard Kearney, Billy Kelly, Lena Kelly, Patrick Joseph Kelly, Patrick McAleer, Bobby McBride, Robert McClay Jnr, Reece McColgan, Danny McDaid, Mariah McElwee, Frances McElwee-Gallagher, Simsey McFarland, Detta McKane, Betty Montague, Johnnie Montague, Patrick Murray, Robert Porter, Mary Anne McCloskey. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:

Leckpatrick: £949.28(offertory), £453.55 (renovation)

Clonleigh: €1,558.64

Camus: £1,653.65 (offertory), £738 (restoration).

Thanks also to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 13th September:

1st Reading: Sirach 27:30-28:7

Psalms: 102:1-4, 9-12

2nd Reading: Romans 14:7-9

Gospel: Matthew 18:21-35

Saints of The Coming Week:

Tuesday: Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Wednesday: St Ciaran of Clonmacnoise

Thursday: St Peter Claver

Saturday: St Ailbe, The Most Holy Name of Mary

St Patrick's Hall, Strabane We wish to acknowledge all those who continue to use the facilities at St Patrick's Hall. The hall serves our community and creates opportunity for so many people. Throughout the years the hall has been used for various purposes including celebrations to mark special occasions and also reflects so much talent from all age groups. Sadly too, in circumstances of death, the hall has offered hospitality to families. Many of these events have been supported by our local caterers. We thank everyone for their ongoing support. The hall is an important community facility. However, in terms of insurance and safeguarding, proper booking procedures need to

be in place so as to ensure the safety of all those who use this facility. We ask that those who wish to use the hall for any planned event to please contact Sinead (Parish Administrator) at the pastoral office, or speak with Brian (Caretaker) at the hall so as to complete the necessary documentation for insurance and safeguarding requirements, and to clarify any queries. We thank everyone for their cooperation and understanding in regard to these matters. It is important to maintain good practices for the continuing safe use of the hall as it is a valuable community facility. We thank people for their support through the years.

Legion of Mary An urgent appeal for new members to join us. Role includes visitation of nursing homes, promotion of the rosary with the pilgrim statue and weekly meetings. Time commitment of approx 3 hrs per week. Meeting on Thursday mornings at 11 am in St Pat's Hall. Please contact Margaret Harte: 028 71883159.

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles on Sunday 13th September at 1.30 pm in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt. Following blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present a donation to RNLI. Mass will be celebrated on 13th September at 11.30 am in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN for deceased bikers. All welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meetings resume on Monday 7th September at 8.00 pm in the Pastoral Office, 27 Butcher Street, Strabane. Everyone welcome.

Vocations Society of St Joseph St John Vianney branch meets on Tues 8th September in Immaculate Conception Church with rosary after 10am Mass. All welcome.

Pray for Vocations We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world. Visit: <https://derryvocations.org>

St Joseph's Men's Camino A Day of pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal on Sat 12th Sept. Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, the 25km guided pilgrimage along the beautiful Boyne Valley is open to all men aged 18+. Cost €65/€55 (incl lunch/dinner). Visit www.dominicans.ie

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day today (Sunday) at Termonbacca, Derry, beginning with the National Mass at 2.00 pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. Email info@catholicmothers.ie

Host for Hospice October is Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please contact Ailbhe, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice: 028 71359888 or ailbhe@foylehospice.com

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) parish. 12 hrs per week. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hour. Contact recruitment@derrydiocese.org / 028 71262302. Closing 15/ 9/26.

Human Life International Ireland Fr L Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at Canal Court Hotel, Newry on 29th Sept at 6:45pm with 1st class relic of St Thérèse.

Season of Creation During this Season of Creation, Pope Leo invites us to turn our attention to one of the most essential gifts for life: water. Let us pray that we may learn to manage water with justice and responsibility, protecting it as a common good and ensuring that everyone has equitable access to it.

Strabane / Leckpatrick Draw August 2026

Prize	Winner	Promoter
£2,000	Robert Coyle	Marian Cooke
£1,000	Jacqueline Donaghey	Sadie Kerlin
£500	Sean Devine	Maisie Boggs
£500	Bernie & Joan	Nuala Kerr
£250	Ryan Clarke	Maura Coyle
£250	Pat Timoney	John Devine
£100	Eileen Devine	Gabrielle Dooher
£100	Margaret Kavanagh	Paul Mullen
£100	Martina Murray	Fr Michael
£100	Colm Clarke	Maura Coyle
£100	Celine Ward	Ann McCrory

Congratulations to all the winners. Thank you for your support.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four in St Pat's Hall on Thursdays at 8 pm.
Some fun, excitement and slight competition.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Course The next course is on 20th/21st November at Ebrington Hotel, Derry. Booking online www.accordni.com

Lough Derg Day Retreats September 9, 12, 15, 19, 20 - a day of prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal. Visit www.loughderg.org All welcome.

Porter School of Irish Dancing Classes resume on Monday 7th Sept at Lifford Resource Centre. Registration is now open. Classes available for 4 year olds and over. Teachers fully qualified and garda vetted. To register your interest, please call 0044 7515525499 or visit facebook page: Porter School of Irish Dance.

Rosary on the Coast takes place today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm at Lisfannon Beach, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn babies. Everyone welcome.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: 8.30 am (6th Sept - alternate Sundays - 20th Sept)

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: 8.30 am (13th Sept - alternate Sundays - 27th Sept)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes.

Office hours: Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm.

Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at

marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.

Cappagh PARISH NEWS

30th August 2026

St Mary's Killyclogher, St Mary's Knockmoyle, Corpus Christi Mountfield, Christ The King Strathroy

MASS SCHEDULE

St. Mary's Church, Killyclogher

Sunday Mass: 9am & 11:15am

Daily Mass: 10am: Mon, Tues, Wed & Thurs

Christ the King Church, Strathroy

Sunday Mass: 12noon

Vigil: 7pm

Evening Mass: 7:30pm: Tues

St. Mary's Church, Killyclogher

Daily Rosary: 9:10am: Mon-Saturday

Legion of Mary: Every Monday after 10am Mass

Corpus Christi Church, Mountfield

Rosary: Commence mid-September

Christ the King Church, Strathroy

Confessions: 6:15pm-6.45pm: Saturday



SEASON OF CREATION

The Season of Creation takes place from 1st September to 4th October, Bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home.

This years theme, "Living Water", invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

Back to School Prayer

Dear Lord,

As our students begin a new school year, I pray that you will keep them in your care.

Send your Spirit to open their minds to all that is true and beautiful and good.

Help them to see the gifts and talents You have given them and to use them well.

Help them to grow in knowledge and wisdom.

Help them to be kind to others and lead others to be kind to them.

Give their teachers patience and understanding, and help them teach what is just and true.

Send your angels to guide and guard our children and to keep them from all harm.

Open their young hearts to your presence and enfold them in your peace and protection.

Hold them in the palm of your hand and bring them home safely at day's end.

Amen



PARISH OFFICE OPENING HOURS: MONDAY –THURSDAY: 9AM-5PM (closed 1-1.30pm)

Contact: Phone 028 8224 3375 or Email info@cappaghparish.com

Anniversary Mass Bookings: Please note that a Requiem Mass takes precedence and therefore your booking is subject to change.

WATCH MASS LIVE ON THE PARISH WEBCAM: www.cappaghparish.com

Webcam live streams only. The recording of services broadcast on the webcam ***must be requested in advance*** by contacting the parish office on 028 8224 3375 or speaking with the priest (outside of office opening hours)

FR KEVIN McELHENNON P.P: 028 8225 8108 / k.mcelhennon@derrydiocese.org

FR MALACHY GALLAGHER C.C: 028 8225 1055 / malachy.gallagher@derrydiocese.org

SVP CTK : 07738838066

SVP KC : 07738837992



Sacred Heart Church

Carndonagh

5th & 6th September 2026 (23rd Sunday Ordinary Time)

Mass Times

Friday	7.00 pm
Saturday Vigil	7.00 pm
Sunday	9.00 am & 11 am

Baptism

Saturday	6.00 pm
Sunday	12.00 noon

Rosary

Sunday	6.30pm
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Deaths: We wish to express our deepest sympathy to the families and friends of Teresa McLaughlin, Carrick, her funeral Mass took place on Sunday & Shauna Hennigan, Ballyloskey, her funeral Mass took place on Saturday.

Anniversary and Month's Mind Masses

Fri 11 th Sept	Kathleen Ruddy, Ballyloskey (1 st Anniv) 7pm
Sat 12 th Sept	Jimmy Diver, Whitehouse (1 st Anniv) 7pm
Sun 13 th Sept	Anne Doyle, Benduff, (4 th Anniv) 9am
Mon 14 th Sept	Patricia McCallion, Magherarnett, (3 rd Anniv) 10am
Tue 15 th Sept	Liam Monagle, Ballyliffin 10am
Fri 18 th Sept	Jim Reid, Drimdoo (Month's Mind) 7pm
Sat 19 th Sept	Brian McLaughlin, Lenamore (1 st Anniv) 7pm
Sun 20 th Sept	iFrank Harkin, Ard Colgan, (2 nd Anniv) 9 am

Anniversaries at this time

Patrick McCauley, Ard Colgan, Danny Doherty (Newman), Ballyloskey and Mary Doherty, Glenmakee.

Fr Con will visit the sick in his care on Thursday 10th Sept.

PARISH DRAW RETURNS are due on Tuesday 8th Sept at 7 pm in the parish office

Weekly Collection amounted to €2,900.39 & Stg £101.707

Thank you for your generosity.

Good As New for Church funds will be re-opening on Monday 7th September. All washed and clean donations are welcome. Tel. Bernie on 0861734977 or Don on 0868554796.

VOCATIONS: We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

Anam Cara Donegal, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold its monthly Face to Face Parent Support Evening for bereaved parents on Thursday 10th September 2026 at 7.30pm in the Raddison Blu Hotel, Letterkenny F92 FK15. This event is free and open to all bereaved parents regardless of the age of their child, the circumstances of their death, or how recent their death was. There is no need for registration, this is a walk in meeting. We also offer online support group meetings. To find out more call 01 4045378 or email info@anamcara.ie

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26th September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeowan Diocese of Derry and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

Masses and Baptisms: If you wish to book Masses or Baptisms please call into the Sacristy before or after any Masses or telephone **0860577273**. Parish Office, Macartan's, Carndonagh, Co. Donegal. Tel:(074)9374104
Email:sacredheartchurchcarn@gmail.com

SUNDAY 6 SEPTEMBER 2026

Twenty Third Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:

Aghyaran ♦ Ardstraw West & Castlederg ♦ Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

Parish websites (*including access to church webcams*) and emails:

Aghyaran: Website: parishofaghyaran.com Email: aghyaranparish@derrydiocese.org

Drumquin: Website: drumquinparish.com Email: drumquin@derrydiocese.org

Ardstraw West & Castlederg: Web: castledergparish.com Email: castledergparish@derrydiocese.org

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:

Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 7 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 8 Sept	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 9 Sept	Liturgy of the Word, With Holy Communion	Liturgy of the Word, With Holy Communion	Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 10 Sept	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 11 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	
Saturday 12 Sept	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 13 Sept	Mass on first and third Sunday	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am Drumnabey, 12.30pm	Mass on first and third Sunday

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £877 & €51. Church Restoration Fund: £773 & €522.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,018 & €79, made up of:

Castlederg £1,147 & €46, Drumnabey £483 & €36, Dregish £388 & €10. **DRUMQUIN:** £877.

UNLOCKING THE MYSTERIES OF THE BIBLE: As published last week, we had intended to start this eight-week course in the coming week. Unfortunately, the resources that we need for the programme will not be available until the end of September. We will keep you posted with a new start-date as soon as we have the materials. Apologies for the inconvenience.



We pray for the happy repose of the soul of Evelyn Baxter, Castlefin Park, whose Funeral Mass took place in Castlederg on Thursday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to Evelyn's family and to all who mourn her death. May she rest in peace.

CONGRATULATIONS to the winners in the Ardstraw West and Castlederg Monthly Draw for Parish Development, which took place in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, on Sunday 30 August:

£1,000 Eunan Carlin (1118) Promoter's Prize: Sylvia McHugh
£500 Lynn Gallen (13)
£250 (x 3) May Browne (16); Michael Lynch (677); Alicia McCrory (220)
£100 (x 7) Mary McGlinchey (918); Eugene Carlin (557); Michael Gallen (194); Frank & Geraldine Gallen (1027); Patrick McHugh (600); Michelle McDougall (832); Fr Patsy Arkinson (678).

As always, thanks to our wonderful team of promoters and to all who are supporting our Parish Appeal by taking part in the draw. Returns for September's draw should be made to the Parochial House on Thursday 17 September between 6.00 and 7.30pm. The next draw will take place on Sunday 27 September 2026 in St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg.

There is a small number of tickets left – if you are not in the draw but would like to join, talk to the promoter in your area or contact Kathleen in the Parish Office. If you're not in, you can't win!

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Monday 7 Sept – Drumquin - Rural Area only: Tattysallagh Road / Dooish Road / Glen Road / Bradan Road / Sloughan Road / Drumscrew Road, commencing at 11.00am - Fr Thomas.

Wednesday 9 Sept – Castlederg Rural Area, Oakleigh Grove, Main Street and Derg Fold, commencing at 3.00pm - Fr Thomas.

Thursday 10 Sept – Young Crescent and Drumnabey, commencing at 10.30am – Fr Paul.

Friday 11 Sept – Town Area – (excluding Oakleigh Grove, Derg Fold & Main Street), commencing 10.30am – Fr Paul.

BLESSING OF STUDENTS: A special Mass to mark the beginning of the school year for both Primary and Secondary school pupils will be celebrated on Saturday 12 September at 7.30pm in St. Patrick's Church Aghyaran.

Blessing of school bags for those starting school will take place at this Mass. We encourage families to come along and young children beginning school are asked to bring their school bag with them, as we ask God's blessing on all of them and their work in the new year ahead.

PRAYER:

Lord, we thank you for your goodness to all your children,
Be with these children throughout this new school year.
May your blessing be upon these school bags which the children will carry to and from school each day.
Watch over the children in their coming and their going.
Keep them safe always; help them to be kind; bless their learning and their play.
Enfold them at all times in your love. We pray through Christ our Lord. AMEN

LEGION OF MARY Meetings will resume in Drumquin Parochial House this Thursday, 10 September, commencing at 7.30pm. New members are very welcome to come along to this short time prayer and reflections.

RISE AND SHINE TRUST – Easter 2027 Pilgrimage: Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11-30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with Rise and Shine Trust. The trip is free to Guests. Application form available on riseandshine.ie. Closing date 15 October. Applications also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests. Applications at riseandshine.ie Visit www.riseandshine.ie or contact Sian (07960211352) or Maurice (07711504821).

ARANDERG CCÉ Irish Traditional Music Sessions have started back on Friday nights at 9.00pm in Killeter Heritage. Everyone is welcome! We are holding a **registration night** tomorrow, Mon 7 September, for parents to register their child for upcoming music lessons, in Banjo, Fiddle, Accordion and Tin whistle. Lessons are £30 for 6 weeks, with payment required on registration night. Call in any time between 7.00 – 8.00pm to register or if you have any questions.

IRISH DANCING resumes on **Tuesday 8 September**, at **6.00pm** in **Drumquin Community Youth Centre**. New beginners P1 and above are welcome to join. Text / call Dolores on 07739631478.

ZUMBA FITNESS with Vanessa is back for September – Tuesday 8 September at 7.00pm in Garvagh Hall and Wednesday 9 September at 7.00pm in St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg. No experience needed, no perfect moves required, no pressure. Any questions or queries, contact Vanessa on 077 0235 5424

YOGA CLASS: Aghyaran Development Association in conjunction with HARC is commencing a 6-week Yogo class for over 50's in Aghyaran Centre, commencing Tues 15 September, 11.30am - 12.30pm. Contact Jerry on 078 6492 9344.

HOST FOR HOSPICE: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

Season of Creation 2026: 1 September to 4 October

The annual celebration of Season of Creation aims to bring Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation. The theme is inspired by the vision of hope and renewal found in the Book of Ezekiel, 47:9: "Wherever the river flows, every living creature that swarms will live... and everything will live where the river goes."

NEWSLETTER 6/9/26

CRAIGBANE NO 10AM MASS ON SUNDAY . Fr O Kane's Retirement Event. Craighbane's event to mark Fr O Kane's retirement will be held on Sunday 6th September in Craighbane at 4pm. Mass will be celebrated in Craighbane Chapel followed by a salad tea and concert in Craighbane Hall. **Admission to the Hall event will be by ticket only.**

SICK IN CLAUDY WILL BE VISITED Monday 7th and Tuesday 8th September.

FR O'KANE'S RETIREMENT MASS - Fr O'Kane wishes to thank all parishioners who attended his retirement Mass and celebration refreshments. Thank you to all the Claudy Committee members for their work in organising the event. Thank you most sincerely to everyone who contributed towards the very generous gifts which I received and for helping me celebrate this very special occasion with my family.

THANK YOU We would like to thank all the local businesses and all those parishioners who contributed so generously to Fr O'Kane's Retirement Celebration. A special word of thanks to all who helped with the catering and organisation of the event, on this joyous yet heart rendering occasion Fr. O'Kane's Retirement Committee. The Mass has been recorded and is available to view online please go to <https://www.mcn.live/Camera/saint-patricks-claudy> scroll down to the bottom of the page to "recordings of past events" and click on Sunday 30/8/26

SINGLE KEY found in Craighbane Chapel. Is available for collection in the sacristy in Craighbane.

ST PATRICKS CHURCH CLAUDY; The Rosary will be prayed on parish webcam from Monday - Thursday at 6pm. Divine mercy chaplet and Divine Office (Midday Prayer) will be prayed from Monday - Friday at 3pm. Devotion to the Holy Face of Jesus & Divine Office (Evening Prayer) will be prayed every Friday at 6pm.

The Children's Rosary will be prayed on Saturday 12th September at 2pm, new Families welcome.

ST PATRICKS CHURCH CLAUDY; Experience the power of Sacred reading every Thursday at 7pm. Come join our weekly Scripture group as we prayerfully read, meditate on and reflect on the upcoming Sunday Gospel. All Are Welcome.

CHURCH GATE COLLECTION WILL BE HELD IN BOTH CHURCHES ON Saturday 26th and Sunday 27th September for Rise and Shine trust, (Formerly Known as Irish Pilgrimage Trust,,) The Trust takes young people with Additional needs to Lourdes every Easter for a week of ,Prayer, Fun Laughter and making great friendships and memories

ROSARY ON THE COAST Sunday 6th September at 3pm on Lisfannon Beach.

LEARMOUNT COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT GROUP (PARK):Week commencing Monday 7th September: *Monday 7th Sept:* Dementia Social Group: (11 am - 1 pm); *Tuesday 8th Sept:* Men's Hobby Workshop (10.30 am - 12.30 pm); Advice NW (2 - 4 pm); Funky Feet Kids dance class (5 - 6 pm); Slow Sewing (7 - 9 pm); *Thursday 10th Sept:* Post Office Outreach Service (9 am - 12 pm); Painting for Pleasure (10.30 am - 12.30 pm); Park 60+ Club (12 - 2 pm); *Friday 11th Sept:* Learmount Walking Group (10.30 am).

Dates for your diary: *The following classes resume on Monday 14th September: Ladies & Men's Yoga Classes in Park Hall; Time for Me Ladies (10.30 - 12.30 pm), Evening Art Class (7.30 - 9.30 pm). Saturday 19th September: Family Fun afternoon in Park with In Your Space Circus. Tai Chi sessions: Wednesday 23rd September. Booking is essential for classes: Tel 02877781881 / WhatsApp 07751118656 / DM / email: admin@learmountgroup.org*

VOLUNTEERS FOR SEPTEMBER Claudy Sat vigil 6.30pm

Eucharistic Ministers: Pauline McAlinden FB, John O'Hagan Ft, Elaine McKenna GB, Donna McNicholl GT. **Sunday 11.30am** Una Kelly FB, Pauline O'Neill Ft, Gerard Smyth GB, Erin Donaghy GT. **Readers Claudy Sat vigil 6.30pm** Rosemary O'Kane. **Sunday 11.30am** Sophie Holmes. **Readers Craibbane** - Shauna Mullan. **Eucharistic Ministers Craibbane** Anne Cooke, Leanne Caldwell

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

JOB OPPORTUNITY: Derry Diocesan Trust - Granaghan (Swatragh)

Parish: Sacristan, hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St John the Baptist Church. Rate of Pay : £12.88 per hour. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12noon on Tuesday 15 September 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Anam Cara Donegal, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold it's monthly Face to Face Parent Support

Evening for bereaved parents on Thursday 10th September 2026 at 7.30pm in the Raddison Blu Hotel, Letterkenny F92 FK15.

This event is free and open to all bereaved parents regardless of the age of their child, the circumstances of their death, or how recent their death was. There is no need for registration, this is a walk in meeting.

We also offer online support group meetings. To find out more call 01 4045378 or email info@anamcara.ie

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust)

are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26th September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal Mc Keown Diocese of Derry and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

HOST FOR HOSPICE: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

VOCATIONS We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

MICHAEL ENGLISH CHURCH CONCERT: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Season of Creation 2026: The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

WEEKLY COLLECTION was: £2,237 thank you for your continuing contribution.

PRAY FOR THE ANNIVERSARY OF Christine McIvor, Elizabeth Devine, Tommy Nicholas, Jeannie Woods, Sean Burke, Philip Crossan, Mary Dempsey

PRAY FOR THE SOUL OF John Mullan buried in Craigbane on Tuesday. We pray for the Mullan family at this time. May he Rest in Peace.

Anniversary/Month's Mind Masses Sunday 13th September at 10am in Craigbane for Annie McQuillan. Sunday 13th September at 11.30am in Claudy for John Devine. Sunday 20th September at 10am in Craigbane for Willie John Gormley. Friday 25th September at 7.30pm in Craigbane for Month's Mind Mass for John Mullan. Sunday 27th September at 10am in Craigbane for James Cartin. Sunday 27th September at 11.30am in Claudy for James Devine.

ROSARY FOR 1ST ANNIVERSARIES SEPTEMBER - held in St Patrick's Church, Claudy at 6pm Thursday 17th September for Fr Michael Keaveney. Thursday 24th September for Patrick Enright.

Safeguarding Notice: If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children or adults at Risk of Harm within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane

the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 07596500793 or email dlp@derrydiocese.org. or ring PSNI on 101 or Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust on 028 71314090 and ask for the Duty Social Worker or Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust on 028 9442 4459 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Services on 0800 1979 995

Saint Vincent De Paul Helpline Telephone Number: 0751 820 8132

PLEASE NOTE THERE IS A NEW LINK TO MCN MEDIA -Our live streaming web address has been updated. To access MCN Media, please go to **<https://www.mcn.live/Camera/saint-patricks-claudy>** on your web browser. To watch Mass on our Parish website there will be no change everything remains the same. **please note the first 2 seats in the centre aisle are visible on the webcam. St Patrick's Church, Claudy is now monitored by CCTV cameras inside and outside the Church. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the Parish Website and Church notice board**

Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick

Twenty-Third Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 6th September 2026

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (*Matthew 18:15-20*)

In today's gospel, Jesus teaches that reconciliation is a sacred responsibility rooted in love, humility and a desire for restored relationship. When conflict or hurt arises, the first response should not be anger, gossip, avoidance or revenge, but a quiet and honest conversation with the person involved. This private dialogue gives space for listening, understanding and healing. If the conflict cannot be resolved alone, Jesus encourages the involvement of trusted witnesses, not to shame or accuse, but to help guide the conversation with wisdom, fairness and care. When difficulties continue, the wider community has a role in encouraging accountability, unity and peace.

This message can be remembered through the word **LOVE:**

Listen with humility,

Offer reconciliation,

Value community, and

Embrace divine presence.

Love calls us to hear one another deeply, choose restoration over pride, protect unity, and trust that God is present wherever people gather in faith, prayer, forgiveness, and harmony. Overall, Jesus reminds us that love is more than a feeling; it is a way of living. Through patience, courage, humility, and faith, conflict can become an opportunity for healing, forgiveness, and renewed fellowship.

May the peace of Christ guide our hearts, strengthen our unity, and fill our community with love, forgiveness and grace. Amen.

A Time of Prayer and Reflection in Honour of St Pio will take place in our pastoral area from Saturday 19th September until Wednesday

23rd September. At this time we invite people to simply take time aside from their busy schedules to invoke the intercession of St Pio on individuals, families, and parish community. At this time of year when schools / colleges reopen and many people return to work, it is good to think about our own faith commitment.

At our Masses on the weekend of 19/20th September, a reflection on the life of St Pio will be offered. Mon 21st / Tues 22nd / Wed 23rd, we will celebrate together an early morning Mass in each of our churches and again, Mass at 10.00 am with an evening devotion at 7.00 pm. So too, an opportunity for reflection. Specific times and places will be confirmed next week.

On **Wednesday 23rd September**, the Feast Day of St Pio, Bishop Michael Router will celebrate Mass at **7.00 pm** in St Patrick's Church, Murlog. This is a prayerful opportunity to welcome Bishop Michael to our diocese and to our pastoral area.

Eucharistic Adoration takes place on **Wednesday** from **8.30 am – 5.30 pm** in **Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road.**

Eucharistic Adoration will resume in **St Patrick's, Murlog** on **Monday 7th September** from **10.30 am – 1.00 pm**. Everyone welcome.

Sick and Housebound Fr McCaughey hopes to visit the sick and housebound through the coming week as follows:

Monday and Wednesday: Leckpatrick and Strabane

Tuesday: Lifford.

We pray for all who are sick and housebound at this time and for those who accompany them.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of Eamonn McNulty, Ballyduff Pk, Lifford

Conor Woods, Lisnafin Pk, Strabane

Teresa Madden, Glenview Pk, Strabane

Aiden Dunne, Townsend St, Strabane

Anniversaries Jackie Bjourson, Margaret Crotty, Anthony Diver, Hugh Duncan, Sarah Huston-Richmond, Gerard Kearney, Billy Kelly, Lena Kelly, Patrick Joseph Kelly, Patrick McAleer, Bobby McBride, Robert McClay Jnr, Reece McColgan, Danny McDaid, Mariah McElwee, Frances McElwee-Gallagher, Simsey McFarland, Detta McKane, Betty Montague, Johnnie Montague, Patrick Murray, Robert Porter, Mary Anne McCloskey.

May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:

Leckpatrick: £949.28(offertory), £453.55 (renovation)

Clonleigh: €1,558.64

Camus: £1,653.65 (offertory), £738 (restoration).

Thanks also to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 13th September:

1st Reading: Sirach 27:30-28:7

Psalm: 102:1-4, 9-12

2nd Reading: Romans 14:7-9

Gospel: Matthew 18:21-35

Saints of The Coming Week:

Tuesday: Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Wednesday: St Ciaran of Clonmacnoise

Thursday: St Peter Claver

Saturday: St Ailbe, The Most Holy Name of Mary

St Patrick's Hall, Strabane We wish to acknowledge all those who continue to use the facilities at St Patrick's Hall. The hall serves our community and creates opportunity for so many people. Throughout the years the hall has been used for various purposes including celebrations to mark special occasions and also reflects so much talent from all age groups. Sadly too, in circumstances of death, the hall

has offered hospitality to families. Many of these events have been supported by our local caterers. We thank everyone for their ongoing support. The hall is an important community facility. However, in terms of insurance and safeguarding, proper booking procedures need to be in place so as to ensure the safety of all those who use this facility. We ask that those who wish to use the hall for any planned event to please contact Sinead (Parish Administrator) at the pastoral office, or speak with Brian (Caretaker) at the hall so as to complete the necessary documentation for insurance and safeguarding requirements, and to clarify any queries. We thank everyone for their cooperation and understanding in regard to these matters. It is important to maintain good practices for the continuing safe use of the hall as it is a valuable community facility. We thank people for their support through the years.

Legion of Mary An urgent appeal for new members to join us. Role includes visitation of nursing homes, promotion of the rosary with the pilgrim statue and weekly meetings. Time commitment of approx 3 hrs per week. Meeting on Thursday mornings at 11 am in St Pat's Hall. Please contact Margaret Harte: 028 71883159.

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles on Sunday 13th September at 1.30 pm in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt. Following blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present a donation to RNLI. Mass will be celebrated on 13th September at 11.30 am in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN for deceased bikers. All welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meetings resume on Monday 7th September at 8.00 pm in the Pastoral Office, 27 Butcher Street, Strabane. Everyone welcome.

Vocations Society of St Joseph St John Vianney branch meets on Tues 8th September in Immaculate Conception Church with rosary after 10am Mass. All welcome.

Pray for Vocations We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world. Visit: <https://derryvocations.org>

St Joseph's Men's Camino A Day of pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal on Sat 12th Sept. Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, the 25km guided pilgrimage along the beautiful Boyne Valley is open to all men aged 18+. Cost €65/€55 (incl lunch/dinner). Visit www.dominicans.ie

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day today (Sunday) at Termonbacca, Derry, beginning with the National Mass at 2.00 pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. Email info@catholicmothers.ie

Host for Hospice October is Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on – it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please contact Ailbhe, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice: 028 71359888 or ailbhe@foylehospice.com

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) parish. 12 hrs per week. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hour. Contact recruitment@derrydiocese.org / 028 71262302. Closing 15/ 9/26.

Human Life International Ireland Fr L Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at Canal Court Hotel, Newry on 29th Sept at 6:45pm with 1st class relic of St Thérèse.

Season of Creation During this Season of Creation, Pope Leo invites us to turn our attention to one of the most essential gifts for life: water. Let us pray that we may learn to manage water with justice and responsibility, protecting it as a common good and ensuring that everyone has equitable access to it.

Strabane / Leckpatrick Draw August 2026

Prize	Winner	Promoter
£2,000	Robert Coyle	Marian Cooke
£1,000	Jacqueline Donaghey	Sadie Kerlin
£500	Sean Devine	Maisie Boggs
£500	Bernie & Joan	Nuala Kerr
£250	Ryan Clarke	Maura Coyle
£250	Pat Timoney	John Devine
£100	Eileen Devine	Gabrielle Dooher
£100	Margaret Kavanagh	Paul Mullen
£100	Martina Murray	Fr Michael
£100	Colm Clarke	Maura Coyle

Congratulations to all the winners. Thank you for your support.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four in St Pat's Hall on Thursdays at 8 pm.

Some fun, excitement and slight competition.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Course The next course is on 20th/21st November at Ebrington Hotel, Derry. Booking online www.accordni.com

Lough Derg Day Retreats September 9, 12, 15, 19, 20 – a day of prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal. Visit www.loughderg.org All welcome.

Porter School of Irish Dancing Classes resume on Monday 7th Sept at Lifford Resource Centre. Registration is now open. Classes available for 4 year olds and over. Teachers fully qualified and garda vetted. To register your interest, please call 0044 7515525499 or visit facebook page: Porter School of Irish Dance.

Rosary on the Coast takes place today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm at Lisfannon Beach, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn babies. Everyone welcome.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: 12.15 pm

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: 6.30 pm; Sunday: 9.45 am

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: 8.30 am (6th Sept – alternate Sundays – 20th Sept)

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: 8.30 am (13th Sept – alternate Sundays – 27th Sept)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: 10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: 10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: 8.00 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes.

Office hours: Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am – 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am – 12.30 pm. Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.



clonmanyparish.ie

PARISH MASS AND PRAYER SCHEDULE

ST MARY’S CHURCH, CLONMANY

- Monday—Thursday 9:30am Mass
- Friday 7:30pm—Confessions from 7pm
- Saturday 6:30pm V Mass—Confessions from 6pm
- Sunday 11:30am
- Wednesday: *Exposition of The Blessed Sacrament 2:30pm—3:30pm in the room behind the Sanctuary*

ST MICHAEL’S CHURCH, URRIS

- Sunday: 10am Mass
- Friday: *Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament 3-6pm*

ORATORY OF THE ASSUMPTION, BALLYLIFFIN

- Tuesday: *Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament 7:30—8:30pm*

MASS INTENTIONS THIS WEEKEND

6:30pm V Mass—Marion Fagan-Grant, Ballyliffin & Dublin
10:00am Mass—Sarah McGonigle, Roxtown
11:30am Mass—Philomena & Charlie McGonigle, Cloontagh.

ANNIVERSARY

Teresa Conaghan, Letter

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS

6:30pm Vigil Mass in St Mary’s Church next Saturday Sept 12 will be offered for John Doherty, Tirmaine, on the first anniversary of his death. May he rest in peace.

SAINTS OF THE WEEK

Tuesday: The Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary
Wednesday: St Ciaran. Thursday: St Peter Claver
Saturday: The Holy Name of Mary & St Ailbe, Bishop

VISITATION OF THE SICK

Fr Haan will attend the sick and housebound in his care on Tuesday Sept 8—starting after 9:30am Mass.

LEGION OF MARY

Bus trip to Knock of Sunday Sept 27— Contact James on 086 1256357.

COLLECTION

Parish collection last weekend amounted to 2,251. Thank you for your generosity.

VOCATIONS

We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

VOCATIONS SOCIETY OF ST JOSEPH

Meeting in St Mary’s Hall on Mon Sept 7 at 7pm. New members always welcome. (Praying for vocations)

ROSARY

The Rosary continues on Wednesday at 8:30pm at the Grotto in St Mary’s Church, Clonmany— All welcome as we pray for peace.



Clonmany Parish Newsletter



Fr John McDevitt PP Tel 0749376273 or 085 8237119

Fr Karl Haan CC Tel 0749379107

Parish Office Tel 0749376114 Email: clonmanyparish1@outlook.com

COELIAC HOSTS

The Parish has purchased a new pyx for coeliac hosts which clips onto the main ciborium keeping the coeliac hosts separate from other hosts. Next weekend we will start to use this pyx. The priest / Eucharistic minister will change hands when distributing from it, so that there will be no transfer of fragments from the other hosts. People who are coeliacs are now invited to receive Holy Communion like the whole congregation and the table in the sanctuary area will be removed. Thank you for your continued support.



Irish Cancer Society

HOST FOR HOSPICE

October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us

raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it’s at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it’s a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

VOLUNTEER SUPPORT

The Irish Cancer Society is seeking compassionate volunteer drivers to join our pool of drivers. As a volunteer driver you would be bringing patients undergoing chemotherapy to the hospital and back home for their treatment. Gifting your time means that cancer patients will have comfortable (one on one) transport to attend appointments for their lifesaving treatment.

If you can spare 2 days per month, have a valid driving licence, and a safe, reliable vehicle, you are the perfect candidate to make a significant difference. The Irish Cancer Society will provide you with training before you start as a driver for us. Your generosity not only eases the journey for many during a challenging time but also offers comfort and support when it's needed most.

For more information and to become a volunteer driver, please contact Monica or Emily at volunteer@irishcancer.ie

The feedback we receive from patients that have relied on the Transport Service in the past is heart-warming and underlines the need of its existence. We would be extremely grateful for your support, as it will help us to continue supporting those who are impacted by cancer.

HEARING LOSS? Earache? Blocked ears? It could just be wax. Inishowen Medical can help with that. We can offer both our patients and non-patients microsuction. Microsuction is a newer and more patient friendly way of clearing wax from ears. It is considered comfortable for the patient and can be used in every ear, even if there is a history of perforations. The fee is €60 for all patients including medical card & GP Visit card holders. Call Inishowen Medical to make an appointment 074 93 61800 or 074 76173.

NOWDOC—6pm Friday—8am Monday—Call 0818400911



WE REMEMBER AT THIS TIME...

Every life matters. This month we remember in prayer those who feel they have no option but to end it all. Holy Spirit, give us a gentle nudge when someone around us is struggling, and give us wisdom to know what to say, when to say it, and when to simply be present. Help us to notice, to listen without judgement, and to offer kindness, compassion and hope.

For those contemplating suicide, Lord, give them a reason to live. Show them that their life has value, they are loved, and their story is not over. Bless them with hope for the life they have yet to live and place the right people around them in their darkest moments. Amen!

CHURCH GATE COLLECTION

Annual collection for Down Syndrome which was taken up recently amounted to €1,299 & £10. Sincere thanks to all who contributed.

CLONMANY TUG-O-WAR GROUP

Will hold their AGM on Friday September 18 in Clonmany Tug-of-war clubhouse at 8pm. All welcome.

CLONMANY SHAMROCKS NEWS

Lotto Numbers on 27/08/2026—05,15,22,28. No jackpot winner.
€20: Sally Kelly, Gaddyduff; Carol Ivers, Dunaff; Michael Devlin, Tulagh. Next draw on Sept 3—Jackpot €15,000.
Results: Aug 30—Clubman Shirts League Cup: Greencastle FC 2 Clonmany Shamrocks 11
Inishowen Eng. Div 2: Carrowmena 3 Clonmany Res 4
Fixtures: Sept 6—Clubman Shirts League Cup: Clonmany Shamrocks v Buncrana Hearts at 2pm.
Inishowen Eng. Div 2: Cockhill Colts v Clonmany Res 11am
August 200 Club Draw winners—1st Prize €1000: No.71= Dominic & Margaret O'Neill, Rasharkin. 2nd Prize €500: No.96= Daniel McGonigle, Cloontagh. Five prizes of €100: No. 169 James Hegarty, No. 53 Shaun Harkin, No. 3 Rosemary Quinn, No. 60 Kathleen & John Joe Doherty, No.122 . Amanda Friel & Patrick Doherty.
Congratulations to all our winners & good luck to everyone in the September draw.

SLIABH SNEACHT CENTRE NOTES

Weekly drop in Craft Class starts back this Wednesday Sept 9.
Oil Painting Art Class starting on Sept 24 from 7-9pm—8 week course and costs €80, which includes a small starter kit. To book 0749361742

BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOTORCYCLES

Next Sun Sept 13 in St Aengus’ Chapel, Burt, at 1:30. All are welcome. Mass on Sun Sept 13 in St Patrick’s Chapel, Dungiven, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.



‘For where two or three are gathered in my name, I shall be there with them’.

There is a real value of coming together in faith, even if it is only two people, because in doing so we create a space for the Lord to be present. This saying of Jesus is one that gives tremendous value to all our gatherings, especially our gatherings for prayer, no matter how small those gatherings are. Whenever the Lord is present in our midst, he is not there in a passive way. His presence is always an active, lifegiving, transforming presence. There is a great deal going on when even two gather in the Lord’s name. There is so much more happening than just the physical coming together of people. The Lord is at work in their midst. We need never underestimate the value of our gatherings or their power to transform, no matter how small they are.



Living Water
Season of Creation 2026

IMMERSION IN LIVING WATER

Ezekiel 47:9, 12

Creation is God’s work. Before humanity was, the rest of creation came into being. The earth and her creatures—indeed the whole cosmos—have beauty, dignity, and meaning before human presence. So to nurture awe at the wonder of creation is part of our calling. Look up into the skies, walk in the fields, stand at the ocean’s edge. Everything belongs, everything has beauty! The garden is such an insightful model for our care of creation. Our call is to be good gardeners, thoughtful, alert and diligent, working with the soil and with the rhythm of the seasons, caring for the creatures who find home and shelter in the garden.

Culdaff
Fr John McDevitt P.P. 9376273 / 0858237119

Fr. Karl Haan C.C. 9379107
www.culdaffparish.com
email: culdaffnotes@gmail.com

Daily Mass
Monday 7.30 pm; **Tuesday & Wednesday**, 10 am
[Blessed Sacrament Exposition after 10 am Mass until 2 pm]; **Thursday**, 7.30 pm; **Friday** 10 am; **Saturday** 11am

Confessions Before Saturday nights Mass, 7.30 – 7.50
Saturday Vigil 8 pm
Sunday 10 am.

Anniversary Mass this weekend
Saturday, 8 pm : Mary Mc Conalogue, Cashel
Sunday, 10 am James Doherty, The Cottages, Gleneely
Next Weekend
Saturday Vigil 8 pm Yvonne Scott, Cloncha

Fr McDevitt will attend the sick of the Parish on Tuesday this week. If you would like to be visited, please contact the Parochial House.

Weekly Offering €765
Development Collection €240

Retired Priests Collection will be taken up next weekend.

We acknowledge the receipt of €120 from the Whist Club
Envelopes can be left in McGuinness' shop.

First Reading
Ezekiel 33:7-9
The Son of Man is appointed as guardian of Israel.
Second Reading
Romans 13:8-10
The Law is summarized in the commandment to love your neighbour as yourself.
Gospel Reading
Matthew 18:15-20
Jesus teaches his disciples how to settle disputes in the Church.



VOCATIONS We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

Season of Creation 2026: The Season of Creation

takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

CULDAFF TIDY TOWNS This year's annual Culdaff Craft Fair will take place on Sunday 15 November from 2-5pm in the Wee Hall Culdaff. Afternoon teas served and a draw for valuable prizes will take place.
For more information and bookings contact Philomena on 0868418189.

Tea/Coffee after 10 am Mass next Sunday. Everyone welcome.



Whist Winners

1st Margaret Mc Gilloway
2nd Rose Thompson
Joint 3rd Bridget Mc Cauley
Mary B Mc Laughlin
Mary Quigley

Tickets

Gerard Doherty
Kathleen Mc Donald
John Doherty

Other Winners

Fr Jim Mc Gonigle
Patrick Mc Laughlin
Charlie Doherty
Mary Quigley
John Doherty



HOST FOR HOSPICE: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

Anam Cara Donegal, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold it's monthly Face to Face Parent Support Evening for bereaved parents on **Thursday 10th September 2026 at 7.30pm in the Raddison Blu Hotel, Letterkenny F92 FK15.**

This event is free and open to all bereaved parents regardless of the age of their child, the circumstances of their death, or how recent their death was. There is no need for registration, this is a walk in meeting.

We also offer online support group meetings. To find out more call

01 4045378 or email info@anamcara.ie

The Deep End: Made for each other

by *Triona Doherty*

'Turning the front door knob, it came to him that maybe he could sponge away the look of loneliness that he'd seen in Susan's eyes – and John was now pretty sure it was loneliness he'd seen, despite the smiles and the confidences. If he'd learned one thing while he'd been away, it was that loneliness and the open discussion of loneliness is the most taboo subject in the world. Forget sex or politics or religion. Or even failure. Loneliness is what clears out a room' – Douglas Coupland, *Miss Wyoming*. Many of us have experienced loneliness at one time or another. We hear a lot of talk these days about a modern sense of loneliness and isolation, in spite of advancements in mobile technology and the growth of online communities. Yet relationships are at the heart of who we are as human beings. The Gospel of Matthew begins and ends with reassurances that we are not alone. At the beginning we are told the one who is coming will be called Emmanuel, meaning 'God is with us', and it concludes with the words of Jesus 'I am with you always, to the very end of the age'. And here in the middle we have Jesus' assurance: 'Where two or three meet in my name, I shall be there with them.' Today's Gospel speaks to us about relationships, and lets us know that God is with us in and through our relationships with other people – when we gather in his name, he is there too.

Greencastle Centre - The Computer Clinic 4 weeks IT Support Course starting 15th September 6-8pm.
- Strike A Chord after-school youth music project starting Tuesday 22nd September 4-6pm food and transport provided.
- Dungeons & Dragons returning soon.
- Knitting Club every Tuesday 11am – 1pm.

The Men's Shed Carn is also hosting **"DROP IN WEDNESDAYS"** for men every Wednesday from 11 am - 1 pm. Pop in for a coffee and a chat and see what we do here at the shed, a place to connect, learn and create. Bring a friend, meet new people. All ages welcome

POINTS TO PONDER - In many ways, we are keepers of our sisters and brothers. We have social responsibility in family and in neighbourhood. Jesus is saying something like that today. We have a responsibility for each other, for the common good. Parents may find this most difficult – to try to guide the family well and not lose them. We teach by example and by love. Even when children are young and making some mistakes, we hope they are not mistakes that last forever, like crime, alcoholism or an unplanned life-changing moment. We pray to God for help. This we do with others. We ask for guidance and find help in the community of the church and of others. That's where God is – two or three gathered is the community of God. Church is the gathered people. God wants the best for each of us. We can help each other to goodness, we can support each other, correct each other, and help each other on our way to God.

Jesus promises guidance and his presence to his followers for all ages. If we gather in his name, he is with us. The 'in his name' is the relevant condition. That means openness to his word and the traditions faithfully handed on by his community of followers. It means openness to asking for wisdom and guidance and the humility to admit none of us has all the answers.

<http://www.culdaffparish.com>
Discerning God's voice in the midst of tensions

The submissions to the Irish Synodal Pathway reveal a Church in motion, a community grappling with its identity, grieving its wounds, and reaching for new life. What emerges is not a tidy consensus, but a Spirit-led ferment. There are cries for belonging, tensions over inclusion, and the hopes for deeper formation and shared mission.

There were those who felt that engagement with contemporary society, especially young people, required recognition of the reality of changed attitudes to sexuality and sexual identity, while others emphasised the importance of maintaining the integrity of authentic church teaching in these areas.

There were divergences with regard to the legacy of abuse in the Church. For some, a failure to acknowledge fully the suffering of victims and survivors and 'to own our broken past' as a precondition for renewal would contradict and undermine the life-affirming message of the Gospel; for others, while acknowledging the need for accountability and vigilance, there was a perceived risk of distracting from other tasks of renewal and mission.

There was frustration that liturgical forms and language constituted a barrier to engagement and participation, while others expressed the view that the integrity and beauty of the liturgy should be valued for their capacity to attract and engage

Carrowmenagh Community Centre Tel 074 93 67061

Our all-age social club, **The Tuesday Club**, returns on Tuesday 15th September from 2-4pm. Join us for a relaxed and enjoyable afternoon with a range of activities, including cards, bingo, Scrabble and other board games, knitting and crochet, or simply a chance to enjoy a chat and make new friends. Everyone is very welcome. Cost is €5, including afternoon tea. We have lots of great **courses** coming up for the autumn including Spanish conversation and culture, beauty therapy, plumbing and heating, phone photography, dressmaking and alterations, creative painting, guitar lessons, tablet and smartphone for beginners, creative crafts, digital skills for farmers and internet skills level 3. Contact the Centre for more information and to book.

Our Lady of Lourdes Steelstown



Sunday 6 September
23rd Sunday Of The Year

Creation is God's work. Before humanity was, the rest of creation came into being. The earth and her creatures – indeed the whole cosmos – have beauty, dignity and meaning before human presence.

So to nurture awe at the wonder of creation is part of our calling. Look up into the skies, walk in the fields, stand at the ocean's edge. Everything belongs, everything has beauty! The garden is such an insightful model for our care of creation.. Our call is to be good gardeners, thoughtful, alert and diligent, working with the soil and with the rhythm of the seasons, caring for the creatures who find home and shelter in the garden.

Ian Adams



SAFEGUARDING NOTICE

If you have any concerns with regard to Safeguarding children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O’Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at +447596 500 793 or at dlp@derrydiocese.org. For emergencies please contact PSNI Tel 101 or Social Services Western HSC Trust Tel +442871314090 (Ask for Duty Social Worker).

Additional contact numbers:

Northern Ireland: PSNI Tel 101 or Social Services Western HSC Trust Tel +442871314090 (Ask for Duty Social Worker)

Republic of Ireland: Garda Siochana, Buncrana +353749320540 or Letterkenny HQ +353749167100 TUSLA Family and Child Agency, Buncrana +353749320420 or Letterkenny +353749123672.



COUPLES PLANNING TO GET MARRIED

If you live in this parish and plan to marry here or in another Catholic Church then you require marriage papers from this parish. You must give at least three months notice of your intention to marry. The following documentation will be required: a recent copy of your Baptism Certificate from the Parish of your Baptism; and possibly a letter of freedom.

All couples are required to prepare for the Sacrament of Marriage. Accord offers marriage preparation and can be contacted at 71362475 or online www.accord-ni.co.uk. Places available on the November 20th/21st course. This course is in person and Venue: Everglades Hotel Derry.

All couples living in this Parish and planning to marry here or elsewhere are please asked to contact the parish office to make arrangements for the completion of the paperwork.



BOOKSTAND

There is a variety of books and cards on sale at the back of the Church.

Signed Mass cards and various Mass bouquet cards are also available from the Parochial House during office hours.

PARISH OFFICE

The Parish Office is open between 9am and 3pm Wednesday to Friday.

Please bring Passport Application Forms, make requests for Baptismal Certificates etc during office hours.

Please do not bring forms to the Parochial House on Sundays.

SEASON OF CREATION 2026 The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, Living Water, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOTORCYCLES Will take place next Sunday, 13 September, in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1.30pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, Dungiven, at 11.30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

DONEGAL GROUP 173 RISE AND SHINE TRUST (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26 September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown Diocese of Derry and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

HOST FOR HOSPICE October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your free host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

NOT DEAD YET UK have provided postcards you can send to your MP to ask them to vote NO to assisted suicide in the vote in the House of Commons on 11 September. Please take action now - collect a red and white postcard, fill out your details, add a stamp and post it to your MP today!

HLI IRELAND Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29 September at 6.45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

POPE'S PRAYER INTENTION FOR SEPTEMBER

For the care of water

Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.

Our Lady of Lourdes Steelstown



OFFICE: Wednesdays to Fridays: 9am to 3pm
Tel: 028 7135 1718
Email: steelstown@derrydiocese.org
culmoreparish@derrydiocese.org

PRIEST: Rev. Declan McGeehan
Email: declan.mcgeeahan@derrydiocese.org
Emergency Tel.: 073 5238 7817 (*urgent sick calls only*)

MASS TIMES:
Sunday: 09:00am; 11:00am and 12:15pm
Monday: 07:45am; 7:00pm
Tuesday - Thursday: 07:45am and 10:00am
Friday: 07:45am
Saturday: 10:00am; **Vigil Mass:** 6:30pm

CONFESSIONS:
Sunday: 09:45am - 10:50am
Monday: 6:30pm - 6:55pm
Tuesday: 08:10am - 08:30am
Thursday: 09:30am - 09:55am
Saturday: 10:30am-11:30am; &, 5:45pm - 6:20pm

ANNIVERSARIES

Please pray for the repose of the souls of:
May Doherty; Tom Casey; Noah Karran;
Kevin Johnston; Megan Tyre;
Mary McDevitt; Kevin McDevitt;
Rita Nelis; Paddy Nelis;
Roseleen Meenan and William Falconer.

COLLECTION

Last Sunday's Collection amounted to £3,655.00.
Thank you for your generosity.

RETIRED PRIEST'S COLLECTION

Will be taken up at all Masses next weekend, 12/13 September.
There is a special envelope in your collection envelope box.

SACRAMENT OF MARRIAGE

We congratulate Tiegán and Sean who recently celebrated the sacrament of marriage here in Our Lady of Lourdes, Steelstown.

ANNIVERSARY AND MONTH'S MIND MASSES

To book a Mass for an anniversary or month's mind please contact the parish office by telephone on 02871 351718 or by email at steelstown@derrydiocese.org.

The daytime Masses will only be offered for one intention but the evening Masses, Monday at 7pm and Saturday 6.30pm, can be offered for more than one intention.

VOCATIONS

Anyone interested in serving the diocese of Derry as a priest should contact their local priest(s) and/or the diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, PP, Bellaghy, at pgoh2111@gmail.com.

Monday 7th September – 10.30am – St Johns Sacristy

SUNDAY 6 SEPTEMBER 2026

Twenty Third Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:

Aghyaran ♦ Ardstraw West & Castlederg ♦ Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

Parish Office: Parochial House, 16 Castlefin Road, Castlederg, BT81 7BT. Tel: 028 816 71393

Parish websites (*including access to church webcams*) and emails:

Aghyaran: Website: parishofaghyaran.com Email: aghyaranparish@derrydiocese.org

Drumquin: Website: drumquinparish.com Email: drumquin@derrydiocese.org

Ardstraw West & Castlederg: Web: castledergparish.com Email: castledergparish@derrydiocese.org

DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING DESIGNATED LIAISON PERSON:

Ms Marie O'Kane – Telephone 07596500793 Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 7 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 8 Sept	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 9 Sept	Liturgy of the Word, With Holy Communion	Liturgy of the Word, With Holy Communion	Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 10 Sept	Mass, 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon		
Friday 11 Sept		Mass, Castlederg: 10.00am, followed by Adoration until 12.00noon	
Saturday 12 Sept	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 13 Sept	Mass on first and third Sunday	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Castlederg, 11.00am Drumnabey, 12.30pm	Mass on first and third Sunday

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £877 & €51. **Church Restoration Fund:** £773 & €522.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,018 & €79, made up of:

Castlederg £1,147 & €46, Drumnabey £483 & €36, Dregish £388 & €10. **DRUMQUIN:** £877.

UNLOCKING THE MYSTERIES OF THE BIBLE: As published last week, we had intended to start this eight-week course in the coming week. Unfortunately, the resources that we need for the programme will not be available until the end of September. We will keep you posted with a new start-date as soon as we have the materials. Apologies for the inconvenience.



We pray for the happy repose of the soul of Evelyn Baxter, Castlefin Park, whose Funeral Mass took place in Castlederg on Thursday. We offer our sympathy and our prayerful support to Evelyn's family and to all who mourn her death. May she rest in peace.

CONGRATULATIONS to the winners in the Ardstraw West and Castlederg Monthly Draw for Parish Development, which took place in St Eugene's Hall, Dregish, on Sunday 30 August:

£1,000 Eunan Carlin (1118) Promoter's Prize: Sylvia McHugh
£500 Lynn Gallen (13)
£250 (x 3) May Browne (16); Michael Lynch (677); Alicia McCrory (220)
£100 (x 7) Mary McGlinchey (918); Eugene Carlin (557); Michael Gallen (194); Frank & Geraldine Gallen (1027); Patrick McHugh (600); Michelle McDougall (832); Fr Patsy Arkinson (678).

As always, thanks to our wonderful team of promoters and to all who are supporting our Parish Appeal by taking part in the draw. Returns for September's draw should be made to the Parochial House on Thursday 17 September between 6.00 and 7.30pm. The next draw will take place on Sunday 27 September 2026 in St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg.

There is a small number of tickets left – if you are not in the draw but would like to join, talk to the promoter in your area or contact Kathleen in the Parish Office. If you're not in, you can't win!

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Monday 7 Sept – Drumquin - Rural Area only: Tattysallagh Road / Dooish Road / Glen Road / Bradan Road / Sloughan Road / Drumscrew Road, commencing at 11.00am - Fr Thomas.

Wednesday 9 Sept – Castlederg Rural Area, Oakleigh Grove, Main Street and Derg Fold, commencing at 3.00pm - Fr Thomas.

Thursday 10 Sept – Young Crescent and Drumnabey, commencing at 10.30am – Fr Paul.

Friday 11 Sept – Town Area – (excluding Oakleigh Grove, Derg Fold & Main Street), commencing 10.30am – Fr Paul.

BLESSING OF STUDENTS: A special Mass to mark the beginning of the school year for both Primary and Secondary school pupils will be celebrated on Saturday 12 September at 7.30pm in St. Patrick's Church Aghyaran.

Blessing of school bags for those starting school will take place at this Mass. We encourage families to come along and young children beginning school are asked to bring their school bag with them, as we ask God's blessing on all of them and their work in the new year ahead.

PRAYER:

Lord, we thank you for your goodness to all your children,

Be with these children throughout this new school year.

May your blessing be upon these school bags which the children will carry to and from school each day.

Watch over the children in their coming and their going.

Keep them safe always; help them to be kind; bless their learning and their play.

Enfold them at all times in your love. We pray through Christ our Lord. AMEN

LEGION OF MARY Meetings will resume in Drumquin Parochial House this Thursday, 10 September, commencing at 7.30pm. New members are very welcome to come along to this short time prayer and reflections.

RISE AND SHINE TRUST – Easter 2027 Pilgrimage: Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11-30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with Rise and Shine Trust. The trip is free to Guests. Application form available on riseandshine.ie. Closing date 15 October. Applications also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests. Applications at riseandshine.ie Visit www.riseandshine.ie or contact Sian (07960211352) or Maurice (07711504821).

ARANDERG CCÉ Irish Traditional Music Sessions have started back on Friday nights at 9.00pm in Killeter Heritage. Everyone is welcome! We are holding a **registration night** tomorrow, Mon 7 September, for parents to register their child for upcoming music lessons, in Banjo, Fiddle, Accordion and Tin whistle. Lessons are £30 for 6 weeks, with payment required on registration night. Call in any time between 7.00 – 8.00pm to register or if you have any questions.

IRISH DANCING resumes on **Tuesday 8 September**, at **6.00pm** in **Drumquin Community Youth Centre**. New beginners P1 and above are welcome to join. Text / call Dolores on 07739631478.

ZUMBA FITNESS with Vanessa is back for September – Tuesday 8 September at 7.00pm in Garvagh Hall and Wednesday 9 September at 7.00pm in St Patrick's Hall, Castlederg. No experience needed, no perfect moves required, no pressure. Any questions or queries, contact Vanessa on 077 0235 5424

YOGA CLASS: Aghyaran Development Association in conjunction with HARC is commencing a 6-week Yogo class for over 50's in Aghyaran Centre, commencing Tues 15 September, 11.30am - 12.30pm. Contact Jerry on 078 6492 9344.

HOST FOR HOSPICE: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

Season of Creation 2026: 1 September to 4 October

The annual celebration of Season of Creation aims to bring Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation. The theme is inspired by the vision of hope and renewal found in the Book of Ezekiel, 47:9: "Wherever the river flows, every living creature that swarms will live... and everything will live where the river goes."

**Twenty-Third Sunday in
Ordinary Time**

6th September 2026



Parish of Drumragh

**Sacred Heart Church, Omagh
St Mary's Church, Drumragh
028 82242092**

Weekend Mass Schedule

Sacred Heart Church, Omagh

Vigil: 5.30pm

Sunday Mass: 10am & 12.30pm

St. Mary's Church, Drumragh

Sunday Mass: 10.30am

Confessions:

Sacred Heart Church: Saturday's after morning Mass unless there is a funeral.

Christ the King, Strathroy:

Saturday 6.15pm-6.45pm

Weekday Mass Times this week

10.00am Monday, Tuesday & Wednesday in St. Mary's, Killyclogher

10.00am Wed, Thurs, Fri & Sat.

in Sacred Heart Church

7.30pm Wednesday Sacred Heart
Rosary before 7.30pm Mass

**Eucharistic Adoration on
Wednesday from 10am until
6.45pm**

Heritage Open Day

Guided Tour of Sacred Heart Church on 12th & 13th September
for approximately 1 hour Time: 2pm & 3.30pm
Free Admission. All Welcome.



Fr Stephen Baxter - Our new temporary Curate

My name is Stephen Baxter and I was ordained for the Diocese of Derry on Sunday 14th June in St Columb's in the Waterside in Derry City.



I started studying for the priesthood in 2019 by attending the Scots College seminary in Salamanca, followed by studying Philosophy for two years in Maynooth then Theology for four years in Rome. Before entering seminary, I attended St Columb's College in Derry, working for six years in Stewarts and Tesco supermarkets then I worked for nineteen years as a bus driver and Inspector for Translink.

Since ordination I have been based in the Waterside helping out as required and I am now delighted to have received my first appointment to Omagh and I am looking forward to my time in your parishes and I thank Father Kevin and Father Malachy for the welcome they have given me to the parishes.

Fr Kevin McElhennon P.P: 028 8225 8108 / k.mcelhennon@derrydiocese.org

Fr Malachy Gallagher C.C: 028 8225 1055 / malachy.gallagher@derrydiocese.org

Parish Office, Omagh 028 8224 2092 / info@drumraghparish.com

Parish Office Open Mon/Tues/Thursday 9-2pm 02882242092

Parish email: info@drumraghparish.com

Sacred Heart Church Mass Intentions

Wednesday 9th September 7.30pm **Carrie Anne Browne - Month Mind**
Brendan Rodgers - 1st Anniversary
Saturday 12th September 5.30pm **Arthur Quinn - 1st Anniversary**
Sunday 13th September 10.00pm **Patricia (Pat) Daly Month Mind**

Recent Weddings

We congratulate the following
couples who were married
here recently

Laura McBride & Brandon Parke
Danielle Darcy & Ruari Haughey
May the grace of the sacrament
remain with them all their lives.

VOCATIONS

We pray for the men called to priesthood, to
the ministry of teaching and preaching in
the name of Jesus, and encouraging their
brothers and sisters to turn away from sin
and live as followers of Christ in today's
world.

Recently Deceased

Kathleen McCartan
Marie Conway
David Mullan

May they rest in peace

Eucharistic Ministers will bring
Holy Communion to the sick and
housebound next
Sunday 13th September

Season of Creation 2026: The Season of
Creation takes place from 1st September
to 4th October, bringing Christians
throughout the world together in prayer,
reflection and action for the care of our
common home. This year's theme, *Living
Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift
of water and renew our care for God's
creation.

The monthly novena devotion through the
intercession of Saint Padre Pio, starts on
**Tuesday the 8th September, in Christ
the King** Chapel in Omagh.
Rosary at 7pm followed by Holy Mass at
7.30pm.
Veneration and blessing with a relic of
Saint Padre Pio.
Pray, Hope and Don't Worry

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will
take place on Sunday 13th September in
St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at
1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief
service and blessing.

Following the blessing all are welcome to
join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station,
to present the donation to the RNLI.
Please note, Mass will be celebrated on
Sunday 13th September in St Patrick's
Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for
deceased bikers, especially those who
have died in past year.

Legion of Mary Annual Pilgrimage to
Knock on **Sunday 27th September**,
departing main st Dromore at 8.30am, fare
£25, contact Lucia on 07548870901 or call
into Top News George's street and book a
seat, please book early

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day:
Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its
Annual National Mass on Sunday, 6th
September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre,
Derry. The day will begin with Mass at
2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal
McKeown, All are welcome

BINGO in St. Joseph's Hall Tuesday 8th September at 8.30pm

Drumragh Parish Draw Winners September

<u>Winner</u>	<u>Promoter</u>
£2,000 Margaret & Mairead McKenna	Brian McKenna
£1,000 Martin Kirk	John Baxter
£500 Sally McGranaghan	Babs Barrett
£250 Carmel Reid	Attracta Kelly
£100 Terence & Ruth O'Gara	Kevin O'Gara
£100 Aoife Quinn	Raymond McNally
£100 Micky Mullan	Maggie Quinn
£100 Sinead Duncan	Gerard Lilly
£100 Patsy Grugan	Mary Quinn
£100 Michael Mallon	Raymond McNally
£100 Rosemary McCourt	Kevin Moore
£100 Paddy Nicholas	Gerard Lilly
£100 Ronald Oddy	Ronald Oddy
£100 Shane O'Neill	Gerard Lilly
£100 Promoter's Prize:	Geraldine Gallagher

Next Draw
6th October

Alzheimer's society is running a Carers Information Support

Programme (CRISP) for family, carers and friends of people living with Dementia in Omagh area. The programme is run over 2 sessions; attendees should attend both afternoons. **Dates are 7th and 8th 2026 3-5pm** In the Conference Room, Silver Birch Hotel, 5 Gortin Road, Omagh, Co Tyrone. To register please contact Julie-Anne, Senior Dementia Adviser. M:07889 604702. Registration is required prior to attendance.

SONGS FROM HOME

Come together with **Harmonise** and fellow local singers as we share Songs from Home. Participants must attend FREE five week choir practice followed by the Final Song Trail 10th October at Ulster American Folk Park. Refreshments provided.

EVERYONE WELCOME - **Contact Claire Sharkey for more details 07751371800**

Dates

September 23rd 7.30-10pm – Silverbirch Hotel
September 30th 7.30-10pm – Dromore Sports Complex
October 7th 7.30pm-9.30pm – Silverbirch Hotel

Loreto 170 Hyrox

Loreto Grammar School, Omagh, will host a special Loreto 170 Hyrox today Sunday celebrating 170 years of Loreto Education, while raising funds for Dementia NI and the new Loreto Oratory. This inclusive, fully scaled and non-timed Hyrox event will take place on school grounds and warmly welcomes current and past pupils and staff, families, friends, and the wider community to come together, reconnect, and enjoy a day centred on participation and togetherness. Anyone wishing to take part can register using the sign-up link on the Schools Facebook or Instagram. Anyone who may not be able to participate is very welcome to drop in, show support, and donate towards these two meaningful causes.

Parish email: info@drumraghparish.com

St Joseph's Hall

Mon 4.30 pm - Groogan O' Doherty School of Dancing

Tues 2.30 - 4.30pm - Colmcille Club **RESUMES ON 8TH SEPTEMBER**

Tues 8.30pm - Bingo

Wed 5.45 pm - Baxter School of Dancing

Thurs 8 pm - Bowls

Sat 2 pm - Groogan O'Doherty School of Dancing

*Booking forms and hall rates are available to
download at www.drumraghparish.com/st.joseph's hall*

West Tyrone Feis / AGM / St. Joseph's Hall, Omagh (Upstairs) Tues 8th Sept 7pm

Welcome new volunteers to join the committee and help support the running of the Feis.

If you would be interested in any section of the Feis, please come along to the A.G.M.

We would particularly welcome those with an interest in the Irish Dancing Section, as the previous secretary for this section has retired.

Killyclogher Over 50's Club

Re-Opens on Thursday 3rd September / 2pm / Killyclogher Hall

Fun, Friendship & Food! If you enjoy company in a comfortable setting, you are welcome to join the Over 50's Club. Club activities include Bingo, Knitting, Crocheting, Armchair Exercises, Monthly Tea Dances; with occasional outings and enjoyable hot meals.

Come along and see for yourself - you will be very welcome!

The Club welcomes people, over 50, from neighbouring parishes. The more – the merrier

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26th September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal Mc Keown Diocese of Derry and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Rise and Shine Trust-Easter 2027 Pilgrimage: Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11-30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with the Rise and Shine Trust. The trip is free to Guests travelling with the Group. The application form is available online on riseandshine.ie. Closing date for applications 15th October 2026.

Applications are also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests on the trip. Carers applications at riseandshine.ie

For more information, visit www.riseandshine.ie or Please feel free to contact Sian (07960211352) or Maurice (07711504821)

**DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING
REPRESENTATIVE**
Marie O'Kane DLP 07596500793
dlp@derrydiocese.org

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS:
Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

6th September 2026 Dungiven Parish Bulletin No 1859

Fr. Gerard Sweeney P.P. Tel: 777 41219.

Parish Office Tel: 777 40702. Email address

dungivenparish@derrydiocese.org

Parish Website <https://www.parishofdungiven.com>**SUNDAY MASS TIMES****Sat. 4.30 pm. - Gortnaghey****Sat. 6.00 pm. - Dungiven****Sun. 9.00 am. - Dungiven****Sun. 10.15 am. - Drumsurn****Sun. 11.30 am. - Dungiven****WEEKDAY MASS TIMES****St. Patrick's:** Mon., Tues. & Wed. 10.00 am. **Thursday 7.00 pm.** Friday 10.00 am.**FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASSES**For Brendan McManus on Sat. 12th Sept. at 4.30 pm. in the Immaculate Conception.For Mary O'Neill on Sat. 12th Sept. at 6.00 pm. in St. Patrick's.**DERRY DIOCESAN SOCIETY**The 10.00 am. Mass on Fri. 11th September in St. Patrick's will be celebrated for all deceased members of the society.**CONFESSIONS:** Will take place in St. Patrick's at 11.00 am. on Saturday.**THE ROSARY:** Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday & Friday at 9.30 am. in St. Patrick's.**LAST WEEK'S COLLECTION: £2,861.***Thank you to all who contributed.***BAPTISM** – We welcome into our Christian Community: Melah Faoltiltiarna McCormick, Rannynghlas and Noah Thor McCormick, Gelvin Road.**BAPTISM - Godparents must be over 16 years of age, one male and one female and a practicing Catholic.****CHARISMATIC PRAYER GROUP**

Meeting every Thursday at 7.30 pm. in the Emmaus Hall.

Baptisms will take place in St. Patrick's Church at 3.00 pm. *Two weeks' notice must be given for all Baptism bookings.***The Baptism Course:** Places must be booked through the Parish Office. **Next Course: Wednesday 9th September at 7.30 pm. in the Committee Room.****WEDDING BELLS** - We congratulate Shauna Campbell and Denis Doherty on the occasion of their marriage on the 3rd September 2026.**DEATHS**

We extend our sympathy to the McReynolds family circle on the death of Rosa McReynolds, Altmover Road.

To the Higgins family circle on the death of Patricia Higgins, Holmlea Park.

To the Donaghy family circle on the death of Maureen Donaghy, Station Avenue. May they rest in peace.

OUR MISSION AS CHURCHThis weekend 5th & 6th Sept. we will have the honour to welcome to our parish Sr. Orla Treacy and Sr. Noelle Corscadden from the Loreto Sisters Provincial South Sudan. Sr. Orla and Sr. Noelle will be preaching at all Masses, sharing their experience of mission work, especially in the field of education for girls and young women. Our parish, through our Mission fund will be supporting them and their School for the next five years. At the 11.30 am. Mass on Sunday morning we will present them with a cheque as part of our effort from Dungiven to help them in this vital work. After the 11.30 am. Mass, all are welcome to the Emmaus Hall (parish hall) to meet them both and have a cuppa.**BLESSING OF BIKERS & MOTORCYCLES**Next Sun. 13th Sept. in St. Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co. Donegal, at 1.30 pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point R.N.L.I station, to present the donation to the R.N.L.I. Please note! Mass will be celebrated on Sun. 13th Sept. in St Patrick's, DUNGIVEN, at 11.30 am. for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.**VOCATIONS** - We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.**VOCATIONS SOCIETY OF ST. JOSEPH**Our next meeting will take place on Tues. 8th Sept. in the committee room, after 10.00 am. Mass. *If there is a funeral it will be moved to Wednesday 9th September.***DUNGIVEN REGENERATION CLUB**Have a vacancy for P/T Admin, 6 months contract starting soon. Tel: 07759692122. 4-week yoga starting Wed. 16th Sept. @ 5.00 pm. To book Tel: 07759692122.**KEVIN LYNCH H. C.** - Lotto no's: 1, 12, 16 & 24. Lucky dip: Shea McVeigh. Jackpot: £2,175. *Bingo: Fridays 8.00 pm. in Wanes World.***ROSARY ON THE BEACH** - Today Sunday 6th Sept. at 3.00 pm. at Lisfannon Beach.**LEGION OF MARY ROSARY**Warmly invites you to join them for the Rosary on **Mon. 7th Sept. at 7.00 pm.** in Emmaus Hall. This Rosary will be offered for all pupils starting a new school year or returning to school or college, and for all teachers, classroom assistants, principals and staff.**S.V.P. HELPLINE 079 2792 9923****LEGION OF MARY**The Legion of Mary hopes to organise a Day Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine on **Sun. 27th Sept.**, subject to sufficient interest. If you would like to travel, text **Mary McKnight** on **07548 887 853**, or by leaving your name with the Parish Office. The approximate bus fare will be **£25 p. p.****DUNGIVEN LIBRARY**The Knit and Natter group will be starting on **Tuesday 8th Sept. at 11.00 am.** in the Library. The 'Plant & Play Roadshow' for children age 6+ is coming to Dungiven Library on Sat. 12th Sept. at 12 noon – 1.25 pm. Not to be missed by any children who love anything science or plant related! Booking is essential Tel: 028777 41475 or dungiven.library@librariesni.org.uk**GLENSHANE HOUSE**A Free 4-week Family History Programme starts on Tues. 22nd Sept. from 6.30 - 9.30 pm. Topics: Local Roots; American Roots; Life in Ireland and the American Journey. It will also show how to research genealogical records. To book Tel: 028 777 42494.**ACTION MENTAL HEALTH**Is running a free **Pain & Condition Management Programme** for adults aged 18+ living within the W. H. & S. C. Trust area. The programme is designed to support people living with long-term health conditions or chronic pain, providing practical strategies to help improve quality of life, manage symptoms, improve sleep, communicate effectively with healthcare professionals, and build confidence in self-management. The next programme begins on **Wed. 9th Sept.** at **Glenshane House**, and runs over six weekly sessions. For further information or to register, contact the Pain & Condition Management team at pcm@amh.org.uk or 028 6672 0673.

Twenty - Third Sunday in Ordinary Time (Year A)

Errigal Parish News - 6th September 2026

Weekday Masses: St. Mary's Church: - Monday, Tuesday, and Thursday at 10am.

St. Joseph's Church: - Wednesday at 10am.

St. Mary's Church - (Vigil): Anniversary Mass -

Anniversary Mass:

St. Joseph's Church - (Vigil) -

First Anniversary Mass - For Susan McNicholl on Sunday 6th September at 11.30am.

Saturday Vigil Mass 6pm - St. Mary's Church in September.

Eucharistic Adoration: - Adoration on Monday after morning Mass.

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Season of Creation: The Season of Creation takes place from 1st September to 4th October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. Each year, the Season of Creation proposes a theme for the Season of Creation. This year's theme, "Living Water", explores Ezekiel 47:9 and 12 as a powerful biblical vision of hope and ecological healing. Set amid exile and loss, the image of living water flowing from God's sanctuary reveals divine healing that renews land, water, biodiversity, and human responsibility towards the whole creation.

Parish Pastoral Group: The next meeting of the Parish pastoral Group will take place in the Parochial House on Tuesday 8th September at 7.30pm.

Requiescant In Pace: We extend our sympathy to the family and relatives of Anna Mc Nicholl (née McClements), 41 Tirkeeran Road who died recently.

St. Mary's - September Altar Society: Carol Ann McLaughlin, Margeret Mullan, Dolores Mullan and Kate Mullan.

St. Mary's - September Collectors - (Vigil) Barney O'Kane.

(Sunday) Philip McKeown & Fergal Bradley.

St. Joseph's - September Altar Society: Fidelma O'Kane with Sheena & Aine Diane Burns.

St. Joseph's - September Counters: Fidelma O'Kane with Sheena & Aine Diane Burns.

St. Joseph's September Collectors: (Sunday) Seamus Conway, Padhraic and Thomas Leydon.

Parish Mission: Parishioners may have heard that the parish will hold a mission in September of this year. It will be delivered by the Dominican Order. As you know it has been some time since the last Mission in the parish. Whilst members of the Parish Pastoral Group continue to organise it, it would be helpful to have a few interested individuals from each end of the parish to help with the organisation. Time commitment should not be great - a few hours between now and September and some input during the week itself. This is a great opportunity to get involved in a significant event for the parish, and if you are interested, please contact Fr. Crowley.

Parish Mission - Sunday 27th September - Friday 2nd October

Errigal SVP: Could You Spare a Little Time to Help Others? As we prepare to celebrate the Feast of St Vincent de Paul (27th September), the Errigal St Vincent de Paul (SVP) Conference need a couple of volunteers to join our local team. This is a wonderful opportunity to put your faith into action, give something back to our community, and make a real difference to the lives of local individuals and families who are struggling.

No previous experience is necessary. You will be warmly welcomed and fully supported by our local SVP Volunteers, with guidance and training provided.

If you would like to find out more, please contact us on 07563595868. We'd be delighted to hear from you. For more details, please see <https://www.svp.ie/northern-ireland/>

Baby Massage & Reflexology Classes: 6-week course starting 9th September in Ballerin. For more information or to book: diane@groundedsoles.org - 07761 054666

Errigal: Through Our Eyes - Summer Youth Photography Project: Starting Monday 6th July, all young people under 18 are invited to join Errigal: Through Our Eyes, a summer photography project. The theme is "See what matters. See where God is." This will celebrate the beauty, faith, kindness, and everyday life of our parish.

Pick up an entry form, then send up to three photos taken within the parish boundaries and a short reflection to the parish email (with parent/guardian consent for under-16s). There are 1st, 2nd and 3rd place prizes in both Primary and Secondary categories, with certificates for everyone. **Update Deadline - Please note that the closing date for entries has been postponed until the end of September. We warmly encourage all our young people to take part and share their photographs and reflections. More details will follow soon.**

Marion Hall- Bingo: Takes place on Thursday 17th September at 8.30pm. Every two weeks in the Marion Hall, Kilrea. Double Books - £20. Single Books - £10. Half Books - £5. Last House - £250.

Michael English Church Concert: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2nd October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Gift Aid/Census Cards: Can we please request the return of Gift Aid and Census cards recently circulated so that parish records can be updated during the summer months.

Rosary and Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament: Will continue the first Monday of each month. St. Joseph's Church - 7pm.

Monday Adoration Adorers: We request if you are available on Monday from after the morning Mass to participate in the rota for Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament which takes place until 2.30pm. If interested, please leave your name/contact number in the sacristy and we will follow up.

Parish Collections - Thank you. 183 boxes of envelopes in circulation.

Standing Order figures for August in brackets.

Returns (Pink/Yellow - 78 White - 56)

St. Mary's - Parish: £395 (£572) Renovation: £125 (£83)

St. Joseph's - Parish: £405 (£1092) Renovation: £450 (£865)

Ballerin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 1, 3, 5, 29. Jackpot is £2900. Lucky Dip Winner £50 - Micky Carton.

Glenullin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 4, 9, 22, 26. Jackpot £10,000. £25 winners – Fergal Kearney, Artie Henry, Kevin Mullan, Eileen Mullan, and Niall Mullan. (Ballerin)

Readers & Eucharistic Ministers

St. Mary's Church - Church Readers - 11th/12th September

Saturday Vigil - Anne O'Neill.

Sunday Morning - Paul Mullan.

If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Mary's Church, please give your name to Fr. Crowley training will be provided.

Eucharistic Ministers - 11th/12th September

Saturday Vigil - Louise Mullan & Paddy Bradley.

Sunday Morning - Lee Ann McKay & Amanda Mooney.

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Readers & Eucharistic Ministers

St. Joseph's Church - Church Readers - 11th/12th September

Saturday Vigil -

Sunday Morning - Anne McNicholl.

If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Joseph's Church, please give your name to Fr. Crowley or Mairead McNicholl (Lector Co-Ordinator), training will be provided.

Eucharistic Ministers - 11th/12th September

Saturday Vigil -

Sunday Morning – Ráicheál Mhic Noicaill & Margaret Rose Hasson.

Feasts during the Week: Tuesday - Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary: Who brought the dawn of hope and salvation to the world. She is the true Arch of the Covenant, the temple of God, because her body received the one Mediator. **Wednesday - St. Ciaran:** Was born in Roscommon around 512. He came to Clonmacnois in January 545 where he founded a monastery which was to become one of the most renowned in Europe. He died at the age of thirty-three while the monastery was still being built. **Thursday - St. Peter Claver:** Was born in Verdú, Catalonia, in 1580, a member of the Society of Jesus (Jesuits). In 1610 he was sent to Cartagena in Columbia and worked for thirty-three years among the slaves until his death in 1654. Cartagena was a flourishing centre of the slave trade, as many as 10,000 arriving each year from Africa. During a tireless ministry, he is said to have baptised more than 300,000. **Saturday - The Holy Name of Mary:** The feast was included in the Roman

Calendar in 1684 to celebrate the victory of the Turks at Vienna in 1683. Suppressed in the Calendar revision of 1969, it was restored as a optional memorial in 2022.

Diocesan Vocations: We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

For further information, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Anniversaries: It is advisable where possible to book well in advance in the case of anniversaries. These are arranged with a sacristan as the anniversary book is kept in the sacristy. Also, please indicate in the Anniversary book that the Mass is booked for the stated intention - we would appreciate an acknowledgment of the booking by email if possible. **In the case of a booked Anniversary Mass please inquire of the sacristan before the Mass begins that the Mass is offered for the intention you request.** Names to be added to the weekend anniversary list need to be added to the anniversary book by informing the sacristan - this can be done in advance of the date requested.

Parish Readers/Eucharistic Ministers: If you are unable to attend the schedule allocated to you, it would be much appreciated if you can get a replacement to step in for you. (It may be possible to exchange a rotation with another group member - there is also the opportunity to seek cover via the Whatsapp messaging facility if available to your group). I also ask Readers please to conclude the readings with - '**The Word of the Lord**' as directed in the Missalette, and not 'This is the Word of the Lord' as stated in the Lectionary. We have previously discussed this at our reader meetings.

Look out Leaflets...Are now available for children at the back of both churches in the parish focusing on the liturgy of the word each week. Enjoy!

Teach us to Pray Booklet - It can be downloaded at:
<https://www.derrydiocese.org/news/teach-us-to-pray>.

Why Sunday Matters! The Irish Catholic Bishops' Conference have published a pastoral message titled '*Why Sunday Matters*' - an invitation to reflect on Sunday Mass. To access this resource and watch a four-part video series titles Sunday Mass - 'Digging Deeper', visit at CatholicBishops.ie

TheWay.ie: Is a new digital platform set up by the Irish Bishops Conference dedicated to sharing the 'Good News' and the witness of the Catholic Church in Ireland. It is intended to help people discover the faith, live the faith and pass on the faith. It is for both seekers and followers. Follow us on Facebook, Instagram, X and YouTube.

St. Joseph's Church - A YouTube camera link is now available for services from St. Joseph's Church, Glenullin. The link can be accessed -
<https://youtube.com@parishoferrigalderry>.

The Net: As always, it features a wide variety of news, interesting and inspiring interviews, articles, and photos from parishes across the diocese. You can read the Diocesan newspaper on-line at: www.derrydiocese.org/news/categories/the-net. or a paper copy is available at the back of the church. Donations welcome.

Prayer for Peace in the Middle East: God of mercy and compassion of grace and reconciliation, pour your presence upon all your children in the Middle East: Jews, Muslims, Christians, Palestinians, and Israelis. Let hatred be turned into love, fear to trust, despair to hope, oppression to freedom, occupation to liberation. That violent encounters may be replaced by loving embraces, and peace and justice maybe experienced by all. Amen.

St. Joseph's Church: We present a dual gauge to initiative funds in our parish for the on-going costs associated with the renovation of St. Joseph's Church. The gauge on the left indicates the funds we require to complete the refurbishment. The gauge on the right reflects the loans we have received from other parishes. (Gauge also available on website and Facebook page). **Thanks - Donations to date** - Current figure £235,400.00.

Providing compassionate care at the end of life - To address the sensitive issue of compassionate care at the end of life, and in response to the need to inform the faithful of Catholic teaching on this important life issue that affects so many families, the Bishops of Ireland have published the pastoral letter: Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes. You are invited to read this letter and view the accompanying video Through the Valley, which offers personal testimonies by carers and people with terminal illness. The key message of both letter and video asserts that every person possesses inherent, infinite dignity that remains intact regardless of their circumstances. In this context, bishops strongly oppose the Oireachtas Committee's proposal to Government to legislate for assisted suicide and call on support for healthcare workers who uphold the sanctity of life. To read Freedom to Live Fully, Until Death Comes and to watch Through the Valley, visit the following link: <https://www.catholicbishops.ie/2024/06/24/bishops-statement-on-end-of-life-care-freedom-to-live-fully-until-death-comes/>

The Catholic Communications Office of the Irish Bishops Conference: Produces a five-story weekly ezine Sharing Good News that reports on stories associated with the Bishops' Conference, activities in parishes and dioceses, and that celebrates Church life generally. If you do not currently subscribe to receiving it and you wish to subscribe to receive Sharing Good News, please register your email address on <https://catholicnews.ie/newsletter/>

Errigal Hall Volunteers: For this hospitality to continue in the community, we need new volunteers to come forward and help in this voluntary service to the parish. If you are interested, please contact Melinda Robinson. If enough volunteers come forward a rota can be put in place via a WhatsApp group, so that the same people are not required at each function.

Errigal Hall: Parishioners who borrow items from the hall need to sign for their removal from the hall and when they are returned. The signing book is in the kitchen of the hall.



St. Joseph's Church: Choir Practice will take place each Tuesday at 7pm in the church. New members from Primary 4 up are very welcome. Any queries contact Roisin McIlvar [07841407154](tel:07841407154).

St. Mary's Church Choir: If you are interested in joining the choir, you are welcome to attend the practice in the church on a Wednesday evening at 7pm. Or contact any choir member.

Derry Diocesan Society (DDS): In each of the parishes of the diocese Mass is offered alternating in each parish (list at the back of each church) for deceased and living members who are registered in the society. The deceased members registered are remembered in the anniversary list for three consecutive weekends each quarter (three months). Registration is £20 and can be given to a sacristan or Fr. Crowley - please ensure name and address of the person to be enrolled is included and whether it is for a living or deceased member.

Maternity Blessing: Expectant mothers are welcome to receive a blessing in any of the sacristies following Mass - and a prayer card for their pregnancy.

Stamps: For the missions can be left at the back of each church.

Synodal Pathway: Find attached the final versions of the National Synthesis for the Church in Ireland, which is the fruit of the recent process of listening and consultation; it is based on the syntheses produced by the 26 dioceses in Ireland, as well as those submitted by religious congregations and other interested groups. Also attach appendix document from survivors of abuse and the Irish Bishops' Conference Cover Letter, which have all been forwarded to the General Secretariat of the Synod of Bishops. Press Release also attached. We are requested to bring the Report to the attention of your parishioners and to share it on your social media outlets. It will be a useful tool as parishes move forward on the synodal journey in the autumn. **The Report is now available on the website of the Synodal Pathway of the Church in Ireland website:** www.synod.ie



Parish Envelopes: Following previous discussion with the Parish Finance Committee we encourage consideration for those who use envelopes infrequently to consider the use of a standing order, (through this medium you have full control), of the donation at your disposal. **Further information is available from the parish website.**

If you advance the standing order, (it can be processed on-line with your bank), or alternatively bring the completed mandate to your bank. We request that when you are issuing your instruction to the bank, that you do so with your personal name, in doing so we can therefore identify from whom the standing order has been authorised. It is with your authorisation that the standing order is either processed weekly or monthly. Also, you can withdraw the mandate

at your own discretion. We would appreciate an acknowledgement of this transaction (via the parish email) when it is activated, so that we can have a copy for the parish records. In the information forwarded we will require your address and telephone number.

Several parishioners recently have set up a standing order, however we do not know who these parishioners are because they have not provided an address. We ask please that you follow the instructions above and email the parish to inform us who has authorised the standing order.

We request now that the boxes are delivered, if you have not previously returned or updated a parish Census card, please complete the card in the back of the box and return in the collection envelope. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be signed and returned if you are a taxpayer.

Those who avail of Standing Orders are also asked to complete a Census card and Gift Aid card. These can be collected in each sacristy and returned at your convenience.

Details of Parish Accounts for Standing Orders:

(Errigal Ballerin: Sort Code - 950346 - Account No. 40067059 is the No 1 a/c) **Errigal**

Development: Sort Code - 950346 - (Account No. 90042358 is the Renovation a/c).

(Errigal Glenullin: Sort Code - 950346 Account No. 90062596 is the No 1 a/c) **(Errigal**

Parish: Sort Code 950689 - Account No. 90083712 is the Renovation a/c).

Parish Finance: If you wish to contribute to the parish by standing order - forms can be forwarded upon request by sending an email to - errigalparish@gmail.com or they are available on the parish website. At the end of each month, we shall include in the collection figures the amounts relating to the increase in standing orders, these figures are stated in brackets.

Parish Census: In the recent distribution of collection envelopes, we request that at your earliest convenience you might return the census card with your family details for parish registration. Also, the Gift Aid card needs to be updated and signed so that the parish can claim Gift Aid if you are a taxpayer, this does not affect your personal details or taxation. If your tax circumstances change, please inform us, if you are no longer a taxpayer.

Census cards are available in each sacristy, once completed they can be returned in a sealed envelope via the collection box at the back of each church. If you have previously registered, you do not have to do so again, unless your household occupation has changed.

Church Cleaners: Cleaners are required to join the existing monthly groups who clean each church. The more that participate the less occasions that individuals will be required to cover. If interested, please leave your name/contact phone number in each sacristy or alternatively give details to a sacristan.

Mass Cards/Mass Bouquets: Are available for sale at the back of each church please put the money in the candle box.

ACCORD - Counselling: If you need to speak, to an experienced couples and relationships counsellor during this time of unprecedented stress and pressure on family life, please contact 95680151. This is a free helpline service available from 9am - 8pm. Monday to Friday. All calls charged at local rate.

ACCORD DERRY: Virtual Interactive Marriage Preparation Programme (limited to 15 couples per course). Booking now online at www.accordni.com

Radio Maria Ireland: <https://www.radiomaria.ie/radio-maria-ireland/> is an Irish-run Catholic Talk-Radio Station with commercial-free broadcasting of Prayer, Catechesis, Music, Talks, Interviews and Testimonies.

Church Safeguarding: If you have any concerns with regard to Safeguarding children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact: Mrs Marie O’Kane (Designated Liaison Person), Diocesan Pastoral Centre, 164 Bishop Street, Derry. Tel: 02871 - 362475/07596500793. Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org - or PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 or Social Services Tel: 02871-314090.

Parish Representatives - Tracey McGilligan and Clare Mullan.

Errigal Privacy Notice: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website or alternatively it is available from the Parish Office. Live stream of Mass and Services in St. Mary’s Church and a Utube streaming in St. Joseph’s Church are available online. Parishioners should note that the first three rows of seats are visible in St. Mary’s Church.

<u>ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF THANKS</u> Burts Big Bingo raised €700. We thank you for supporting it and to all who donated prizes.	
<u>ADORATION IN ST MURA’S PARISH CHURCH</u> on Friday after the 10am Mass. All welcome. <u>ROSARY ON THE COAST</u> Sunday the 6th September @ 3pm at Lisfannon beach. <u>CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND</u> —Annual National Mass on Sunday, 6 Sept at 2pm at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. For info and booking, email info@catholicmothers.ie . All welcome. <u>THE SEASON OF CREATION 2026</u> takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year’s theme, <i>Living Water</i> , invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God’s creation. <u>DONEGAL GROUP 173 RISE AND SHINE TRUST</u> (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Sat 26th Sept in the Church of the Irish Martyr's Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal Mc Keown Diocese of Derry and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes. <u>MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND</u> hosted by Marriage Encounter Ireland at Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare, from Fri 2 to Sun 4 October. This is not a retreat in the traditional sense but is a positive, joy-filled experience, guided by presenting couples and a priest, in an atmosphere of warmth, prayer, and deep Christian faith. Couples are invited to register online at www.marriageencounter.ie <u>THE PRIORY INSTITUTE</u> provides online Theology courses to degree level. Attend Saturday lectures in Tallaght or from the comfort of your own home. Register now to begin on 19 September. Find out more on our website, prioryinstitute.com <u>BURT BINGO</u> every Tuesday in St. Marys Hall, Burt at 9pm. <u>BURT GAA LOTTO</u> 7-16-17-19-27 Lily Evers €100. <u>BEGINNERS LINE DANCING CLASS</u> at St Mary's Hall, Burt starting Thursday 3 Sept 7:45pm-8:45pm. <u>THE IRISH CANCER SOCIETY</u> is seeking compassionate volunteer drivers to join our pool of drivers. As a volunteer driver you would be bringing patients undergoing chemotherapy to the hospital and back home for their treatment. Gifting your time means that cancer patients will have comfortable transport to attend appointments for their lifesaving treatment. If you can spare 2 days per month, have a valid driving licence, and a safe, reliable vehicle, you are the perfect candidate to make a difference. The Irish Cancer Society will provide training before you start as a driver for us. Your generosity not only eases the journey for many during a challenging time but also offers comfort and support when it's needed most. For info and to become a volunteer driver, contact Monica or Emily at volunteer@irishcancer.ie <u>FRIENDS OF THE ORDER</u> Equestrian Order of the Holy Sepulchre of Jerusalem Lieutenancy of Ireland Help sustain the living Christian presence in the Holy Land The Holy Land is the land of the Gospel, it is also home to Christian families, schools, parishes and communities who need prayer, solidarity and practical support today. The Order is a Catholic Order under the protection of the Holy See, dedicated to supporting the Latin Patriarchate of Jerusalem and the Christian communities of the Holy Land. Friends are not members of the Order but are people of goodwill who support this mission through prayer, awareness and charitable giving. Friends support helps provide: Catholic schools, scholarships and teacher support, parishes, churches, seminaries and religious communities healthcare, homes for the elderly and humanitarian aid Projects in Jerusalem, Bethlehem, Gaza, Jordan, Galilee and the West Bank. 100% of Friends donations go directly to approved Holy Land needs, without administrative deductions. To learn more or become a Friend: Website: holysepulchre.ie/friends Facebook: EOHSJ Ireland Email: friends@holysepulchre.ie Phone: 086 3253882	
<u>PRIVACY NOTICE:</u> The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mura’s Church and St Aengus’ are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online for both Churches.	

http://www.fahanparish.com Fahan Parish Newsletter		
Weekly Collection Burt €1214 Inch €339 Fahan €1075 <i>Sincere Thanks</i>	fahanparish@derrydiocese.org www.fahanparish.com 6th September 2026 Twenty Third Sunday In Ordinary Time	Fr Bradley 9363455 Fr Baker 9360151 Parish Office 9360151 (Mon-Thurs 10am-12:30pm)
Mass Schedule		
<u>St. Aengus' Burt</u> <u>(churchservices.tv/burt)</u> Monday 7th September Mass at 10am Saturday 12th September Mass at 6.30pm John Harkin 1st Anniversary Mass Carol Harkin Anniversary Mass Sunday 13th September Mass at 10.15am Margaret Curran Month Mind Mass <u>Our Lady of Lourdes, Inch</u> Sunday 13th September Mass at 9am	<u>St Mura's Church, Fahan</u> <u>(churchservices.tv/fahan)</u> Wednesday 9th September No Mass Friday 11th September Mass at 10am Special Intention Sunday 13th September Mass at 11:30am Vera McLaughlin Month Mind Mass <u>Chapel Of Ease, Fahan</u> Thursday 10th September Mass at 10am	
PLEASE NOTE THERE WILL BE NO MASS IN ST MURA'S PARISH CHURCH ON WEDNESDAY 9TH SEPTEMBER		
<u>DEATH</u> Your prayers are asked for Frances Barr (nee Boyle), Ballyderowen, Burnfoot who died recently and for her family and friends saddened by their loss.		
<u>CONFIRMATION 2027</u> The Sacrament of Confirmation will be celebrated by Bishop McKeown on: Saturday 10th April at 11am in St. Aengus' Church, Burt For the 6th class pupils of St Mura's NS and St Aengus' NS Bridgend.		
<u>BLESSING OF BIKES AND MOTORCYCLES</u> Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, at 1:30pm. All welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 Sept in St Patrick's Chapel, Dungiven, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.		
<u>BAPTISM</u> We welcome into God's family the following child who was baptised: Tiarnán Hegarty, Ballynahone, Fahan <i>May God guide and protect our children always</i>		
<u>PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS</u> We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.		
<u>SAFEGUARDING NOTICE:</u> If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or Garda Sióchána , Buncrana 074 9320540 Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or TUSLA Family & Child Agency 07491 02233		

Rev. Chris McDermott. Adm.

Tel: (028) 79401236

Email: christopher.mcdermott@derrydiocese.org

www.granaghanparish.com



Twenty-Third Sunday
in Ordinary Time

Sunday 6th September 2026

PARISH OF GRANAGHAN

St Vincent De Paul Helpline: 07927900310

MASS TIMES FOR THE COMING WEEK:

Monday, Wednesday & Friday Mass
at 09:15am
Saturday (Vigil) at 4pm
Sunday Mass at 11am

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? *We would like to help you.* Please pick up your phone and make contact - Tel: 028 7135 1329.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

HOST FOR HOSPICE: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or ailbhe@foylehospice.com

An Carn

Irish Language Classes with an emphasis on conversational Irish and building self-confidence starting on **21st September in An Carn.** Classes in high demand. Booking online essential.

MOSAIC Project - We're inviting you to take part in an exciting new Art Project - share your connections, disconnections, stories, memories and experiences of local bogs and peatlands. Information evening:

Monday 7th September @ 7pm | An Coire Arts Centre | Refreshments provided. Email jodie.jackson@ancarn.org or call 02879549978 to register your attendance.

Introduction to Cyanotype Printing - Using a range of local foliage, you will create unique prints on paper and fabric to make your own selection of artworks. Saturday 12 September | An Coire | 10:30am - 1:30pm | £35 / £30 Concession (Over 60 & Unemployed)

Live Music: Na Leanai - The children and grandchildren of the Sands Family, a name synonymous with Irish folk music for generations, are joining us at An Coire for a special night of music you don't want to miss! Saturday 12 September | Doors at 7:30pm | £16 | Under 16s: Free
together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake!

Maghera's Movie House - Maghera's Vue is showing "David" this weekend - all tickets are just £4 (National Cinema Weekend). An outstanding animated film *David (PG)* based on 1 Samuel is now showing in UK cinemas.

JOB OPPORTUNITY: Derry Diocesan Trust - Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish: Sacristan, hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St John the Baptist Church. Rate of Pay : £12.88 per hour. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12noon on Tuesday 15 September 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Baby Massage & Reflexology Classes - 6-week course starting 9th September in **Ballerin**.

Bingo makes a welcome return on Thursday 17th September at 8.30pm, every 2 weeks in the Marian Hall, Kilrea
Double books £20, Single £10, Half books £5

Weekly Collection for Sunday 23rd August - Weekly: £1,394.78

Weekly Collection for Sunday 30th August - Weekly: £1,499.47 Priests: £10.00

Thank you
your generous support

for

Northern Counties Development Association - The Friday club will resume on Friday 18th September at the usual time of 10.30am. More details next week. Hope to see you all again for a cuppa and a chat and whatever activity is organised. **Everyone welcome.**

That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people. **Fr. Pat O'Hagan**

SUNDAY



Tamlaght
O'Crilly
Greenlough

SUNDAY 13 SEPTEMBER 2026

TWENTY FOURTH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

Next weekend, as we prepare to welcome Bishop Michael Router among us, we will pray God's blessing on him in a particular way at each of our weekend Masses.



Once again we wish Bishop Dónal McKeown a very happy and fruitful retirement. No doubt he will remain very active as he offers his services to Bishop Router, and to the priests and people of the diocese in whatever ways he can.

Our new bishop was a priest of the diocese of Kilmore and, for the last seven years, has served as Auxiliary Bishop in Armagh. He comes among us as a stranger, yes, but also as a pastor. He asks us all to be patient as he gets to know us and as we get to know him.

We pray that his time among us in this diocese of Derry will see a great renewal of faith as we "walk together" (the meaning of Synodality) in the footsteps of all the faithful bishops, priests, religious, and people who have gone before us.

Please pray for Bishop Michael Router as he prepares to begin his pastoral ministry among us. The Mass of Installation will take place in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, next Sunday, at 3.00pm.

Each parish is asked to send five members to the ceremony. Invitations for parishioners from both Bellaghy and Greenlough can be collected from the parish office at Bellaghy.

Sunday 13 September 2026

MASS SCHEDULES 14 - 20 SEPTEMBER 2026

GREENLOUGH

Tuesday 15 September: 9.30am; Rosary: 7.30pm

Thursday 17 September: 9.00am

Adoration: 9.30am - 5.00pm

Saturday 19 September: 5.30pm

Sunday 20 September: 11.00am

(Streamed from Bellaghy)

BELLAGHY

Wednesday 16 September: 9.30am

Friday 18 September: Adoration 10.00am - 8.00pm

Saturday 19 September: 5.30pm

(Streamed from Greenlough)

Sunday 20 September: 11.00am

(Streamed to Greenlough)

BALLYSCULLION

Sunday 20 September: 9.45am

Anniversaries: Assumpta Henry, Robert Mullan, Joe Henry, Annie Reid, Carrie Bradley, Eileen Donnelly, Mary Graham, Angela Boylan, Paddy Rankin

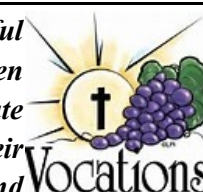


Children's Liturgy has recommenced and will continue every Saturday during the 5.30pm Mass for children from P1 - P4. The 'Quiet Room' will be reserved for the children's liturgy during this Mass.

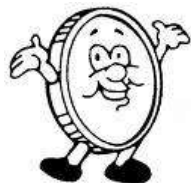
Welcome to Children's Liturgy



In today's gospel Jesus teaches a powerful lesson on forgiveness. We pray for the men called to priesthood that, as they celebrate the Sacrament of Reconciliation with their people, they will help them to know and experience the Lord who "...is compassion and love, slow to anger, and rich in mercy." (Responsorial Psalm)



Website: www.greenlough.com



GREENLOUGH COLLECTIONS

6 September 2026: Weekly: £1284.90. Thank you.

RETIRED PRIESTS' FUND COLLECTION will take place next weekend. Please use the envelope in your box



BAPTISMS

GREENLOUGH: 4.15PM

24 October, 28 November, 19 December.

BELLAGHY: 1.00PM

26 September; 10 October; 7 November; 5 December.

Please contact either parish office to book.



The Parish Office is currently closed but you can still contact us via phone: 028 2582 1190 or by email: greenloughparish@gmail.com.

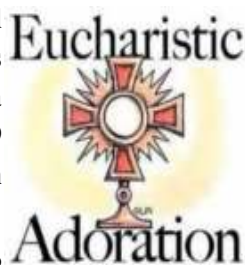


Parish Newsletter: Please send Notices & Anniversaries in writing or via email to the parish office by 10.00am on Wednesday. Thank you.

EUCCHARISTIC ADORATION: Anyone interested in promoting Eucharistic Adoration in the parishes of Bellaghy and Greenlough is invited to attend a meeting in the Drummond Hotel, Ballykelly, BT49 9HP, on Wednesday 30 September, from 8-9pm (Registration will take place from 7:30pm).

Both Bishop McKeown and Bishop Router are happy to promote Eucharistic Adoration throughout the diocese as a means of bringing people to Jesus in the Blessed Sacrament, to foster vocations, and to encourage prayer for vocations.

We are already blessed to have weekly Adoration in our parishes - in Greenlough on Thursdays, and in Bellaghy on Fridays. Now, perhaps, would be a good time to invite and encourage more people to pray before Jesus in the Eucharist which He has left us as "...the source and the summit of our faith." (Second Vatican Council).



Email: greenloughparish@gmail.com

Parish Information

Fr. O'Hagan
028 7938 6259

Parish Office
028 2582 1190

St. Mary's
Primary School
028 2582 1066

St. Conor's
College
028 2582 1370

Neighbouring
Parishes

Bellaghy
028 7938 6259

Lavey
028 7964 2458

Portglenone
028 2582 1218

Baptisms
Contact the
Parish Office

Weddings
Contact the
Parish Office

Confessions
As Announced

The Columban Young Adults are a new group for those aged 18 - 30 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. **Our September event will be a Holy Hour and meditation on Thursday 17 September, 7:00pm at our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by Fr Declan McGeehan.** The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and light refreshments. **We are actively seeking new members - please come along and bring a friend!**

MICHAEL ENGLISH CHURCH CONCERT

An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on **Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin.** Tickets are £30, and available to buy at Herons Gift Shop, Draperstown, Moneyneena Post Office, Ballinascreen and Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

QUEEN'S UNIVERSITY CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY reopens for the new academic year on Monday **QUB Catholic**

14 September, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming. **The first Sunday Mass will be celebrated on 20 September at the new, earlier time of 7.00pm. Please note the new time!** New or returning student? Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at qubcatholic.org and on our socials. Staff and alumni are always welcome too. **Visit our newly renewed Chaplaincy at 28 Elmwood Avenue for Mass, Confessions or candle-lighting - and call into Mosaic for some of the best coffee, hot lunches and home-baked treats in South Belfast!**

OUR LADY OF MONTLIGEON PRAYER GROUP- praying for all the souls in Purgatory meets in Termonbacca, on the last Wednesday each month at 12:30pm. Also in St Joseph's Church Galliagh every Monday after 11am Mass.

RACHEL'S VINEYARD: Have you been hurt by abortion? Tel: Michelle 07871765181.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

ACCOR DERRY MARRIAGE PREPARATION WORKSHOPS September 25th/26th November 20th/21st 2026 These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com

SEASON OF CREATION 2026: The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

MICHAEL ENGLISH CHURCH CONCERT: An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available Desertmartin Parish offices, or online with Eventbrite:

ST JOSEPH MEN'S CAMINO Join men from across Ireland on Saturday 12th September for a 25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner, with after-dinner speaker Fr. Mark Quinn. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 (student € 55). Registration, details www.dominicans.ie/events. Enquiries: op.evangelisation@gmail.com.

SAFEGUARDING Any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children and Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org Northern Ireland emergency services PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker) Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459 Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 99

Sun 5th Sept

Vol 44 No 36

MASSES

Saturday Vigil 6.00pm

Sunday 9.30am, 11.00am, 12.30pm

Mon ,Wed ,Fri, Sat 10.00am Tues and Thurs 7.15pm

CONFESSIONS

Saturdays from 10.30am-11.30am & 5.15pm-5.50pm

Tues ,Thurs 6.45pm – 7.10pm

Divine Mercy 3pm Monday– Friday

BAPTISMS

Saturday at 4.30pm

MARRIAGES

Three months notice and marriage preparation necessary

PAROCHIAL HOUSE

71267070

1 Aileach Road Ballymagroarty BT48 0AZ

Email: office@holyfamily-parish.com

Website: www.holyfamily-parish.com

Webcam: Click on website and follow the links

Parish Office 9.45am-1.45pm Mon– Fri

Parish Priest:
Fr Joseph Gormley

Curate
Fr Kevin Mulhern

INTRODUCTION OF A SECOND COLLECTION

As previously announced at the beginning of summer, a **Second Collection** will be introduced from next **Sunday, 13 September 2026**. This collection will be taken up **immediately after Holy Communion** at all weekend Masses.

The purpose of this additional collection is to provide a dedicated source of funding for the continued improvement of our church as well as for future parish development projects. Through the generosity of parishioners, important works can now be undertaken to enhance our church and facilities, ensuring that they continue to serve the needs of our worshipping community for generations to come.

I am deeply grateful for the ongoing generosity and commitment of all who support the parish. Your contributions play a vital role in sustaining and developing the life and mission of our parish, Deo Gratias.

Fr Joseph Gormley, Parish Priest

Prayer for Holy Family Parish

Heavenly Father, Bless our parish community and the gifts we offer in Your name. Guide us in the wise stewardship of these resources, that our church may continue to grow in faith, service and mission. May all that we do give glory to You and bear fruit for future generations. Through Christ our Lord. Amen

INSTALLATION OF BISHOP MICHAEL ROUTER AS BISHOP OF DERRY will take place on Sunday 20th September at 3.00pm. We have five invitations for parishioners one of which will be for a young person who will be invited to take part in the entrance procession carrying banner displaying the name of the parish. If you would like one of the other invitations please put your name, address and telephone number in an envelope marked 'Installation of Bishop' and return to the box at the Sacred Heart Statue. The persons chosen to represent the parish will be drawn from the names.

DEATHS We pray for Kathleen Cullen, The Branch who was buried during the week. May she rest in peace

BAPTISMS Our Parish family welcomes: Maddie Evelyn Hanlon Sheriff's Glen Arabelle Louise Claire Crumlish, Labre Park

ROSARY ON THE COAST. Rosary on the Coast will be at 3pm today Sunday at Lisfannon We will pray for unborn children. Tel 077303 30028

ADORATION OF THE BLESSED SACRAMENT RESUMES TODAY AFTER 12.30 MASS UNTIL 6PM

ANNIVERSARIES We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time. John Doherty John & Lilly Ted & Dessie McLaughlin, Billy Coyle, Garrett Doherty, Molly Linehan, John McDaid, John Gallagher, John Kelly, Mary Harkin

CHILD SAFE GUARDING REFRESHER TRAINING In 2023 all Parish Volunteers, Clergy and Employees received Child Safe guarding Training. It is necessary that this training is refreshed every three years. With this in mind all Parish Volunteers and Clergy and Employees are asked to attend refresher training in Holy Family Primary School on Thursday 10th September at 8.00pm. Please leave your name in the Parish Office to indicate your availability to attend .

SUNDAY COLLECTION 30th August £2471.29 Standing Orders £400 and €143.95 Thank you for your generosity

MESSAGE FROM FR ANSELM MEO who was here a number of years ago has written to us asking for our support for them. As you have known recently Flores island in Indonesia has been hit by earthquake in Saturday, August 15th. **Envelopes can be returned to the collection or left in parish office.**

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD."

We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world

BLESSING OF MOTORBICYLES AND RIDERS will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30pm. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN, at 11:30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

ANAM CARA , the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold it's monthly Face to Face Parent Support Evening for bereaved parents on Thursday 10th September at 7.30pm in the Raddison Blu Hotel, Letterkenny For more info call 01 4045378 or email info@anamcara.ie

Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill

Rev. Christopher McDermott
Parish Secretary: Mrs Kim Convery



Twenty-Third Sunday of The Year

06th September 2026

www.parishofkilrea.com

E-mail: parishofkilrea@btinternet.com

Facebook: *Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill*

Telephone: 028 29540343

Errigal: 028 29558251

Vigil Mass (Sat) 7pm at Saint Anne's Oratory – Sunday 10am at Drumagarner – Sunday 12noon at Craigavole

Weekday Masses

Monday, Thursday and Friday at 10am in Saint Anne's Oratory.

In Remembrance of

John Joe Quigg, Bridget Quigg, Betty Quinn, Mary McCauley, Albert McKenna, Danny Burke, Seamus McGill, Tessie Dempsey, James O'Kane, John O'Kane, Philomena McErlean and Ruth Armstrong. whose anniversaries occur at this time.

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord.

Congratulations to

Claire O'Hagan & Gerard Higgins



whose marriage was celebrated recently.
We wish them well for their future together!

Kilrea GAC News

Lottery result 27th August : 2,4,6,14.

No Winner £3,900.

£25 – Packie McCormack £25 – Ronan Hegarty
Next Jackpot is £3,950 **Tickets on Klubfunder.**

Vocations; We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

Last week's collection amounted to £1,465.

Standing Orders August £2,075

Thank You

We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of **Kevin McAtamney, The Fairways, Pat Higgins, Dungiven, Sean O'Neill, Beechview Gardens.** who were buried recently.
May they rest in peace and rise in glory

Month's Mind Mass for **Mary Convery** on Saturday 26th September at 7pm St Anne's.

JOB OPPORTUNITY: Derry Diocesan Trust - Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish: Sacristan, hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St John the Baptist Church. Rate of Pay : £12.88 per hour. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12noon on Tuesday 15 September 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Bingo makes a welcome return on Thursday 17th September at 8.30pm, every 2 weeks in the Marian Hall. Double books £20, Single £10, Half books £5. Last House £250

Readers for 12th Sept/ 13th Sept

7pm:

Sue Anne Mullan

10am:

Michael Og McKiernan

12noon:

Mary O'Kane

Eucharistic Adoration

Every Monday from
12noon until 7pm at
Drumagarner.

Concludes with public
prayers.

**A warm welcome awaits
any New Parishioners!**

Mass Times
Sundays:
Vigil: 6.00pm
Morning:
9am & 11am

Weekdays:
Mon - Fri:
9.15am

Baptisms
Sundays
11.45am

Telephone
No's
Fr. Graham
028 7964 2458

Parish Office:
028 7964 2458

SVP Helpline
07596971627

St. Brigid's PS.
028 7964 2014

Lavey Early
Years
028 7964 5464

Neighbouring
Parishes

Maghera
Fr. Doherty
028 7964 2496

Kilrea
Fr. McDermott
028 2954 0343

*Well done to our Minor
footballers and
management on winning
the Derry Minor
Championship last
Monday evening.
Onwards & Upwards!*



**"From an Island
to an Island"
Journeying from Lavey
to Newfoundland**

*Stories, poems, singing
and much more*



Sunday 13th September in Lavey Club at 7.30pm

All Donations in aid of Lavey Parish.
Come along for a night of entertainment!

**Marian Hall, Kilrea - Bingo
Thursday 17th September
at 8.30pm**, every 2 weeks in
the Marian Hall. Double
books **£20**, Single **£10**, Half
books **£5**. Last House **£250**.



Parish Details

Please have all
Anniversaries names &
News Items in **by 1.00 pm**
on WEDNESDAY this week.



The Parish Office is open
Monday - Thursday from 10.00 am.

Thank-You

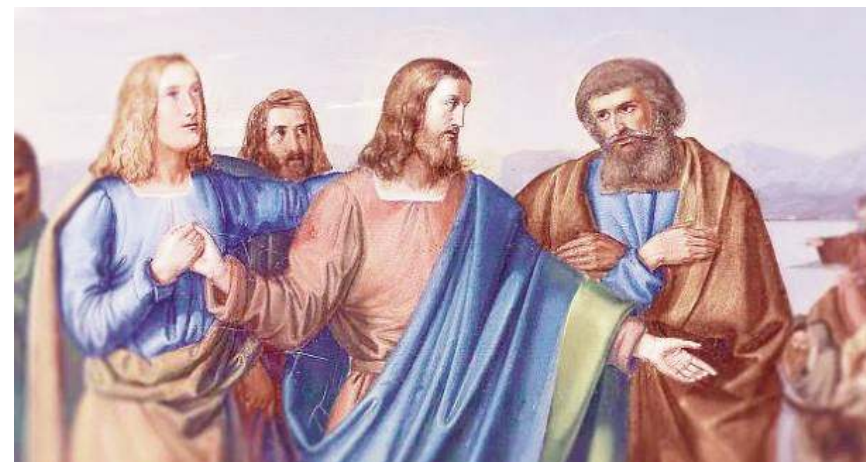


Lavey Parish

Tel: (028) 7964 2458

E-Mail: laveyparish@derrydiocese.org

Web: www.laveyparish.com



"Where two or three meet in my name I shall be there with them." What a wonderful promise that is. And what an extraordinary power that promise gives us as followers of Christ. Because of our Baptism, we are people who always meet in his name whatever the purpose of our meeting. Every time we are together we make Christ present. It is hard to believe and yet we have Christ's word for it. This has huge implications for each of us personally. Every married couple, just by being together in love, is a source of the presence of Christ. Every family home is where he lives because of the people who live there. And everything we do together as a faith community is part of the salvation of the world. However, our responsibility in all of this is to ensure that the quality of our love is such that this presence of Christ can warm the world of all those around us.

Father Johnny Doherty, C.Ss.R.



Monday 7th September	9.15 am Mass
Wednesday 9th September	9.15 am Mass
Thursday 10th September	9.15 am Mass
Friday 11th September	9.15 am Mass

Adoration will begin **after morning Mass**
and conclude at **5.00 pm.**

24th Sunday in Ordinary Time

Saturday 12th September	5:15 pm - 5:45 pm - Confessions 6:00 pm Mass
Sunday 13th September	9:00 pm Mass 11:00 am Mass

As Bishop Router prepares for his Installation on Sunday 20th September, please remember him in your daily prayers.

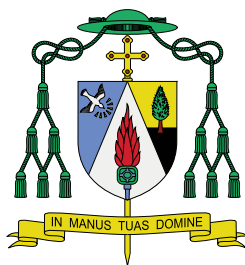
God, eternal shepherd, you tend your Church in many ways and rule us with love.

You have chosen your servant, Michael, to be shepherd of your flock in the Diocese of Derry.

Give him a spirit of courage and right judgment, a spirit of knowledge and love.

By governing with fidelity those entrusted to his care, may he build your Church as a sign of salvation for the world.

Amen.



Sunday 6th September - 23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time

The Famine Bell

We have recently acquired, through the good auspices of the Late Father Liam Donnelly, a very old church bell. This bell was cast during the famine years.

The bell has been placed in the old cemetery near the old church ruin in memory of the victims of the Great Famine, many of whom are buried here. It is also a memorial to all victims of conflict in the years since the building of the Church in 1803.

The bell also reminds us that the law of the land forbade Church bells when the old church was built. This was one of the Penal Laws.

Going further back, it also links us to the Great St. Patrick's Bell, which was for many years concealed in Mayogall for safety.

Since the bell was erected last week it has become a focal point of great interest. It marks a site of remembrance and prayer.

The design and construction of the bell was the great work of Packie Duggan, Andreus and Mark. It is an outstanding addition to the parish along with the great work already carried out in the old cemetery.



****CONGRATULATIONS****

We would like to extend our warmest congratulations to Mrs Mary O'Kane on celebrating her 25th anniversary of principalship in our Parish Primary School of St. Brigid's. May the Lord continue to give her strength, wisdom and courage.



Parish Collections: Sunday 30th August

Weekly: **£957.30**
Building: **£998.20**
Loose Coin: **£551.90**

Thank you for your continued support!



**Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Twenty-Third Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 6th September 2026**

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (Matthew 18:15-20)

In today's gospel, Jesus teaches that reconciliation is a sacred responsibility rooted in love, humility and a desire for restored relationship. When conflict or hurt arises, the first response should not be anger, gossip, avoidance or revenge, but a quiet and honest conversation with the person involved. This private dialogue gives space for listening, understanding and healing. If the conflict cannot be resolved alone, Jesus encourages the involvement of trusted witnesses, not to shame or accuse, but to help guide the conversation with wisdom, fairness and care. When difficulties continue, the wider community has a role in encouraging accountability, unity and peace.

This message can be remembered through the word **LOVE**:

Listen with humility,

Offer reconciliation,

Value community, and

Embrace divine presence.

Love calls us to hear one another deeply, choose restoration over pride, protect unity, and trust that God is present wherever people gather in faith, prayer, forgiveness, and harmony. Overall, Jesus reminds us that love is more than a feeling; it is a way of living. Through patience, courage, humility, and faith, conflict can become an opportunity for healing, forgiveness, and renewed fellowship.

***May the peace of Christ guide our hearts, strengthen our unity, and
fill our community with love, forgiveness and grace. Amen.***

A Time of Prayer and Reflection in Honour of St Pio will take place in our pastoral area from Saturday 19th September until Wednesday 23rd September. At this time we invite people to simply take time aside from their busy schedules to invoke the intercession of St Pio on individuals, families, and parish community. At this time of year when schools / colleges reopen and many people return to work, it is good to think about our own faith commitment.



At our Masses on the weekend of 19/20th September, a reflection on the life of St Pio will be offered. Mon 21st / Tues 22nd / Wed 23rd, we will celebrate together an early morning Mass in each of our churches and again, Mass at 10.00 am with an evening devotion at 7.00 pm. So too, an opportunity for reflection. Specific times and places will be confirmed next week.

On **Wednesday 23rd September**, the Feast Day of St Pio, Bishop Michael Router will celebrate Mass at **7.00 pm** in St Patrick's Church, Murlog. This is a prayerful opportunity to welcome Bishop Michael to our diocese and to our pastoral area.

Eucharistic Adoration takes place on **Wednesday** from **8.30 am - 5.30 pm** in **Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road.**

Eucharistic Adoration will resume in **St Patrick's, Murlog** on **Monday 7th September** from **10.30 am - 1.00 pm**. Everyone welcome.

Sick and Housebound Fr McCaughey hopes to visit the sick and housebound through the coming week as follows:

Monday and Wednesday: Leckpatrick and Strabane

Tuesday: Lifford.

We pray for all who are sick and housebound at this time and for those who accompany them.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of Eamonn McNulty, Ballyduff Pk, Lifford

Conor Woods, Lisnafin Pk, Strabane

Teresa Madden, Glenview Pk, Strabane

Aiden Dunne, Townsend St, Strabane

Anniversaries Jackie Bjourson, Margaret Crotty, Anthony Diver, Hugh Duncan, Sarah Huston-Richmond, Gerard Kearney, Billy Kelly, Lena Kelly, Patrick Joseph Kelly, Patrick McAleer, Bobby McBride, Robert McClay Jnr, Reece McColgan, Danny McDaid, Mariah McElwee, Frances McElwee-Gallagher, Simsey McFarland, Detta McKane, Betty Montague, Johnnie Montague, Patrick Murray, Robert Porter, Mary Anne McCloskey. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:

Leckpatrick: £949.28(offertory), £453.55 (renovation)

Clonleigh: €1,558.64

Camus: £1,653.65 (offertory), £738 (restoration).

Thanks also to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 13th September:

1st Reading: Sirach 27:30-28:7

Psalms: 102:1-4, 9-12

2nd Reading: Romans 14:7-9

Gospel: Matthew 18:21-35

Saints of The Coming Week:

Tuesday: Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Wednesday: St Ciaran of Clonmacnoise

Thursday: St Peter Claver

Saturday: St Ailbe, The Most Holy Name of Mary

St Patrick's Hall, Strabane We wish to acknowledge all those who continue to use the facilities at St Patrick's Hall. The hall serves our community and creates opportunity for so many people. Throughout the years the hall has been used for various purposes including celebrations to mark special occasions and also reflects so much talent from all age groups. Sadly too, in circumstances of death, the hall has offered hospitality to families. Many of these events have been supported by our local caterers. We thank everyone for their ongoing support. The hall is an important community facility. However, in terms of insurance and safeguarding, proper booking procedures need to

be in place so as to ensure the safety of all those who use this facility. We ask that those who wish to use the hall for any planned event to please contact Sinead (Parish Administrator) at the pastoral office, or speak with Brian (Caretaker) at the hall so as to complete the necessary documentation for insurance and safeguarding requirements, and to clarify any queries. We thank everyone for their cooperation and understanding in regard to these matters. It is important to maintain good practices for the continuing safe use of the hall as it is a valuable community facility. We thank people for their support through the years.

Legion of Mary An urgent appeal for new members to join us. Role includes visitation of nursing homes, promotion of the rosary with the pilgrim statue and weekly meetings. Time commitment of approx 3 hrs per week. Meeting on Thursday mornings at 11 am in St Pat's Hall. Please contact Margaret Harte: 028 71883159.

Blessing of Bikers & Motorcycles on Sunday 13th September at 1.30 pm in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt. Following blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present a donation to RNLI. Mass will be celebrated on 13th September at 11.30 am in St Patrick's Chapel, DUNGIVEN for deceased bikers. All welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meetings resume on Monday 7th September at 8.00 pm in the Pastoral Office, 27 Butcher Street, Strabane. Everyone welcome.

Vocations Society of St Joseph St John Vianney branch meets on Tues 8th September in Immaculate Conception Church with rosary after 10am Mass. All welcome.

Pray for Vocations We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world. Visit: <https://derryvocations.org>

St Joseph's Men's Camino A Day of pilgrimage, prayer, brotherhood and renewal on Sat 12th Sept. Inspired by the ancient tradition of pilgrimage, the 25km guided pilgrimage along the beautiful Boyne Valley is open to all men aged 18+. Cost €65/€55 (incl lunch/dinner). Visit www.dominicans.ie

Catholic Mothers Ireland Family Day today (Sunday) at Termonbacca, Derry, beginning with the National Mass at 2.00 pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. Email info@catholicmothers.ie

Host for Hospice October is Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please contact Ailbhe, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice: 028 71359888 or ailbhe@foylehospice.com

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of sacristan at Granaghan (Swatragh) parish. 12 hrs per week. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hour. Contact recruitment@derrydiocese.org / 028 71262302. Closing 15/ 9/26.

Human Life International Ireland Fr L Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at Canal Court Hotel, Newry on 29th Sept at 6:45pm with 1st class relic of St Thérèse.

Season of Creation During this Season of Creation, Pope Leo invites us to turn our attention to one of the most essential gifts for life: water. Let us pray that we may learn to manage water with justice and responsibility, protecting it as a common good and ensuring that everyone has equitable access to it.

Strabane / Leckpatrick Draw August 2026

Prize	Winner	Promoter
£2,000	Robert Coyle	Marian Cooke
£1,000	Jacqueline Donaghey	Sadie Kerlin
£500	Sean Devine	Maisie Boggs
£500	Bernie & Joan	Nuala Kerr
£250	Ryan Clarke	Maura Coyle
£250	Pat Timoney	John Devine
£100	Eileen Devine	Gabrielle Dooher
£100	Margaret Kavanagh	Paul Mullen
£100	Martina Murray	Fr Michael
£100	Colm Clarke	Maura Coyle
£100	Celine Ward	Ann McCrory

Congratulations to all the winners. Thank you for your support.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four in St Pat's Hall on Thursdays at 8 pm.
Some fun, excitement and slight competition.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Course The next course is on 20th/21st November at Ebrington Hotel, Derry. Booking online www.accordni.com

Lough Derg Day Retreats September 9, 12, 15, 19, 20 - a day of prayer, reflection and spiritual renewal. Visit www.loughderg.org All welcome.

Porter School of Irish Dancing Classes resume on Monday 7th Sept at Lifford Resource Centre. Registration is now open. Classes available for 4 year olds and over. Teachers fully qualified and garda vetted. To register your interest, please call 0044 7515525499 or visit facebook page: Porter School of Irish Dance.

Rosary on the Coast takes place today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm at Lisfannon Beach, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn babies. Everyone welcome.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: 8.30 am (6th Sept - alternate Sundays - 20th Sept)

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: 8.30 am (13th Sept - alternate Sundays - 27th Sept)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes.

Office hours: Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm.

Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at

marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.



Limavady Parish

6 September 2026

**TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY
IN ORDINARY TIME**

LITURGICAL PROGRAMME FOR

WEEK COMMENCING Monday 7 September 2026

Monday 7 September -

Friday 11 September 10.00am

**Mass: Christ the King Church
(streamed)**

Saturday 12 September 4.30pm

**Vigil Mass: Christ the King Church
(streamed)**

6.00pm

**Vigil Mass: St Finlough's Church
(streamed)**

Sunday 13 September 9.00am

Mass: Christ the King Church

10.30am

Mass: St Mary's Church (streamed)

12.00noon

Mass: Christ the King Church

**Readings for next Sunday: Eccles (Sir) 27:30-28:7. Ps 102:1-4, 9-12,
R/ V 8. Rm 14:7-9. Mt 18:21-35.**

TELEPHONE NUMBERS:

PARISH OFFICE 028 777 62522

(MONDAY - THURSDAY: 9.00 am - 1.00 pm)

Msgr. McCanny 028 777 29759

Fr Harkin 028 777 63944

PARISH BULLETIN:

The bulletin is available online. Visit: www.limavadyparish.org

All notices should be emailed to parishoflimavady@btinternet.com or left in the post box outside the parish office before Wednesday at 1.00pm.

**IN THESE DIFFICULT TIMES PLEASE REMEMBER THE SVP RED BOX.
HELPLINE 07512360388.**



SYMPATHY

We extend our sympathy to the family and friends of:

James (Jim) Daly, Rathbrady Road, Limavady
who has died recently.

ANNIVERSARIES:

Rev. Dr. Edward O'Brien, James Tierney, Sadie O'Kane, Seamie Lynn,
Anna O'Connell, Mary Ann and James McClarey, Paddy Gallagher,
Teresa Ferris, Seamus Stewart, Frank McLaughlin, Isobel McLaughlin,
John O'Kane, John Alexander Moore, Patrick Joseph Moore, Anna Burke,
Martin Donnelly, Josephine McCann, Mary and James Forrest.

MONTH'S MIND MASSES:

The Month's Mind Mass for **Margaret O'Kane** will be celebrated
on **Saturday 12 September** at 4.30pm in **Christ the King Church**.

The Month's Mind for **Margaret Brown** will be celebrated
on **Saturday 12 September** at 6.00pm in **St. Finlough's Church**.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASSES:

The First Anniversary Mass for **William McGill** will be celebrated
on **Sunday 13 September** at 12 noon in **Christ the King Church**.



WEEKLY EUCHARISTIC ADORATION

has resumed in **St. Mary's Church**
and takes place **each Thursday** from 1.00pm to 6.00pm.

**All are warmly welcome to come and spend some quiet time
in prayer before the Blessed Sacrament.**

STANDING ORDER: If you wish to
set up a Standing Order, please
contact the parish office -
Tel: (028) 77762522 between 9.00am
and 1.00pm (Monday to Thursday).

WEEKLY COLLECTION: £4,975

**Thank you for your continued
generosity and support.**

**ADULT CROCHET CLASS in ST. FINLOUGH'S HALL
resumes on MONDAY, 14 SEPTEMBER
at 7.30pm.**



New members welcome!

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on **Saturday 26th September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown Diocese of Derry and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our Mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.**

RISE AND SHINE TRUST-EASTER 2027 PILGRIMAGE:

Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11-30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with the Rise and Shine Trust. The trip is free to Guests travelling with the Group. The application form is available online on riseandshine.ie.

Closing date for applications 15th October 2026.

Applications are also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests on the trip. Carers applications at riseandshine.ie For more information, visit www.riseandshine.ie or Please feel free to contact Sian (07960211352) or Maurice (07711504821)

Bereaved by Suicide - Support Meeting: If you have been affected by the loss of a loved one to suicide, you are not alone and support is available. A monthly Bereaved by Suicide Support Meeting is usually held on the first Monday of each month. The next meeting will now take place on **Monday 7th September at 7:30pm.** Location: **Roe Valley Therapy Centre** The group is facilitated by Wellness and Positive Minds facilitators who bring lived experience, offering a compassionate and understanding space for support. Everyone welcome.

We pray for the men called to priesthood,
to the ministry of teaching and preaching
in the name of Jesus, and encouraging
their brothers and sisters to turn away
from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.



Could you Host for Hospice?

October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month! We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake!



To request your **FREE** host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

FR. JOSEPH K. BILL RETREAT: given by Fr. Anthony Saji V.C. at Allingham Arms Hotel, Bundoran - 28 September to 2 October 2026. Contact Roisin on 00353868937399.

CHAIR EXERCISES: begin again on

Monday 7 September

in Limavady Methodist Church Hall at 7.00pm for one hour.

£3 plus cuppa. Coach: Mr Pascal Proctor. Everyone welcome.

A chance to exercise and socialise.



SAFEGUARDING NOTICE If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison

Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

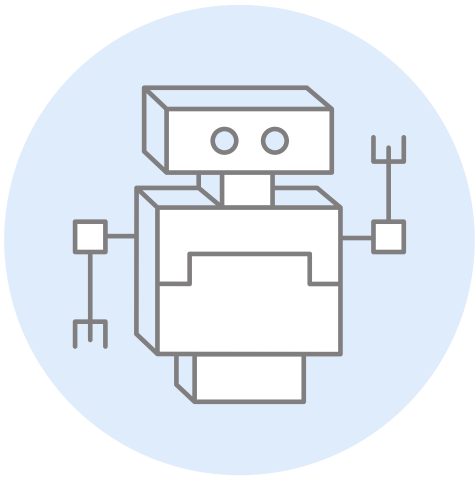
Northern Ireland emergency services

PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101

Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker)

Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459

Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 995



longtowerchurch.org

Checking the site connection security



23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time

6 September 2026

"You have won back your brother"

God appoints Ezekiel a watchman, a guardian, this Sunday. When danger comes, he must speak, and, if he stays silent, the harm is on his head. That duty did not end with the prophets. It belongs to every one of us, the baptised.

But notice how Jesus asks it to be done. Not a public shaming. Not plastered across social media first. Go quietly, he says, just the two of you. Our world has forgotten this. It is quick to condemn, quick to cancel, quick to cast people out for their failures. The Gospel does the opposite: it corrects in order to win the person back. Cancel culture writes people off. Christ never does.

That is correction properly understood. Correction rooted in the one debt St Paul says we can never pay off: the debt of love. Love that does not depend on the other person deserving it. Love that speaks the truth gently, patiently, without a hint of superiority, given unconditionally and always keeps the door open.

And yes, speaking that truth today can cost us. We may be laughed at, called outdated, told to keep our faith to ourselves. But speak anyway. Kindly, humbly, but speak. Silence is not kindness; it is abandonment. So many we love have not rejected the faith, they have simply drifted, the fire has gone low. A word of love may be the very thing that rekindles it.

This week, be a gentle guardian. A phone call. A visit. *"I miss seeing you at Mass"* — said and meant. *"I'm praying for you"* — said and done.

We are never sent out alone. Christ goes with us — his love poured into our hearts. Your duty now is to go, and pour it out.

Fr Sean

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: **Melmount:** £2444.00; **Sion Mills:** £1395.00. Thank you.

Those who pay to the weekly collection or any special collections, including Priest's Collection by cheque are asked that all cheques should be made payable to '*Melmount Parish*' or '*Sion Mills Parish*' depending on the Parish. This is a banking requirement. *Parishioners can still leave their contributions in the Parish Office. If the Office is closed, please use the letterbox.*

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 7 September after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm.

Collection Counters The following are asked to count the collection for the month of September: Aoife Doherty's Team.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Rosa Maria McElroy

Mollie Eileen McIlroy

Tess Hegarty

Koby Martyn Burns

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Teresa Madden, 14 Glenview Park

Aiden (Cookie) Dunne, 6 Townsend Street

Eamon McNulty, 5 Ballyduff Park

Martin Gallagher, Bingley, formerly Laurel Drive

Evelyn Baxter, Castlederg

Anniversaries

Marie Logue, Martha Reid, Brendan Kearney

Gerard Maguire, Teresa Casey, Kathleen Christy

Rose Graham, John McHugh, Nora McLaughlin

Betty Montague, Danny McDaid, Sarah Huston-Richmond

Johnnie Montague, Mariah McElwee, Frances McElwee-Gallagher

George Patterson, Catherine Gibson, Bernadette Barclay

Margaret Blee, James Foley, Frances Duncan

Michael McDevitt, Kathleen McDevitt, Rosemary Stewart

Tommy Barr, Aiden Callen, Lena Kelly

Collection for Retired Priests The Annual Collection for Retired Priests will be taken up at all Masses next Sunday 13 September. This is a collection to help assist priests who have retired from active ministry. There is an envelope marked '*Clergy Retirement Fund*' in your box of envelopes for this collection. Anyone contributing to this collection by cheque should make it payable to '*Melmount Parish*' or '*Sion Mills Parish*' depending on the Parish.

Vocations We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

Baptism Dates Melmount

September: Sunday 13; Saturday 19.

October: Sunday 4; Saturday 10; Saturday 17; Saturday 24.

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14; Saturday 21; Saturday 28.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

Parish Draw Promoters should make their returns for September to the Parish Office on **Monday 21 September from 2.00pm - 4.30pm**. The Draw for September will take place on Thursday 24 September at 10.30am in the Parish Office.

Adoration Everyday The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Society of St. Juan Vianney Branch will meet on Tuesday 8 September in the Church of the Immaculate Conception. Rosary after 10.00am Mass and meeting will continue in St. Patrick's Hall, Barrack Street afterwards.

Legion of Mary will meet in the Green Room, behind St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills each Monday evening at 7.30pm. New members welcome. The Rosary for Peace will be said at the Grotto tomorrow Monday 7 September at 12 noon.

40 Hours Eucharistic Adoration, St. Mary's Church, Castlefin Begins with Mass on Friday 11/12 September at midnight continuous Eucharistic Adoration. Finishes on Sunday 13 September at 4.00pm. Prayer and Benediction on Sunday at 3.30pm. All are welcome.

Study Theology Online, is this for you? The Priory Institute provides Theology courses to degree level. Attend Saturday lectures in Tallaght or from the comfort of your own home. Register now before 19 September. For more information see prioryinstitute.com.

Anam Cara, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold its monthly Parent Support Evening on Thursday 10 September at 7.30pm in the Radisson Blu Hotel, Letterkenny. This event is free and open to all bereaved parents regardless of the age their child died, the circumstances of their death or how recent their death was. Advance registration not necessary. We also offer online support group meetings. To find out more call 0035385 288

8888 or email

Info@Anamcara.ie

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly *The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust* and *The Irish Pilgrimage Trust*) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26 September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's, Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St. Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co. Donegal at 1.30pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNL Station to present the donation to the RNL. ***Please Note:*** *Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St. Patrick's Church, Dungiven at 11.30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.*

Rise and Shine Trust Easter 2027 Pilgrimage Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11 – 30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with the Rise and Shine Trust. *The trip is free to guests travelling with the Group.* The application form is available online at riseandshine.ie. Closing date for applications is 15 October 2026. Applications are also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests on the trip. Carers applications at riseandshine.ie. For more information visit **www.Riseandshine.ie** or contact Sian 07960211352 or Maurice 07711504821.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church please contact Marie O’Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email@

Dlp@Derrydiocese.Org

. *Northern Ireland emergency services:* PSNI on 101; *Social Services:* Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 71314090 and ask for the Duty Social Worker. *Regional Emergency Social Work Services* 0800 1979 995.

The Parish of Moville

St Pius X, Moville St Mary's, Ballybrack

St Columba's, Ballinacrae St Joseph's Oratory, Shrove



Parish Priest: Fr Colm O'Doherty (074) 9382057

Parish Office: (074) 9382057/0899421375

emails: movilleparish@derrydiocese.org
movilleparish@gmail.com

Bulletin email address: movillebulletin@gmail.com

Parish website: www.movilleparish.com

CALENDAR FOR THE WEEK AHEAD

Sunday 6th The three readings today, by chance, deal with the same theme of neighbourly correction. This is a difficult art and can only be exercised through genuine love and the purest of motives. We have to learn to help and to heal each other. In this we have to avoid attitudes of prying, denunciation, jealousy and informing. The spirit of the Gospel which lays down a procedure must be our guide.

Tuesday 8th The Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary. Mary's birth brings the dawn of hope and the promise that salvation is near at hand.

Wednesday 9th St Ciaran, abbot. He came to Clonmacnoise in January 545 and there he founded a monastery, which was to become one of the most renowned in Europe. He died at the age of thirty-three while the monastery was still being built.

Thursday 10th St Peter Claver. Born in Catalonia in 1580, a Jesuit, who was sent to Columbia in 1610. He worked for thirty-three years among the slaves, until his death in 1654.

Saturday 12th The Holy Name of Mary.
St Ailbe, who founded the monastery of Emly, which became very important in Munster.

Sunday 13th 11.30am Mass will be celebrated in Ballinacrae.

Mass this week in St Pius X: Monday to Friday 10am. Saturday 6.30pm; Sunday 10am.

Confessions in St. Pius X Church: Saturday 5.45pm to 6.15pm.

The Rosary and the Divine Mercy Chaplet will be recited in St. Pius X Church, Moville, at 7.30pm every day, from Sunday – Friday. **Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament** on Monday, 2-9pm; Wednesday, 6-9pm.

The next **Parish Draw**, the last in the series, will take place on **Monday 14 September**. Promoters, please hand in your list on or before that date.

If you would like to attend the installation of **Bishop Michael Router** on Sunday 20 September, please put your name and contact number in the box in the porch of the Parochial House and the names will be drawn out at the end of next week.

We offer our **sympathy** to the families and friends of Mary Harkin, O'Gara Villas who died recently. May she rest in peace.

Baptism: We welcome into God's Family **Cillian Liam Cavanagh**, Derry and **James Michael Forward**, Gloucestershire who were baptised recently.

Thank you for your generous financial support to the parish in the past week, which amounted to €2472.

If you'd like to receive a copy of the **parish newsletter** by email, please send an email to: movillebulletin@gmail.com The newsletter will be sent out securely, giving no one else access to your email address, in accordance with GDPR.

Prayer for Vocations: We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world. We pray to the Lord.

"It is to the glory of my Father that you should bear much fruit and then you will be my disciples." Are you being called to love the Lord and His people as a priest, sister or brother? Anyone interested in serving the Church as a priest of the diocese of Derry should contact the diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, PP Bellaghy and Greenlough, at 0487938 6259 or at pgoh2111@gmail.com

St Eugene's Hall (0864519812/0838132948 email steugeneshallmoville@gmail.com) has musical instruments from the old Brass and Reed Band and will hold a public meeting on Wednesday 9 September, in the Hall, at 8pm to discuss how to preserve/display them. Please come along if you are interested or have any memorabilia or photos from that time.

Rosary on the Coast will be held at 3pm today, Sunday 6 September, at Lisfannon Strand, Buncrana.

Greencastle Community Centre (9381054) info@greencastlecentre.ie The Computer Clinic 4 weeks IT Support Course begins 15 September at 6pm; Strike A Chord after-school youth music project on Tuesday 22 September from 4 to 6pm. Food and transport provided; Knitting Club every Tuesday 11am – 1pm.

Beginners **line dancing** classes on Tuesday 8 September in The Methodist Hall from 7 to 8pm and classes in Glencrow Hall on Thursday 10 September from 7 to 9pm.

Carrowmena Community Centre (9367061) All-age social club, The Tuesday Club, resumes on Tuesday 15 September at 2pm. Join in a range of activities or simply chat and make new friends. All welcome. Cost €5, including afternoon tea. A wide variety of courses is planned for the autumn. Contact the Centre for more information and to book.

October is officially **Foyle Hospice** Coffee Morning Month when funds are raised by hosting a Coffee Morning. To request your free host pack or for more info, contact Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 04871359888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

Ceolan School of traditional music is holding a registration day today, Sunday 6 September in The Methodist Hall from 3-5pm. Classes are available in all trad instruments for children and adults, beginners welcome. Please text 0861522322 for details.

As September approaches with the long evenings, why not sign up for **Irish** conversation classes. Classes depend on numbers. Contact gerrysona123@yahoo.ie if interested.

Pilgrimage to **Doon Well and Ards** on Sunday 4 October. Contact Bridie McNally, 9383158.

Safeguarding If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding children or adults, please contact Marie O'Kane, The Diocesan Designated Liaison Person at 00447596500793 or dlp@derrydiocese.org. Local Safeguarding Representatives are Mary McGranaghan and Brídín Hannaway

23rd Sunday in Ordinary Time

6 September 2026

"You have won back your brother"

God appoints Ezekiel a watchman, a guardian, this Sunday. When danger comes, he must speak, and, if he stays silent, the harm is on his head. That duty did not end with the prophets. It belongs to every one of us, the baptised.

But notice how Jesus asks it to be done. Not a public shaming. Not plastered across social media first. Go quietly, he says, just the two of you. Our world has forgotten this. It is quick to condemn, quick to cancel, quick to cast people out for their failures. The Gospel does the opposite: it corrects in order to win the person back. Cancel culture writes people off. Christ never does.

That is correction properly understood. Correction rooted in the one debt St Paul says we can never pay off: the debt of love. Love that does not depend on the other person deserving it. Love that speaks the truth gently, patiently, without a hint of superiority, given unconditionally and always keeps the door open.

And yes, speaking that truth today can cost us. We may be laughed at, called outdated, told to keep our faith to ourselves. But speak anyway. Kindly, humbly, but speak. Silence is not kindness; it is abandonment. So many we love have not rejected the faith, they have simply drifted, the fire has gone low. A word of love may be the very thing that rekindles it.

This week, be a gentle guardian. A phone call. A visit. *"I miss seeing you at Mass"* — said and meant. *"I'm praying for you"* — said and done.

We are never sent out alone. Christ goes with us — his love poured into our hearts. Your duty now is to go, and pour it out.

Fr Sean

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: **Melmount:** £2444.00; **Sion Mills:** £1395.00. Thank you.

Those who pay to the weekly collection or any special collections, including Priest's Collection by cheque are asked that all cheques should be made payable to '*Melmount Parish*' or '*Sion Mills Parish*' depending on the Parish. This is a banking requirement. *Parishioners can still leave their contributions in the Parish Office. If the Office is closed, please use the letterbox.*

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 7 September after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm.

Collection Counters The following are asked to count the collection for the month of September: Aoife Doherty's Team.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Rosa Maria McElroy

Mollie Eileen McIlroy

Tess Hegarty

Koby Martyn Burns

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Teresa Madden, 14 Glenview Park

Aiden (Cookie) Dunne, 6 Townsend Street

Eamon McNulty, 5 Ballyduff Park

Martin Gallagher, Bingley, formerly Laurel Drive

Evelyn Baxter, Castlederg

Anniversaries

Marie Logue, Martha Reid, Brendan Kearney

Gerard Maguire, Teresa Casey, Kathleen Christy

Rose Graham, John McHugh, Nora McLaughlin

Betty Montague, Danny McDaid, Sarah Huston-Richmond

Johnnie Montague, Mariah McElwee, Frances McElwee-Gallagher

George Patterson, Catherine Gibson, Bernadette Barclay

Margaret Blee, James Foley, Frances Duncan

Michael McDevitt, Kathleen McDevitt, Rosemary Stewart

Tommy Barr, Aiden Callen, Lena Kelly

Collection for Retired Priests The Annual Collection for Retired Priests will be taken up at all Masses next Sunday 13 September. This is a collection to help assist priests who have retired from active ministry. There is an envelope marked '*Clergy Retirement Fund*' in your box of envelopes for this collection. Anyone contributing to this collection by cheque should make it payable to '*Melmount Parish*' or '*Sion Mills Parish*' depending on the Parish.

Vocations We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

Baptism Dates Melmount

September: Sunday 13; Saturday 19.

October: Sunday 4; Saturday 10; Saturday 17; Saturday 24.

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14; Saturday 21; Saturday 28.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

Parish Draw Promoters should make their returns for September to the Parish Office on **Monday 21 September from 2.00pm - 4.30pm**. The Draw for September will take place on Thursday 24 September at 10.30am in the Parish Office.

Adoration Everyday The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Society of St. Juan Vianney Branch will meet on Tuesday 8 September in the Church of the Immaculate Conception. Rosary after 10.00am Mass and meeting will continue in St. Patrick's Hall, Barrack Street afterwards.

Legion of Mary will meet in the Green Room, behind St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills each Monday evening at 7.30pm. New members welcome. The Rosary for Peace will be said at the Grotto tomorrow Monday 7 September at 12 noon.

40 Hours Eucharistic Adoration, St. Mary's Church, Castlefin Begins with Mass on Friday 11/12 September at midnight continuous Eucharistic Adoration. Finishes on Sunday 13 September at 4.00pm. Prayer and Benediction on Sunday at 3.30pm. All are welcome.

Study Theology Online, is this for you? The Priory Institute provides Theology courses to degree level. Attend Saturday lectures in Tallaght or from the comfort of your own home. Register now before 19 September. For more information see prioryinstitute.com.

Anam Cara, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold its monthly Parent Support Evening on Thursday 10 September at 7.30pm in the Radisson Blu Hotel, Letterkenny. This event is free and open to all bereaved parents regardless of the age their child died, the circumstances of

their death or how recent their death was. Advance registration not necessary. We also offer online support group meetings. To find out more call 0035385 288 8888 or email info@anamcara.ie.

Donegal Group 173 Rise and Shine Trust (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26 September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's, Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St. Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co. Donegal at 1.30pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station to present the donation to the RNLI. ***Please Note: Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St. Patrick's Church, Dungiven at 11.30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.***

Rise and Shine Trust Easter 2027 Pilgrimage Applications are invited from young people with additional social, emotional, physical and learning needs aged 11 – 30 who are interested in travelling as guests to Lourdes with the Rise and Shine Trust. *The trip is free to guests travelling with the Group.* The application form is available online at riseandshine.ie. Closing date for applications is 15 October 2026. Applications are also sought for carers aged 18+ who would be interested in accompanying guests on the trip. Carers applications at riseandshine.ie. For more information visit www.riseandshine.ie or contact Sian 07960211352 or Maurice 07711504821.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email@ dlp@derrydiocese.org. *Northern Ireland emergency services:* PSNI on 101; *Social Services:* Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 71314090 and ask for the Duty Social Worker. *Regional Emergency Social Work Services* 0800 1979 995.



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- 2 Remembering our Dead.
- 3 WEBCAM
- 4 Prayers For Protection
- 5 Mass Times
- 6 Getting Married

A short reflection on today's Gospel Matthew 18:15-20

In today's Gospel, Jesus reminds us that Christian community is built on honesty, reconciliation and love. When someone hurts us, makes a mistake, or goes astray, we are not called to condemn or abandon them. Instead, we are invited to approach them with patience, compassion and a genuine desire to restore the relationship. This is not always easy. It can take courage to speak honestly, humility to admit when we are wrong, and generosity of heart to forgive. Yet this willingness to reach out, rather than turn away, is at the heart of how Jesus calls us to live together as his disciples.

Jesus also gives us the beautiful promise: "Where two or three are gathered in my name, I am there among them." Our faith is never meant to be lived alone. We need one another, especially in moments when life is difficult or when our faith feels weak. Christ is present when we come together in prayer, when we support one another through difficult times, when we forgive, and when we patiently work to bring peace and understanding. Even the smallest acts of kindness and encouragement can become signs of Christ's presence among us.

As a parish family, may we have the courage to speak with kindness, the humility to listen, and the grace to forgive. May we be willing to look beyond our differences and remember that each person we meet is valued and loved by God. May we never be afraid to take the first step towards reconciliation, even when it is difficult or uncomfortable. And may our communities always be places where Christ's presence can be recognised - not only in our words and prayers, but especially in the way we welcome, support, forgive and care for one another. In doing so, may we become a true reflection of the love and mercy that Jesus asks us to share with the world.

Prayer for Vocations to the Priesthood: We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus, and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world.

The Matt Talbot Mass will be celebrated in here St Eugene's Cathedral on Monday, 7th September at 7.30 pm. To join the Matt Talbot Prayer Society, you are invited to enrol the name of the person to be prayed for and the addiction we are praying that they will be freed from. Those enrolled will be prayed for specifically every day. Mass will also be offered for those enrolled on the first Monday of every month here in St Eugene's Cathedral at 7.30pm. To enrol someone in the Matt Talbot Prayer Society please email vita@matttalbotprayersociety.com or private message St Eugene's Cathedral Facebook page or phone St Eugene's Cathedral at 028 71262894/71365712.

Save the Date: Saint Carlo Acutis Day of Prayer. You are invited to come to St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry on Sunday 11th October from 2.00pm where we will have Veneration of a First Class Relic of St Carlo Acutis, gifted to the Cathedral by Carlo's mother, Antonia. The Sacrament of Confession will be available from 2.00pm until Mass at 7.00pm, which will be celebrated by Bishop Michael Router. Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in the Mother Teresa Chapel during the Celebrations. A short film on Carlo's life will be shown in the Conference Room. Everyone is welcome to this special time.

Anniversaries

Please pray for the repose of the souls of:

Brian McKeever
Joan Ferry
Martin Crowley
John & Maureen Duffy
Pete Rooney
Berna Boyle
Ding Doherty
 May they rest in peace

Baptisms

We welcome as members of God's family:

Róise Caoimhe Campbell
Erin Therese Campbell
Luán John Barr

To book a Baptism contact the
 Parish Office 02871 262894

Sacrament of Marriage

We congratulate

Megan McGarrigle & Johnathan Ward
Jacinta McGahey &
Connor McLaughlin
Cyra Sweeney & Tyrone McCullagh
 who celebrated the Sacrament of
 Marriage recently in the Cathedral
*May God bless you abundantly in love,
 joy and happiness*

Collection

Weekly Collection: £5,527

Parish Development: £1,032

Thank you for your generosity

Thank you

Fr Farren acknowledges with thanks the following donations for:

Smile Train: £40, £30, £100

Trócaire: £100

Mary's Meals: £50, £20, £330

Sight Savers: £30, £50, £20, £20

Readers for 12th /13th September

6.15pm Karen O'Brien

7.30pm Majella Coyle

9.30am Rosemary Finan

11.00am McGinley Readers

12.30pm Kevin Finan

7.00pm Anna Begley

O Blessed Virgin Mary,
 on the joyful feast of your Nativity,
 we thank God for the gift of your life.
 Pray for us, that we may grow in faith,
 hope, and love,
 and lead us closer to your Son, Jesus.

Amen

The Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary – On 8th September, the Church celebrates the Nativity of the Blessed Virgin Mary - the birthday of Mary, the Mother of Jesus. Although Scripture does not tell us the details of Mary's birth, this feast has been celebrated by the Church for many centuries. It invites us to rejoice in the gift of Mary, chosen by God from the beginning to play a unique part in the story of our salvation.

Mary's life reminds us that God often works quietly and patiently, preparing the way for great things. Her humble "yes" to God would one day bring Christ into the world. In celebrating her birth, we give thanks for the young woman who became the Mother of God and a mother to us all.

May Mary's example encourage us to welcome God's will with faith, humility and trust, and may we ask her prayers as we seek to follow her Son, Jesus.

Host for Hospice: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

*Vol 54 No 35
Twenty-Third Sunday
in Ordinary Time
6th September 2026*

Friends of the Equestrian Order of the Holy Sepulchre of Jerusalem Lieutenancy of Ireland: The Holy Land is the land of the Gospel, but it is also home to Christian families, schools, parishes and communities who need prayer, solidarity and practical support today. The Order is a Catholic Order under the protection of the Holy See, dedicated to supporting the Latin Patriarchate of Jerusalem and the Christian communities of the Holy Land. Friends are not members of the Order but are people of goodwill who wish to support this mission through prayer, awareness and charitable giving. To learn more or become a Friend: Website: holysepulchre.ie/friends Facebook: EOHSJ Ireland Email: friends@holysepulchre.ie Phone: 086 3253882

Priests: Fr Paul Farren, Fr Shaun Doherty

Job Opportunity: Derry Diocesan Trust - Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish: Sacristan, hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St John the Baptist Church. Rate of Pay: £12.88 per hour. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12noon on Tuesday 15 September 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

Just five minutes from Derry, the IOSAS Centre and Celtic Prayer Garden is a special place of peace, community and connection. Enjoy freshly prepared homemade food in our warm and welcoming surroundings, then take time in our beautiful Celtic Prayer Garden, relax and experience its wonderful peace and serenity. Come along, meet friends and discover somewhere truly different. Group bookings are very welcome, with ample parking and easy level access for visitors with mobility needs. Find us at F93 F104. For more information contact us at 00353 74 9384866.

St Eugene's Cathedral is monitored by CCTV cameras and by two live streaming cameras. Live streaming can be viewed online at www.churchservices.tv, www.watchmcnmedia or the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Cathedral notice board, or you may obtain a copy from the Parish Office.

Safeguarding Notice: If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker), Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459, Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995. Republic of Ireland emergency services: Garda Síochána Buncrana: 00353 749 320 540 Letterkenny: 00353 749 167 100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency: 00353 749 102 23

 Bulletin

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NEWS/EVENTS

SCHOOLS

Sunday 23rd August
Sunday 16th August
Sunday 9th August
Sunday 2nd August
Sunday 26th July
Sunday 19th July
Sunday 12th July
Sunday 5th July
Sunday 28th June
Sunday 21st June
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Sunday 24th May
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Sunday 27th October
Sunday 20th October
Sunday 13th October

Saint Mary's Creggan

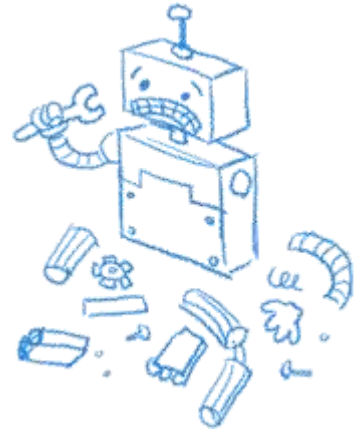
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The requested URL was not found on this server. That's all we know.



Our Lady of Lourdes Steelstown



Sunday 6 September
23rd Sunday Of The Year

Creation is God's work. Before humanity was, the rest of creation came into being. The earth and her creatures – indeed the whole cosmos – have beauty, dignity and meaning before human presence.

So to nurture awe at the wonder of creation is part of our calling. Look up into the skies, walk in the fields, stand at the ocean's edge. Everything belongs, everything has beauty! The garden is such an insightful model for our care of creation.. Our call is to be good gardeners, thoughtful, alert and diligent, working with the soil and with the rhythm of the seasons, caring for the creatures who find home and shelter in the garden.

Ian Adams



SAFEGUARDING NOTICE

If you have any concerns with regard to Safeguarding children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O’Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at +447596 500 793 or at dlp@derrydiocese.org. For emergencies please contact PSNI Tel 101 or Social Services Western HSC Trust Tel +442871314090 (Ask for Duty Social Worker).

Additional contact numbers:

Northern Ireland: PSNI Tel 101 or Social Services Western HSC Trust Tel +442871314090 (Ask for Duty Social Worker)

Republic of Ireland: Garda Siochana, Buncrana +353749320540 or Letterkenny HQ +353749167100 TUSLA Family and Child Agency, Buncrana +353749320420 or Letterkenny +353749123672.

BOOKSTAND

There is a variety of books and cards on sale at the back of the Church.

Signed Mass cards and various Mass bouquet cards are also available from the Parochial House during office hours.

PARISH OFFICE

The Parish Office is open between 9am and 3pm Wednesday to Friday.

Please bring Passport Application Forms, make requests for Baptismal Certificates etc during office hours.

Please do not bring forms to the Parochial House on Sundays.



COUPLES PLANNING TO GET MARRIED

If you live in this parish and plan to marry here or in another Catholic Church then you require marriage papers from this parish. You must give at least three months notice of your intention to marry. The following documentation will be required: a recent copy of your Baptism Certificate from the Parish of your Baptism; and possibly a letter of freedom.

All couples are required to prepare for the Sacrament of Marriage.

Accord offers marriage preparation and can be contacted at 71362475 or online www.accord-ni.co.uk. Places available on the November 20th/21st course. This course is in person and Venue: Everglades Hotel Derry.

All couples living in this Parish and planning to marry here or elsewhere are please asked to contact the parish office to make arrangements for the completion of the paperwork.



SEASON OF CREATION 2026 The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, Living Water, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOTORCYCLES Will take place next Sunday, 13 September, in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1.30pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI. Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September in St Patrick's Chapel, Dungiven, at 11.30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

DONEGAL GROUP 173 RISE AND SHINE TRUST (formerly The Irish Handicapped Children's Pilgrimage Trust and The Irish Pilgrimage Trust) are celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. We are celebrating with a special Mass on Saturday 26 September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's Letterkenny at 12 noon. The Mass will be concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal McKeown Diocese of Derry and many of the priests who travelled to Lourdes with us over the years. We invite all the guests and their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to our mass to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

HOST FOR HOSPICE October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your free host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

NOT DEAD YET UK have provided postcards you can send to your MP to ask them to vote NO to assisted suicide in the vote in the House of Commons on 11 September. Please take action now - collect a red and white postcard, fill out your details, add a stamp and post it to your MP today!

HLI IRELAND Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29 September at 6.45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

POPE'S PRAYER INTENTION FOR SEPTEMBER

For the care of water

Let us pray for a just and sustainable management of water, a vital resource, so that everyone may have equal access to it.

Our Lady of Lourdes Steelstown



OFFICE: Wednesdays to Fridays: 9am to 3pm
Tel: 028 7135 1718
Email: steelstown@derrydiocese.org
culmoreparish@derrydiocese.org

PRIEST: Rev. Declan McGeehan
Email: declan.mcgeeahan@derrydiocese.org
Emergency Tel.: 073 5238 7817 (*urgent sick calls only*)

MASS TIMES:
Sunday: 09:00am; 11:00am and 12:15pm
Monday: 07:45am; 7:00pm
Tuesday - Thursday: 07:45am and 10:00am
Friday: 07:45am
Saturday: 10:00am; **Vigil Mass:** 6:30pm

CONFESSIONS:
Sunday: 09:45am - 10:50am
Monday: 6:30pm - 6:55pm
Tuesday: 08:10am - 08:30am
Thursday: 09:30am - 09:55am
Saturday: 10:30am-11:30am; &, 5:45pm - 6:20pm

ANNIVERSARIES

Please pray for the repose of the souls of:
May Doherty; Tom Casey; Noah Karran;
Kevin Johnston; Megan Tyre;
Mary McDevitt; Kevin McDevitt;
Rita Nelis; Paddy Nelis;
Roseleen Meenan and William Falconer.

COLLECTION

Last Sunday's Collection amounted to £3,655.00.
Thank you for your generosity.

RETIRED PRIEST'S COLLECTION

Will be taken up at all Masses next weekend, 12/13 September.
There is a special envelope in your collection envelope box.

SACRAMENT OF MARRIAGE

We congratulate Tiegán and Sean who recently celebrated the sacrament of marriage here in Our Lady of Lourdes, Steelstown.

ANNIVERSARY AND MONTH'S MIND MASSES

To book a Mass for an anniversary or month's mind please contact the parish office by telephone on 02871 351718 or by email at steelstown@derrydiocese.org.

The daytime Masses will only be offered for one intention but the evening Masses, Monday at 7pm and Saturday 6.30pm, can be offered for more than one intention.

VOCATIONS

Anyone interested in serving the diocese of Derry as a priest should contact their local priest(s) and/or the diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, PP, Bellaghy, at pgoh2111@gmail.com.

Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 6 September 2026

Twenty-third Sunday in Ordinary Time

Shared responsibility for ourselves and our neighbour

The readings for this week ask us and indeed challenge us to embrace our shared responsibility for one another. In the first reading, God appoints Ezekiel as a watchman for the house of Israel. This role which Ezekiel gains is not about showing authority over others, but about a deep spiritual attentiveness to others. God reminds us that we are complicit if we remain silent while a brother or sister walks a path of self-destruction. True community requires us to care about the spiritual well-being as well as the physical well-being of our neighbour.

This call to look out for one another is grounded entirely in Christian charity. As Saint Paul reminds us in his letter to the Romans, our only standing debt is to love one another. When we are called to offer guidance or accountability, it must never flow from a place of pride, judgment, or self-righteousness. Love does no evil to a neighbour, which means our corrections must be gentle, private, and always have a motivation or desire for the other person's ultimate good and healing.

In the Gospel of Matthew, Jesus provides a practical method for resolving conflict and seeking reconciliation within the Church. Instead of resorting to destructive gossip, Christ commands us to speak directly and privately to the person who has offended us. The primary goal is always restoration or to "win over" our brother or sister. In doing so, this protects the dignity of the individual while preserving the harmony of the entire community.

Jesus seals this teaching with a beautiful promise of His divine presence: "Where two or three are gathered in my name, there am I in the midst of them." This reminds us that reconciliation is not merely a human effort, but a sacramental reality. When we gather in humility to heal fractured relationships, Christ is actively present among us, offering the grace needed to bind wounds and loosen the bonds of sin.

Baptisms We welcome members of God's family in Baptism, **Rosie Florence Dunlop**, The Hawthorns, **Jonathan Christopher Bradley**, Lismore Grove, **Kobi Patrick Santos Burke**, The Old Fort.

Deaths – We remember in our prayers **Mark Oakley**, Rosses Gate, **Gloria Hampsey**, Foyle Fold & **Lonappan Parokkaran**, father of Fr Joshi, who died in India.

Anniversaries – We are asked to remember in prayer: Paul Crossan, Annie Doherty, John Doherty, George McCarron, Conor Norris, Pat McGee, Nellie Ward, Agnes Hegarty, Phyliss O'Neill, John McLaughlin, Isobel Higgins, David Murray, Micky McNaught, Joe Dunlop, Kathleen Green & Tommy Kerrigan, Father Aidan Mullan, Kathleen Green and Isobel & Patrick Moore

Vocations – We pray for the men called to priesthood, to the ministry of teaching and preaching in the name of Jesus and encouraging their brothers and sisters to turn away from sin and live as followers of Christ in today's world. For those interested or even wish to enquire about a call to diocesan priesthood, please contact Fr. Pat O'Hagan, Vocations Director for the Diocese of Derry at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Vocations Society of St Joseph (Waterside Parish) We continue to pray for priests, vocations to priesthood and religious life and support seminarians. The Rosary on Thursday mornings at 9.30am offered for this intention. The next meeting will be held on Wednesday 09 September after 10.00 am Mass. The Society wishes to acknowledge with thanks anonymous donations of £100, £40, £40, £20, £20, £20, £10 & £5.

Lectio Divina – Join us on **Thursday** evenings at 8:00pm in St Columb's Church for our weekly praying of the Sacred Scriptures.

Centring Prayer Group – Join us on **Wednesday** at 8:00pm in the St Columb's Church (Parish Hall)

Offertory Collections: Glendermott: £4,285.00 Strathfoyle: £555.00

Thank you for your generosity to the parish collections.

Are you interested in volunteering to help children and adults in our parish to prepare to receive the Sacraments? If you have a basic knowledge of Catholic teaching and some teaching experience (not essential), please contact the Parish Office Tel. 02871 342303. You will join a small parish team and be supported in preparing and delivering sessions. The time commitment would be around 2 hours per week from end of September to May. Safeguarding checks will be carried out.

Season of Creation 2026: The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October. Creation is God's sacred gift, entrusted to our care. Christians are called to protect and nurture Creation working in partnership with others and passing this responsibility onto future generations. Pope Francis' words challenge us: 'What is the goal of our work? What need does the Earth have of us? Leaving an inhabitable planet to future generations is up to us' (Laudato Si', 160)

Accord Derry - Marriage Preparation Workshops - September and November 2026. Sept. 25th/26th 2026 – Nov. 20th/21st 2026. These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com **Please note** that Accord Derry will **NOT** be facilitating courses during October or December 2026.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1:30. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Michael English Concert An evening of Faith, Hope and Inspiration. The concert takes place on Friday 2 October at 7.15pm, in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught, Desertmartin. Tickets are £30, and available to buy at online with Eventbrite: <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/michael-english-band-fundraising-concert-tickets-1996641829460>

Fr. Joseph K. Bill Retreat: At the Allingham Arms Hotel, Bundoran – 28th September to 2nd October, given by Fr. Anthony Saji V.C. Contact: Roisin on 00353868937399 for details.

Rosary on the Coast: will take place on Lisfannon Beach, this Sunday 6th September at 3pm.

Host for Hospice: October is officially Foyle Hospice Coffee Morning Month. We are calling on supporters to help us raise vital funds by hosting a Coffee Morning. Whether it's at home, work or in your local community, you can support your local hospice by bringing your friends together and putting the kettle on - it's a piece of cake! To request your FREE host pack or for more info, please call Ailbhe McDaid, Community Fundraiser, Foyle Hospice, on 028 7135 9888 or email: ailbhe@foylehospice.com

Job Opportunity: Derry Diocesan Trust - Granaghan (Swatragh) Parish: Sacristan, hours of work: 12 hours per week. Place of work: St John

the Baptist Church. Rate of Pay: £12.88 per hour. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302.

Mass & Confession Times

Sunday

St Columb's Church	10.00am, 12.30pm & 6.00pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	10.15am & 12.15pm
St Oliver Plunkett Church	11.15am
St Mary's Oratory	9.15am

Monday – Friday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.30pm
Church of Immaculate Conception	9.15am (Monday – Friday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	11.00am (Mon, Tue and Thursday)
St Mary's Oratory	11.00am (Wednesday only)

Saturday

St Columb's Church	10.00am & 7.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
Church of Immaculate Conception	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	6.00pm (Vigil of Sunday)

Confessions

St Columb's Church	Monday – Friday 7.00pm – 7.25pm Saturday after 10.00 Mass
Church of Immaculate Conception	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm
St Oliver Plunkett's Church	Saturday 5.30pm – 5.55pm

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Email: secretary@watersideparish.net **Web:** www.watersideparish.net

YouTube Channel: www.youtube.com/WatersideParish

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Rev. Patrick Lagan CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

Rev Joshy Parokkaran CC 02871342303 secretary@watersideparish.net

SAFEGUARDING CHILDREN AND VULNERABLE ADULTS – If you are concerned about the welfare and safety of children or a vulnerable adult contact: Designated Diocesan Person Ms Marie Gormley at 07596500793 or marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org or PSNI 101.

Our Churches are monitored by CCTV cameras and by live streaming. Live streaming can be viewed online at the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Church notice board.